“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 8

The Festival of Association with Rāmānanda Rāya

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. Mahāprabhu took *darśana* of Jiyaḍa-Nṛsiṁha, and on the bank of the Godāvarī, at Vidyānagara, He met Rāmānanda Rāya, who had come there to bathe. When they had become acquainted, Rāmānanda asked the Lord to stay in that village for a few days. At his request the Lord stayed in the house of a Vedic Vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇa. In the evening Rāmānanda Rāya, humbly dressed, came to Mahāprabhu and offered Him prostrate obeisances, and Mahāprabhu told him to recite verses that determine the goal (*sādhya*). First Rāmānanda Rāya spoke of *varṇāśrama-dharma*, the duty common to all good people. Then he recited a few verses on “offering one's actions to Kṛṣṇa” (*karmārpaṇa*), then on “action free from attachment,” then on “devotion mixed with knowledge,” and finally on “pure devotion free from knowledge.” Mahāprabhu accepted this last as “the object of the goal” (*sādhya-vastu*). Then the Lord asked Rāya to describe the higher stages of devotion, and as “the essence of the goal” (*sādhya-sāra*) Rāya described first “*prema-bhakti* in the form of pure *rati* for Kṛṣṇa,” then “the *prema* of a servant,” “the *prema* of a friend,” “the *prema* of parents,” and finally “*prema* in the mood of the beloved” (*kānta-bhāva*).[32] Rāya explained in various ways and at length why the beloved's *prema* is the essence of the goal. When the Lord accepted it as the limit of the goal (*sādhya-avadhi*), Rāya described Rādhikā's *prema*. Then Rāya described the nature of Kṛṣṇa, the nature of Rādhā, the nature of *rasa*, and the truth of *prema* (*prema-tattva*). After

that, at Mahāprabhu's request, Rāmānanda Rāya sang a song of his own composition about the *prema-vilāsa-vivarta*, full of *adhirūḍha-bhāva* in separation (*vipralambha*). At the end it was explained in detail how to attain the highest goal, loving service to Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa: the means is to follow the *sakhīs* of Vraja. For several days, every night, they held all kinds of talks about Kṛṣṇa. Then Rāmānanda saw Mahāprabhu's original truth (*mūla-tattva*) and His own true form, and he fainted. A few days later the Lord told Rāmānanda to give up government service and go to Puruṣottama, and He Himself continued south. Kavirāja Gosvāmī wrote all this according to the diary (*kaḍacā*) of Svarūpa Dāmodara.

*Through Rāmānanda the Lord preaches His own *siddhānta* of devotion —*

সঞ্চার্য্য রামাভিধ-ভক্তমেঘে
স্বভক্তিসিদ্ধান্তচয়ামৃতানি ।
গৌরাব্ধিরেতৈরমুনা বিতীর্ণৈ
স্তজ্‌জ্ঞত্ব-রত্নালয়তাং প্রযাতি ॥ ১ ॥

sañcārya rāmābhidha-bhakta-meghe
having infused named Rāma of the devotee into the cloud
sva-bhakti-siddhānta-cayāmṛtāni
of His own devotion of the conclusions of the hosts the nectars
gaurābdhir etair amunā vitīrṇais
the ocean Gaura by these by him poured out
taj-jñatva-ratnālayatāṁ prayāti
of knowing them the abode of jewels the state attains

1 Into the cloud that was His devotee named Rāma, the ocean Gaura infused the nectar of the many conclusions on devotion to Himself; and when the cloud poured that nectar out, the ocean itself became a treasury of jewels — the knowledge of those truths.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Gauraṅga is the ocean of the nectar of *siddhānta*. He infused the nectar of the *siddhānta* of His own devotion into the devotee-cloud named Rāmānanda, and then, through that *siddhānta* spread by Rāmānanda, He Himself again became the ocean, the ocean of knowing the truth of devotion.

Anubhāṣya.

gaurābdhiḥ (Śrī Gaurāṅga Himself is the ocean, the ocean of the nectar of *siddhānta*) **rāmābhidha-bhakta-meghe** (into the devotee named Rāma, that is, Rāmānanda, the cloud that rains the nectar of *siddhānta*) **sva-bhakti-siddhānta-cayāmṛtāni sañcārya amunā** (by that cloud, Rāmānanda) **etaiḥ** (by these nectars of the *siddhānta* of His own devotion) **vitīrṇaiḥ** (spread far and wide, dense) **taj-jñatva-ratnālayatāṁ** (one who knows those nectars of *siddhānta* is *taj-jña*; his quality is *taj-jñatva*; that is the jewel, and its abode is the ocean; that is, the state of being the ocean of knowing the nectar of *siddhānta*) **prayāti** (attains).

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

**Darśana* of Jiyaḍa-Nṛsiṁha; dancing, prayers and songs —*

পূর্ব্ব-রীতে প্রভু আগে গমন করিলা ।
'জিয়ড়নৃসিংহ'-ক্ষেত্রে কতদিনে গেলা ॥ ৩ ॥

pūrva-rīte prabhu āge gamana karilā
as before the Lord onward journey made
'jiyaḍa-nṛsiṁha'-kṣetre kata-dine gelā
at the holy place of Jiyaḍa-Nṛsiṁha after some days He arrived

3 As before, the Lord journeyed on, and after some days He came to the holy place of Jiyaḍa-Nṛsiṁha.

Anubhāṣya.

Jiyaḍa-Nṛsiṁha-kṣetra is a place called "Simhachalam" on the B. N. R. line, five miles due north of Vizagapatam, or Viśākhāpattana. There is also a railway station called "Siṁhācala." The temple of Śrī Nṛsiṁhadeva stands high on the hill. Of all

the temples in Vizagapatam it is the most famous and the richest, and it remains the finest example of architecture. A stone slab records that a pious queen of King Goṅkā III covered the Deity with gold (*Vizagapatam Gazetteer*). Near the temple live the servants of Śrī Nṛsiṁha and other residents. Now on the hilltop, next to the temple, there are many places where pilgrims can stay and many houses. The *vijaya-mūrti* (the festival Deity) resides in a lighted place, and the original Deity of Nṛsiṁha within. Several Śrī Vaiṣṇavas of Rāmānuja's line serve the Deity under the patronage of the king of Vizianagaram.

নৃসিংহ দেখিয়া কৈল দণ্ডবৎ-প্রণতি ।
প্রেমাবেশে কৈল বহু নৃত্য-গীত-স্তুতি ॥ ৪ ॥

nṛsiṁha dekhiyā kaila daṇḍavat-praṇati
Nṛsiṁha seeing He made prostrate obeisance
premāveśe kaila bahu nṛtya-gīta-stuti
absorbed in love He offered much dancing singing praise

4 Seeing Nṛsiṁha, He fell prostrate before Him, and, absorbed in love, He danced, sang and offered many prayers.

“শ্রীনৃসিংহ, জয় নৃসিংহ, জয় জয় নৃসিংহ ।
প্রহ্লাদেশ জয় পদ্মামুখপদ্মভৃঙ্গ ॥” ॥ ৫ ॥

“śrī nṛsiṁha, jaya nṛsiṁha, jaya jaya nṛsiṁha
Śrī Nṛsiṁha glory to Nṛsiṁha glory glory to Nṛsiṁha
prahlādeśa jaya padmā-mukha-padma-bhṛṅga”
to the Lord of Prahlāda glory of Padmā of the face of the lotus to the bee

5 “Śrī Nṛsiṁha! Glory to Nṛsiṁha! Glory, glory to Nṛsiṁha! Glory to the Lord of Prahlāda, the bee at the lotus of Padmā’s face!”

Anubhāṣya.

Padmā-mukha-padma-bhṛṅga means the beloved of Padmā, that is, of Lakṣmīdevī, who sports on His chest. Verses composed by Śrīdhara Svāmī in his commentary on *Bhāg.* 1.1.1 and 10.87.1: “I worship Hari, who has the face of a lion, who delights the heart of Prahlāda, who tears apart the ignorance of His devotees, and who shines like the autumn moon.” “I worship Nṛsiṁha, on whose

lips dwells Vāgīśā, the goddess of speech, on whose chest dwells Lakṣmī, and within whose heart dwells Saṁvit, knowledge."

Śrī Nṛsiṁha is harsh toward nondevotees and gentle toward devotees —

উগ্রোঽপ্যনুগ্র এবায়ং স্বভক্তানাং নৃকেশরী ।
কেশরীব স্বপোতানামন্যেষামুগ্রবিক্রমঃ ॥ ৬ ॥

ugro 'py anugra evāyaṁ
fierce though not fierce indeed this
sva-bhaktānāṁ nṛ-keśarī
to His own devotees the man-lion
keśarīva sva-potānām
like a lion to its own cubs
anyeṣām ugra-vikramaḥ
to others fierce in might

6 "Fierce though He is, this Man-lion is not fierce to His own devotees — like a lion, gentle to its own cubs and fierce in its might to others." (Śrīdhara Svāmī's commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 7.9.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Though fierce in its prowess, a lion is gentle with its own young. In the same way Nṛsiṁhadeva, fierce toward demons such as Hiraṇyakaśipu, is full of tenderness toward His own devotees such as Prahlāda.

Anubhāṣya.
anyeṣām (toward others, such as elephants and tigers, apart from the young it protects) **ugra-vikramaḥ** (fierce in prowess), **sva-potānām** (toward its own young) **śāntaḥ** (gentle) **keśarī** (lion) **iva ayam nṛ-keśarī** (Nṛsiṁhadeva), **ugraḥ** (fierce in prowess) **api**, **sva-bhaktānām** (toward His own servants, whom He protects) **anugraḥ** (gentle, soft, full of affection).

এইমত নানা শ্লোক পড়ি' স্তুতি কৈল ।
নৃসিংহ-সেবক মালা-প্রসাদ আনি' দিল ॥ ৭ ॥

ei-mata nānā śloka paḍi' stuti kaila
in this way various verses reciting praise He offered
nṛsiṁha-sevaka mālā-prasāda āni' dila
of Nṛsiṁha the servant garland prasāda bringing gave

7 Reciting many such verses, He offered His praise. Then a servant of Nṛsiṁha brought Him the Deity's garland and prasāda.

The night at Siṁhācala —

পূর্ব্ববৎ কোন বিপ্রে কৈল নিমন্ত্রণ ।
সেই রাত্রি তাঁহা রহি' করিলা গমন ॥ ৮ ॥

pūrvavat kona vipre kaila nimantraṇa
as before some brāhmaṇa made an invitation
sei rātri tāṁhā rahi' karilā gamana
that night there staying He made departure

8 As before, a certain brāhmaṇa invited Him. He stayed there that night and then went on.

In the morning, on the road again —

প্রভাতে উঠিয়া প্রভু চলিলা প্রেমাবেশে ।
দিগ্ বিদিক্ নাহি জ্ঞান রাত্রি-দিবসে ॥ ৯ ॥

prabhāte uṭhiyā prabhu calilā premāveśe
in the morning rising the Lord went on absorbed in love
dig vidik nāhi jñāna rātri-divase
of directions of the intermediate directions no awareness night and day

9 Rising in the morning, the Lord walked on, absorbed in love; night and day He had no sense of direction.

Arrival at the bank of the Godāvarī; seeing it awakens the memory of the

"Yamunā" —

পূর্ব্ববৎ 'বৈষ্ণব' করি' সর্ব্ব লোকগণে ।
গোদাবরী-তীরে প্রভু আইলা কতদিনে ॥ ১০ ॥

pūrvavat 'vaiṣṇava' kari' sarva loka-gaṇe
as before Vaiṣṇavas making all the people
godāvarī-tīre prabhu āilā kata-dine
on the bank of the Godāvarī the Lord arrived after some days

10 As before, He made Vaiṣṇavas of all the people, and after some days the Lord came to the bank of the Godāvarī.

গোদাবরী দেখি' হইল 'যমুনা'-স্মরণ ।
তীরে বন দেখি' স্মৃতি হৈল বৃন্দাবন ॥ ১১ ॥

godāvarī dekhi' haila 'yamunā'-smaraṇa
the Godāvarī seeing arose of the Yamunā remembrance
tīre vana dekhi' smṛti haila vṛndāvana
on the bank the forest seeing remembrance arose of Vṛndāvana

11 Seeing the Godāvarī, He remembered the Yamunā; seeing the forest on its bank, He remembered Vṛndāvana.

সেই বনে কতক্ষণ করি' নৃত্য-গান ।
গোদাবরী পার হঞা তাঁহা কৈল স্নান ॥ ১২ ॥

sei vane kata-kṣaṇa kari' nṛtya-gāna
in that forest for some time doing dancing and singing
godāvarī pāra hañā tāṁhā kaila snāna
the Godāvarī crossing there He took bath

12 He danced and sang in that forest for some time; then He crossed the Godāvarī and bathed there.

ঘাট ছাড়ি' কতদূরে জল-সন্নিধানে ।
বসি' প্রভু করে কৃষ্ণনাম-সংকীর্ত্তনে ॥ ১৩ ॥

ghāṭa chāḍi' kata-dūre jala-sannidhāne
the ghāṭa leaving some distance away near the water
vasi' prabhu kare kṛṣṇa-nāma-saṅkīrtane
sitting the Lord does of Kṛṣṇa's names saṅkīrtana

13 Leaving the bathing-place, He sat by the water some distance away and chanted the names of Kṛṣṇa.

Rāmānanda Rāya comes there to bathe —

হেনকালে দোলায় চড়ি' রামানন্দ রায় ।
স্নান করিবারে আইলা, বাজনা বাজায় ॥ ১৪ ॥

hena-kāle dolāya caḍi' rāmānanda rāya
at that time in a palanquin riding Rāmānanda Rāya
snāna karibāre āilā, bājanā bājāya
bath to take came music playing

14 Just then Rāmānanda Rāya arrived in a palanquin to bathe, with music playing.

তাঁর সঙ্গে বহু আইলা বৈদিক ব্রাহ্মণ ।
বিধিমতে কৈল তিঁহো স্নানাদি-তর্পণ ॥ ১৫ ॥

tāṁra saṅge bahu āilā vaidika brāhmaṇa
with him together many came Vedic brāhmaṇas
vidhi-mate kaila tiṁho snānādi-tarpaṇa
by the rules performed he bathing and the rest tarpaṇa

15 Many Vedic brāhmaṇas came with him. He bathed and offered tarpaṇa and the other rites according to the rules.

The Lord is eager to meet Rāmānanda —

প্রভু তাঁরে দেখি' জানিল, — এই রামরায় ।
তাঁহারে মিলিতে প্রভুর মন উঠি' ধায় ॥ ১৬ ॥

prabhu tāṁre dekhi' jānila, — ei rāma-rāya
the Lord him seeing knew this is Rāmānanda Rāya
tāṁhāre milite prabhura mana uṭhi' dhāya
him to meet of the Lord the mind rising runs

16 Seeing him, the Lord knew: "This is Rāmānanda Rāya," and His heart leapt up and ran out to meet him.

Rāmānanda approaches the Lord —

তথাপি ধৈর্য্য ধরি' প্রভু রহিলা বসিয়া ।
রামানন্দ আইলা অপূর্ব্ব সন্ন্যাসী দেখিয়া ॥ ১৭ ॥

tathāpi dhairya dhari' prabhu rahilā vasiyā
still composure keeping the Lord remained seated
rāmānanda āilā apūrva sannyāsī dekhiyā
Rāmānanda came a wonderful sannyāsī seeing

17 Still, the Lord kept His composure and remained seated. Seeing this wondrous sannyāsī, Rāmānanda came up to Him.

Seeing the Lord's form, Rāya is amazed and offers prostrate obeisances —

সূর্য্যশত-সম কান্তি, অরুণ বসন ।
সুবলিত প্রকাণ্ড দেহ, কমল-লোচন ॥ ১৮ ॥

sūrya-śata-sama kānti, aruṇa vasana
to a hundred suns equal radiance dawn-coloured garment
subalita prakāṇḍa deha, kamala-locana
well-formed tall body lotus eyes

18 His radiance was like that of a hundred suns, His garment the colour of dawn; His body was tall and beautifully formed, His eyes like lotuses.

দেখিয়া তাঁহার মনে হৈল চমৎকার ।
আসিয়া করিল দণ্ডবৎ নমস্কার ॥ ১৯ ॥

dekhiyā tāṁhāra mane haila camatkāra
seeing in his mind arose wonder
āsiyā karila daṇḍavat namaskāra
coming near he made prostrate obeisance

19 Seeing Him, Rāmānanda was struck with wonder. He came forward and fell prostrate before Him.

The Lord, longing to embrace Rāya, restrains Himself, raises him, and asks his name —

উঠি' প্রভু কহে, — উঠ, কহ 'কৃষ্ণ' 'কৃষ্ণ' ।
তাঁরে আলিঙ্গিতে প্রভুর হৃদয় সতৃষ্ণ ॥ ২০ ॥

uṭhi' prabhu kahe, — uṭha, kaha 'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa'
rising the Lord says rise say Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa
tāṁre āliṅgite prabhura hṛdaya satṛṣṇa
him to embrace of the Lord the heart longing

20 The Lord rose and said, "Get up — say 'Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!'" His heart longed to embrace him.

তথাপি পুছিল, — তুমি রায় রামানন্দ ?
তিঁহো কহে, — হঙ মুঞি দাস শূদ্র মন্দ ॥ ২১ ॥

tathāpi puchila, — tumi rāya rāmānanda?
still He asked you Rāya Rāmānanda
tiṁho kahe, — haṅa muñi dāsa śūdra manda
he said yes I servant a śūdra lowly

21 Still He asked, "Are you Rāya Rāmānanda?" He replied, "Yes, I am Your servant, a lowly śūdra."

As soon as He hears who he is, the Lord embraces Rāya; the love of both —

তবে তাঁরে কৈল প্রভু দৃঢ় আলিঙ্গন ।
প্রেমাবেশে প্রভু-ভৃত্য, দোঁহে অচেতন ॥ ২২ ॥

tabe tāṁre kaila prabhu dṛḍha āliṅgana
then him made the Lord firm embrace
premāveśe prabhu-bhṛtya, doṁhe acetana
absorbed in love Master and servant both unconscious

22 Then the Lord held him in a firm embrace, and, absorbed in love, Master and servant both lost consciousness.

স্বাভাবিক প্রেম দোঁহার উদয় করিলা ।
দুঁহা আলিঙ্গিয়া দুঁহে ভূমিতে পড়িলা ॥ ২৩ ॥

svābhāvika prema doṁhāra udaya karilā
natural love of both awakening made
duṁhā āliṅgiyā duṁhe bhūmite paḍilā
each other embracing both on the ground fell

23 The love natural to both of them awoke; embracing each other, they fell to the ground.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The natural love that Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa feel for Their friend Viśākhā, and that the *sakhī* Viśākhā feels for Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, arose in them.

স্তম্ভ, স্বেদ, অশ্রু, কম্প, পুলক, বৈবর্ণ্য ।
দুঁহার মুখেতে শুনি' গদগদ 'কৃষ্ণ' বর্ণ ॥ ২৪ ॥

stambha, sveda, aśru, kampa, pulaka, vaivarṇya
stupor sweat tears trembling hair standing on end pallor
duṁhāra mukhete śuni' gadgada 'kṛṣṇa' varṇa
of both in the mouths one heard faltering Kṛṣṇa the syllables

24 Stupor, sweat, tears, trembling, hair standing on end, change of colour — and from the lips of both came the name "Kṛṣṇa" in a faltering voice.

Seeing this, the brāhmaṇas are amazed and deliberate —

দেখিয়া ব্রাহ্মণগণের হৈল চমৎকার ।
বৈদিক ব্রাহ্মণ সব করেন বিচার ॥ ২৫ ॥

dekhiyā brāhmaṇa-gaṇera haila camatkāra
seeing of the brāhmaṇas arose wonder
vaidika brāhmaṇa saba karena vicāra
Vedic brāhmaṇas all make reflection

25 Seeing this, the brāhmaṇas were amazed, and all those Vedic brāhmaṇas began to reason among themselves:

এই ত' সন্ন্যাসীর তেজ দেখি ব্রহ্মসম ।
শূদ্রে আলিঙ্গিয়া কেনে করেন ক্রন্দন ॥ ২৬ ॥

ei ta' sannyāsīra teja dekhi brahma-sama
this indeed of the sannyāsī splendour we see to Brahman equal
śūdre āliṅgiyā kene karena krandana
a śūdra embracing why does He weeping

26 "We see that this sannyāsī's splendour is like that of Brahman. Why does He weep, embracing a śūdra?

এই মহারাজ — মহাপণ্ডিত, গম্ভীর ।
সন্ন্যাসীর স্পর্শে মত্ত হইলা অস্থির ॥ ২৭ ॥

ei mahārāja — mahā-paṇḍita, gambhīra
this mahārāja a great scholar grave
sannyāsīra sparśe matta hailā asthira
of the sannyāsī by the touch maddened became unsteady

27 And this mahārāja is a great scholar and a grave man, yet at the touch of this sannyāsī he has become maddened and lost all composure."

The Lord restrains the surge of His feelings —

এইমত বিপ্রগণ ভাবে মনে মন ।
বিজাতীয় লোক দেখি' প্রভু কৈল সম্বরণ ॥ ২৮ ॥

ei-mata vipra-gaṇa bhāve mane mana
in this way the brāhmaṇas think in the mind to themselves
vijātīya loka dekhi' prabhu kaila samvaraṇa
outsiders people seeing the Lord made restraint

28 So the brāhmaṇas reflected within themselves. Seeing people who were strangers to such feelings, the Lord restrained Himself.

Anubhāṣya.

Vijātīya loka (“people of another kind”). Rāmānanda, whose shelter is of the same kind (*svajātīya*), is an intimate devotee. But the brāhmaṇas and others who accompanied Rāmānanda were devoted to *karma*: far from being intimate devotees, they were not even pure devotees. That is why they were *vijātīya*, that is, nondevotees. Though their mutual love was being revealed, the Lord understood that the *karmīs* were turned away from Him, and He concealed it.

The Lord explains why He has come —

সুস্থ হঞা দুঁহে সেই স্থানেতে বসিলা ।
তবে হাসি' মহাপ্রভু কহিতে লাগিলা ॥ ২৯ ॥

sustha hañā duṁhe sei sthānete vasilā
composed becoming both in that place sat down
tabe hāsi' mahāprabhu kahite lāgilā
then smiling Mahāprabhu to speak began

29 Growing calm, the two sat down on that spot, and Mahāprabhu, smiling, began to speak.

সার্ব্বভৌম ভট্টাচার্য্য কহিল তোমার গুণে ।
তোমারে মিলিতে মোরে করিল যতনে ॥ ৩০ ॥

sārvabhauma bhaṭṭācārya kahila tomāra guṇe
Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya told of your virtues
tomāre milite more karila yatane
you to meet Me made (urge) earnestly

30 “Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya told Me of your virtues and earnestly urged Me to meet you.

তোমা মিলিবারে মোর এথা আগমন ।
ভাল হৈল, অনায়াসে পাইলুঁ দরশন ॥ ৩১ ॥

tomā milibāre mora ethā āgamana
you to meet My here coming
bhāla haila, anāyāse pāiluṁ daraśana
good it was without effort I obtained sight (of you)

31 It was to meet you that I came here, and how good it is that I have found you without any effort!”

Rāmānanda's humility and his praise of the Lord —

রায় কহে, — সার্ব্বভৌম করে ভৃত্য-জ্ঞান ।
পরোক্ষেহ মোর হিতে হয় সাবধান ॥ ৩২ ॥

rāya kahe, — sārvabhauma kare bhṛtya-jñāna
Rāya said Sārvabhauma holds as a servant
parokṣeha mora hite haya sāvadhāna
even out of sight for my welfare is careful

32 Rāya said, “Sārvabhauma regards me as his servant; even in my absence he is careful of my welfare.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Rāmānanda Rāya said, “Sārvabhauma regards me as his servant and looks after my welfare even behind my back, that is, even when I am not present.”

Anubhāṣya.
Sāvadhāna — diligent.

তাঁর কৃপায় পাইনু তোমার দরশন ।
আজি সফল হৈল মোর মনুষ্যজনম ॥ ৩৩ ॥

tāṁra kṛpāya pāinu tomāra daraśana
by his mercy I obtained Your sight
āji saphala haila mora manuṣya-janama
today successful became my human birth

33 By his mercy I have seen You; today my human birth has borne its fruit.

সার্ব্বভৌমে তোমার কৃপা, — তার এই চিহ্ন ।
অস্পৃশ্য স্পর্শিলে হঞা তাঁর প্রেমাধীন ॥ ৩৪ ॥

sārvabhaume tomāra kṛpā, — tāra ei cihna
to Sārvabhauma Your mercy of it this sign
aspṛśya sparśile hañā tāṁra premādhīna
an untouchable You touched being of his love subject to

34 Your mercy to Sārvabhauma is plain from this: yielding to his love, You have touched an untouchable.

কাঁহা তুমি — সাক্ষাৎ ঈশ্বর নারায়ণ ।
কাঁহা মুঞি — রাজসেবক বিষয়ী শূদ্রাধম ॥ ৩৫ ॥

kāṁhā tumi — sākṣāt īśvara nārāyaṇa
where You directly the Lord Nārāyaṇa
kāṁhā muñi — rāja-sevaka viṣayī śūdrādhama
where I a king's servant worldly lowest of śūdras

35 Where are You — the Lord Nārāyaṇa Himself — and where am I — a servant of the king, a worldly man, the lowest of śūdras?

মোর স্পর্শে না করিলে ঘৃণা, বেদভয় ।
মোর দর্শন তোমা বেদে নিষেধয় ॥ ৩৬ ॥

mora sparśe nā karile ghṛṇā, veda-bhaya
my touch not You showed disgust fear of the Vedas
mora darśana tomā vede niṣedhaya
me to see You the Vedas forbid

36 You did not shrink from touching me, nor did You fear the Vedas, though the Vedas forbid You even to see me.

Anubhāṣya.

Out of natural humility Śrīla Rāya Rāmānanda called himself by low names such as "*viṣayī*" and "the lowest of *śūdras*." Although he was not born in a family of brāhmaṇas by birth (*śaukra-vipras*), in the manifest pastimes he was an *akiñcana*, a pure *bhāgavata*, a *paramahaṁsa*. Therefore to call him a transcendental brāhmaṇa by initiation (*daikṣa-brāhmaṇa*) of the Vedic Ekāyana branch expresses only a small part of his greatness. Even a man born into a great family, initiated into every sacrifice and versed in a thousand branches of the Vedas, will surely go to hell if he sees caste (*śūdra*) in Rāmānanda and considers him equal to others born in *śūdra* families: "…he who sees in him only a common caste certainly goes to hell." (*Padma Purāṇa*) The eternal good of a *jīva* who seeks the highest goal lies only in the self-conception of being his servant.

তোমার কৃপায় তোমায় করায় নিন্দ্যকর্ম্ম ।
সাক্ষাৎ ঈশ্বর তুমি, কে জানে তোমার মর্ম্ম ॥ ৩৭ ॥

tomāra kṛpāya tomāya karāya nindya-karma
Your mercy You makes do a blameworthy deed
sākṣāt īśvara tumi, ke jāne tomāra marma
directly the Lord You who knows Your heart

37 Your mercy makes You do what is condemned. You are the Lord Himself — who can know Your heart?

Anubhāṣya.

Nindya-karma* (a blameworthy act). A *sannyāsī* is forbidden to see a *viṣayī* and to associate with a *śūdra*, and so such acts are blameworthy. Yet out of Your boundless mercy You accepted even this for my sake.

আমা নিস্তারিতে তোমার ইঁহা আগমন ।
পরম-দয়ালু তুমি পতিত-পাবন ॥ ৩৮ ॥

āmā nistārite tomāra iṁhā āgamana
me to deliver Your here coming
parama-dayālu tumi patita-pāvana
supremely compassionate You of the fallen the purifier

38 You have come here to deliver me. You are supremely compassionate, the purifier of the fallen.

মহান্ত-স্বভাব এই তারিতে পামর ।
নিজ-কার্য্য নাহি তবু যান তার ঘর ॥ ৩৯ ॥

mahānta-svabhāva ei tārite pāmara
of great souls the nature this to deliver the wretched
nija-kārya nāhi tabu yāna tāra ghara
own business not yet they go to their houses

39 This is the nature of great souls: to deliver the wretched. Though they have no business of their own, they still go to their houses.

Causeless mercy is the very nature of Bhagavān and of His devotee —

মহদ্বিচলনং নৃণাং গৃহিণাং দীনচেতসাম্ ।
নিঃশ্রেয়সায় ভগবন্নান্যথা কল্পতে ক্বচিৎ ॥ ৪০ ॥

mahad-vicalanaṁ nṝṇāṁ
of the great the coming of people
gṛhiṇāṁ dīna-cetasām
householders poor in mind
niḥśreyasāya bhagavan
for the highest good O Lord
nānyathā kalpate kvacit
not otherwise is meant ever

40 "O Bhagavān, when great souls go to people — to householders of poor understanding — it is for nothing else than their highest good." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.8.4)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O Bhagavān! Great persons go to the homes of householders whose minds are wretched only to bring them the eternal good; they go for no other reason.

Anubhāṣya.

The words of Mahārāja Nanda to the great sage Garga, who had come to his house sent by Vasudeva:

bhagavan (O sage!), **mahad-vicalanam** (great souls, free of false ego and of all pride, never leave their own hermitages; if ever they do leave them, it is) **dīna-cetasām** (of the miserly) **gṛhiṇām** (of those tormented by household troubles, the *gṛhavratas*, unable to leave home) **nṛṇām niḥśreyasāya** (for their ultimate good) **eva**; **kvacit anyathā na kalpate** (it never happens for their own interest).

Seeing the Lord's form and conduct and the love for Kṛṣṇa in all his companions, Rāya recognizes the Lord as Kṛṣṇa —

আমার সঙ্গে ব্রাহ্মণাদি সহস্রেক জন ।
তোমার দর্শনে সবার দ্রবীভূত মন ॥ ৪১ ॥

āmāra saṅge brāhmaṇādi sahasreka jana
with me together brāhmaṇas and others about a thousand people
tomāra darśane sabāra dravī-bhūta mana
at Your sight of all melted the hearts

41 About a thousand people have come with me, brāhmaṇas and others, and at the sight of You all their hearts have melted.

‘কৃষ্ণ’ ‘হরি’ নাম শুনি সবার বদনে ।
সবার অঙ্গ — পুলকিত, অশ্রু — নয়নে ॥ ৪২ ॥

‘kṛṣṇa’ ‘hari’ nāma śuni sabāra vadane
Kṛṣṇa Hari names I hear of all in the mouths
sabāra aṅga — pulakita, aśru — nayane
of all the limbs thrilling tears in the eyes

42 I hear the names “Kṛṣṇa” and “Hari” on everyone’s lips; the hair of all stands on end, and their eyes are filled with tears.

আকৃত্যে-প্রকৃত্যে তোমার ঈশ্বর-লক্ষণ ।
জীবে না সম্ভবে এই অপ্রাকৃত গুণ ॥ ৪৩ ॥

ākṛtye-prakṛtye tomāra īśvara-lakṣaṇa
in form in nature Your of the Lord the signs
jīve nā sambhave ei aprākṛta guṇa
in a jīva not possible these transcendental qualities

43 In form and in nature You bear the marks of the Lord. Such transcendental qualities are not possible in a jīva."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ākṛti, form, that is, the body of a *nyagrodha-parimaṇḍala*, and *prakṛti*, nature, that is, Your supremely merciful disposition: in these You are seen to be Īśvara.

Anubhāṣya.
Aprākṛta guṇa (a transcendental quality) means awakening consciousness (*caitanya*) in everyone for the service of Kṛṣṇa.

Through His own humility and praise of Rāya, the Lord tries to conceal Himself —

প্রভু কহে, — তুমি মহা-ভাগবতোত্তম ।
তোমার দর্শনে সবার দ্রব হৈল মন ॥ ৪৪ ॥

prabhu kahe, — tumi mahā-bhāgavatottama
the Lord said you the best of great devotees
tomāra darśane sabāra drava haila mana
at your sight of all melted the hearts

44 The Lord said, "You are the best of the great devotees (*mahā-bhāgavata*); it is at the sight of you that all their hearts have melted.

Anubhāṣya.
The marks of a *mahā-bhāgavata*. On the path of *arcana*, as the *Padma Purāṇa* says: "A brāhmaṇa who has received the five *saṁskāras* beginning with *tāpa*, who performs the ninefold worship, and who knows the five meanings (*artha-pañcaka*) is the best of *mahā-bhāgavatas*." On the path of *bhāva*, as

the *Bhāgavata* says: “He who sees in all beings the love for Bhagavān that lives in his own soul, and sees all beings in Bhagavān, the Soul of all, is the best of *bhāgavatas*.”[36]

অন্যের কি কথা, — আমি — ‘মায়াবাদী সন্ন্যাসী’ ৷
আমিহ তোমার স্পর্শে কৃষ্ণ-প্রেমে ভাসি ॥ ৪৫ ॥

anyera ki kathā, — āmi — ‘māyāvādī sannyāsī’
of others what to speak I a Māyāvādī sannyāsī
āmiha tomāra sparśe kṛṣṇa-preme bhāsi
even I at your touch in love for Kṛṣṇa float

45 What to speak of others — I am a Māyāvādī sannyāsī, yet even I float in love for Kṛṣṇa at your touch.

এই জানি’ কঠিন মোর হৃদয় শোধিতে ৷
সার্ব্বভৌম কহিলেন তোমারে মিলিতে ॥ ৪৬ ॥

ei jāni’ kaṭhina mora hṛdaya śodhite
this knowing hard My heart to purify
sārvabhauma kahilena tomāre milite
Sārvabhauma told (Me) you to meet

46 Knowing this, Sārvabhauma told Me to meet you, so that My hard heart might be purified.”

The Lord and His devotee praise each other —

এইমত দুঁহে স্তুতি করে দুঁহার গুণ ৷
দুঁহে দুঁহার দরশনে আনন্দিত মন ॥ ৪৭ ॥

ei-mata duṁhe stuti kare duṁhāra guṇa
in this way both praise each other’s virtues
duṁhe duṁhāra daraśane ānandita mana
both each other’s at the sight joyful in heart

47 So the two praised each other's virtues, their hearts rejoicing at the sight of each other.

The Lord accepts food only in the house of a Vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇa; a non-Vaiṣṇava who merely calls himself a brāhmaṇa has no right to invite Him —

হেনকালে বৈদিক এক বৈষ্ণব ব্রাহ্মণ ।
দণ্ডবৎ করি' কৈল প্রভুরে নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ৪৮ ॥

hena-kāle vaidika eka vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇa
at that time Vedic a Vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇa
daṇḍavat kari' kaila prabhure nimantraṇa
obeisance making made to the Lord invitation

48 Just then a Vedic brāhmaṇa, a Vaiṣṇava, bowed down to the Lord and invited Him for a meal.

নিমন্ত্রণ মানিল তাঁরে বৈষ্ণব জানিয়া ।
রামানন্দে কহে প্রভু ঈষৎ হাসিয়া ॥ ৪৯ ॥

nimantraṇa mānila tāṁre vaiṣṇava jāniyā
the invitation He accepted him a Vaiṣṇava knowing
rāmānande kahe prabhu īṣat hāsiyā
to Rāmānanda says the Lord slightly smiling

49 Knowing him to be a Vaiṣṇava, the Lord accepted his invitation; then, smiling slightly, He said to Rāmānanda:

The Lord wishes to meet Rāya again —

তোমার মুখে কৃষ্ণকথা শুনিতে হয় মন ।
পুনরপি পাই যেন তোমার দরশন ॥ ৫০ ॥

tomāra mukhe kṛṣṇa-kathā śunite haya mana
from your mouth about Kṛṣṇa talks to hear is desire
punarapi pāi yena tomāra daraśana
again I may obtain may your sight

50 “I long to hear you speak of Kṛṣṇa; let Me see you again.”

Rāmānanda's humility; with reverence he asks the Lord for instruction —

রায় কহে, — আইলা যদি পামর শোধিতে ।
দর্শনমাত্রে শুদ্ধ নহে মোর দুষ্ট চিত্তে ॥ ৫১ ॥

rāya kahe, — āilā yadi pāmara śodhite
Rāya said You came if the wretched to purify
darśana-mātre śuddha nahe mora duṣṭa citte
by the mere sight pure does not become my wicked heart

51 Rāya said, “If You have come to purify a wretch like me, my wicked heart will not become pure merely by seeing You.

দিন পাঁচ-সাত রহি’ করহ মার্জ্জন ।
তবে শুদ্ধ হয় মোর এই দুষ্ট মন ॥ ৫২ ॥

dina pāṁca-sāta rahi’ karaha mārjana
days five or seven staying please make cleansing
tabe śuddha haya mora ei duṣṭa mana
then pure becomes my this wicked mind

52 Stay five or seven days and cleanse it; then this wicked mind of mine will become pure.”

At parting, the devotee and Bhagavān cannot bear separation from each other —

যদ্যপি বিচ্ছেদ দোঁহার সহন না যায় ।
তথাপি দণ্ডবৎ করি’ চলিলা রামরায় ॥ ৫৩ ॥

yadyapi viccheda doṁhāra sahana nā yāya
although separation for both to bear not possible
tathāpi daṇḍavat kari’ calilā rāma-rāya
still obeisance making departed Rāmānanda Rāya

53 Though neither could bear the separation, Rāmānanda Rāya bowed down and took his leave.

প্রভু যাই' সেই বিপ্রঘরে ভিক্ষা কৈল ।
দুই জনার উৎকণ্ঠায় আসি' সন্ধ্যা হৈল ॥ ৫৪ ॥

prabhu yāi' sei vipra-ghare bhikṣā kaila
the Lord going in that brāhmaṇa's house meal took
dui janāra utkaṇṭhāya āsi' sandhyā haila
of the two in the eagerness coming evening arrived

54 The Lord went to that brāhmaṇa's house and took His meal there; and while both were eagerly waiting, evening came.

The Lord bathes three times every day; in the evening Rāya meets the Lord —

প্রভু স্নান-কৃত্য করি' আছেন বসিয়া ।
একভৃত্য-সঙ্গে রায় মিলিলা আসিয়া ॥ ৫৫ ॥

prabhu snāna-kṛtya kari' āchena vasiyā
the Lord bath and duties having done is seated
eka-bhṛtya-saṅge rāya mililā āsiyā
with one servant together Rāya met (Him) coming

55 The Lord had bathed and performed His evening duties and was sitting, when Rāya came with a single servant to meet Him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Sannyāsīs bathe three times a day (*tri-savana*). Following this rule, the Lord had bathed in the evening and was sitting [on the bank].

Rāya offers obeisances, and the Lord embraces him —

নমস্কার কৈল রায়, প্রভু কৈল আলিঙ্গনে ।
দুই জনে কৃষ্ণ-কথা কয় সেই স্থানে ॥ ৫৬ ॥

namaskāra kaila rāya, prabhu kaila āliṅgane
obeisance made Rāya the Lord made embrace
dui jane kṛṣṇa-kathā kaya sei sthāne
the two about Kṛṣṇa talks speak in that place

56 Rāya bowed down, the Lord embraced him, and there the two began to speak about Kṛṣṇa.

*The conversation of the Lord and Rāmānanda. The Lord asks about the goal and the means (*sādhya* and *sādhana*). Rāya's answer: (a) the stages of *sādhana* (*abhidheya*): (1) first, keeping *svadharma* in the form of *daiva-varṇāśrama*, the beginning of a theistic moral life, or a life of *dharma* —*

প্রভু কহে, — পড় শ্লোক সাধ্যের নির্ণয় ।
রায় কহে, — স্বধর্ম্মাচরণে বিষ্ণুভক্তি হয় ॥ ৫৭ ॥

prabhu kahe, — paḍa śloka sādhyera nirṇaya
the Lord said recite a verse of the goal the determination
rāya kahe, — sva-dharmācaraṇe viṣṇu-bhakti haya
Rāya said by following one's own dharma for Viṣṇu devotion arises

57 The Lord said, "Recite a verse that determines the goal (*sādhya*)." Rāya said, "Devotion to Viṣṇu arises when one follows one's own *dharma*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord said, "O Rāmānanda Rāya, recite a verse of scripture that determines the truth of the goal (*sādhya-tattva*)." Rāya said, "When human beings follow their own *dharma*, devotion to Viṣṇu arises."

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Rāmānujapāda writes in the *Vedārtha-saṅgraha*: "This special knowledge, *para-bhakti*, is produced only by *bhakti-yoga* assisted by action preceded by knowledge, which, as said above, grows day by day. So says the venerable Parāśara: '*Varṇāśrama*…' And the Supreme Person, Parabrahman Himself, who descended to the earth to deliver the whole world, said: 'Hear how one devoted to his own work attains perfection. By worshiping with his own work Him from

whom all beings have come forth and by whom all this is pervaded, a man attains perfection.' (*Bhagavad-gītā* 18.45–46) Thus [the Lord] is attained only by *bhakti* matured in the order described. This path is shown by the multitude of *śrutis* whose meaning is clearly set forth in the ancient explanations of the Vedas and Vedānta accepted by irreproachable sages such as the venerable Bodhāyana, Ṭaṅka, Dramiḍa, Guhadeva, Kapardī and Bhāruci."

Bhakti is a special knowledge: it is dear beyond measure, it alone is needed, and it produces indifference to everything else. Only a soul endowed with such *bhakti* chooses Bhagavān, and only to devotees is He attainable. This special knowledge, the highest *bhakti*, is produced only by the *bhakti-yoga* described above, which grows without cease and is assisted by action preceded by knowledge. This is what the venerable Parāśara said in the verse *varṇāśramācāravatā*… And the Supreme Person, Parabrahman Himself, who descended to the earth to deliver the whole world, said: "Hear how a man engaged in his own work will attain perfection: by especially worshiping with his own work that Bhagavān from whom all living beings have come forth and by whom this world is spread out, a man will attain perfection." This path to perfection is assisted by *karma*, and on it [the Lord] is attained only by *bhakti* matured in due order. The venerable Bodhāyana, Ṭaṅka, Dramiḍa, Guhadeva, Kapardī, Bhāruci and other sages approve this irreproachable path; it is the path shown by the ancient explanations of the Vedas and Vedānta and by the *śrutis* whose meaning is beautifully (clearly) set forth.

The *ācāryas* of Rāmānuja's *sampradāya* say: "The means of attaining Brahman is only *para-bhakti*, constant meditation (*anudhyāna*) that has become the clearest direct vision, dear without limit and beyond measure. It is attained by steady *bhakti* assisted by one's own *karma* preceded by knowledge of the truth gained from scripture. As the verse *varṇāśramācāravatā*… shows, [this *bhakti*] is not restricted to *sannyāsa*, nor to any one *varṇa*: it is bound to each person's own *varṇa* and *āśrama*. True knowledge is only the knowledge of which *karma* is a part, not *naiṣkarmya*, nor an equal combination of knowledge and *karma*."

Sādhya* — that by which perfection (*siddhi*) is attained, that which is gained by *sādhana*: see *Bhāg.* 1.2.13.

*Viṣṇu is pleased only when *svadharma* in the form of *daiva-varṇāśrama* is kept —*

বর্ণাশ্রমাচারবতা পুরুষেণ পরঃ পুমান্ ।
বিষ্ণুরারাধ্যতে পন্থা নান্যত্তত্তোষকারণম্ ॥ ৫৮ ॥

varṇāśramācāra-vatā
by varṇa and āśrama conduct one who keeps
puruṣeṇa paraḥ pumān
by a person the Supreme Person
viṣṇur ārādhyate panthā
Viṣṇu is worshipped path
nānyat tat-toṣa-kāraṇam
not other Him of pleasing the means

58 "The Supreme Person, Viṣṇu, is worshipped by a person who keeps the conduct of *varṇa* and *āśrama*. There is no other path to please Him." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 3.8.9)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Supreme Lord Viṣṇu is worshiped by a person who keeps the conduct of *varṇa-dharma* and *āśrama-dharma*. Apart from the conduct of *varṇāśrama* there is no other means of pleasing Him.

The purport is this: to please Bhagavān is the truth of the goal (*sādhya-tattva*). When human beings follow the *varṇa-dharma* determined by their own nature and the *āśrama-dharma* determined by their situation, Lord Viṣṇu is pleased. There are four *varṇas*: brāhmaṇas, kṣatriyas, vaiśyas and śūdras. A person should conduct his life by following the *dharma* that scripture has fixed for his *varṇa*. There are four *āśramas*: *brahmacarya*, *gārhasthya*, *vānaprastha* and *sannyāsa*. Each should please Bhagavān by following the *dharma* prescribed for his own *āśrama*. If one deviates from it, one incurs sin (*pratyavāya*) and goes to hell. To take up the path of the highest goal, a life of *dharma* is needed first of all. The *dharma* that sustains life is naturally different for people of different natures.

A person's nature arises from birth, association and education. No one can conduct his life skillfully without accepting a *varṇa* according to his nature. Natures are of many kinds, but at root they fall into four divisions. (1) Those whose nature

turns to God and learning are “brāhmaṇas.” (2) Those whose natural inclination is valor and government are “kṣatriyas.” (3) Those whose natural work is farming, cattle-keeping and trade are “vaiśyas.” (4) Those whose nature is only to serve the three *varṇas* are “śūdras.” When a person worships [the Lord] in the *dharma* of his own *varṇa* and according to his *āśrama*, he rises naturally; when he acts contrary to it, he naturally falls. Therefore a life of *dharma* is the root of every human excellence.

Anubhāṣya.

varṇāśramācāravatā (by one devoted to the conduct of the *varṇas*, brāhmaṇa, kṣatriya, vaiśya and śūdra, and intent on keeping the conduct of the *āśramas*, *brahmacārī*, *gṛhastha*, *vānaprastha* and *bhikṣu*, that is, one who keeps the *dharma* of his own *varṇa* and *āśrama*) **puruṣeṇa paraḥ pumān** (the Supreme Person, Viṣṇu) **ārādhyate**; **tat** (His, Viṣṇu's) **anyat** (any other, one that destroys *varṇāśrama-dharma*) **panthāḥ** (path) **toṣa-kāraṇam** (for His pleasure) **na bhavati**.

*(2) Devotion mixed with *karma*, offering one's actions to Bhagavān, is not pure devotion —*

প্রভু কহে, — এহো বাহ্য, আগে কহ আর ৷
রায় কহে, কৃষ্ণে-কর্ম্মার্পণ — সর্ব্বসাধ্য-সার ॥ ৫৯ ॥

prabhu kahe, — eho bāhya, āge kaha āra
the Lord said this external further say more
rāya kahe, kṛṣṇe-karmārpaṇa — sarva-sādhya-sāra
Rāya said to Kṛṣṇa of actions offering of all goals the essence

59 The Lord said, “This is external. Go further.” Rāya said, “The essence of all goals is to offer one’s actions to Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Setting out to determine the *sādhya*, that is, the devotion that is to be practiced, Śrī Rāmānanda first took the standpoint of a *sādhaka* living within the universe. Rejecting other desires (*anyābhilāṣitā*), he took the side of the moralists (*nīti-vādīs*) and cited the evidence for the *sādhya* that Viṣṇu is pleased when one simply follows *varṇa-dharma* and *āśrama-dharma*. But one who determines the goal in this way grasps his relationship [with the Lord] through his “I”

(*asmitā*), and that “I” lies within the universe. Hence the function of such *asmitā* also remains within the universe, and so it is external. Śrī Bhagavān Gaurahari called the external experience of a person situated outside His abode, Vaikuṇṭha or Goloka, an “external *sādhya*,” rejected it, and told him to go further. The evidence about the *sādhya* cited above did not point to the independence of Viṣṇu's personal nature (*viśeṣatva*). Therefore *sādhakas* of this level on the path of *karma* may aim at the worship of Viṣṇu of both kinds, “*nirviśeṣa*” and “*saviśeṣa*.” Understanding this, [Rāmānanda] gave up the leaning toward featureless truth and cited the evidence showing that the personal nature (*saviśeṣatva*) [of the Lord] alone is the purport of the aim of *karma*.

*The *karmī* who craves enjoyment is told to offer his actions to Kṛṣṇa —*

যৎ করোষি যদশ্নাসি যজ্জুহোষি দদাসি যৎ ।
যত্তপস্যসি কৌন্তেয় তৎ কুরুষ্ব মদর্পণম্ ॥ ৬০ ॥

yat karoṣi yad aśnāsi
what you do what you eat
yaj juhoṣi dadāsi yat
what you offer in sacrifice you give what
yat tapasyasi kaunteya
what austerity you perform O son of Kuntī
tat kuruṣva mad-arpaṇam
that do as an offering to Me

60 “Whatever you do, whatever you eat, whatever you offer in sacrifice, whatever you give away and whatever austerity you perform, O son of Kuntī, do it as an offering to Me.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 9.27)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
[Kṛṣṇa] says in the *Gītā*: “O Kaunteya, whatever you eat, whatever you offer in sacrifice, whatever you give, and whatever austerity you perform, offer all of it to Me, Kṛṣṇa.”

In his first answer Rāya named as “the goal” (*sādhya*) the worship of Kṛṣṇa within *varṇāśrama-dharma*. The Lord therefore called this “external,” and so that Rāya would give a true answer to His question, He told him to speak of what is higher than ordinary *varṇāśrama-dharma*. Rāya then answered that “the essence

of all goals" is declared to be offering to Kṛṣṇa all one's actions within *varṇāśrama*.

Anubhāṣya.

The words of Śrī Kṛṣṇa to Arjuna:

kaunteya (O Arjuna), **yat karma karoṣi**, **yat aśnāsi**, **yat dadāsi**, **yat juhoṣi**, **yat tapasyasi**, **tat sarvaṁ mad-arpaṇam kuruṣva**. See *Bhāg.* 11.2.36.

*(3) Merely giving up the enjoyment of results, or *naiṣkarmya*, is not pure devotion; the first step of pure devotion is to give up *svadharma*, surrender, and serve Śrī Hari —*

প্রভু কহে, — এহো বাহ্য, আগে কহ আর ।
রায় কহে, — স্বধর্ম্ম-ত্যাগ, — এই সাধ্য-সার ॥ ৬১ ॥

prabhu kahe, — eho bāhya, āge kaha āra
the Lord said this external further say more
rāya kahe, — svadharma-tyāga, ei sādhya-sāra
Rāya said of one's own dharma giving up this of the goal the essence

61 The Lord said, "This is external. Go further." Rāya said, "Giving up one's own *dharma* — this is the essence of the goal.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Hearing even this, the Lord said, "This too is external. The answer to My question lies beyond it; tell Me that." In reply Rāya said, "Giving up one's own *dharma* (*svadharma*) is the essence of the goal." That is, among the four *varṇas* the brāhmaṇa gives up his own (household) *dharma* and accepts *sannyāsa*, and the other *varṇas*, following him, accept the marks of renunciation and leave home. This *sannyāsa* is called giving up *svadharma*, or giving up *karma*. The *dharma* of renunciation brings the pleasure of Hari.

Anubhāṣya.

The word *mad-arpaṇa* ("offered to Me") rejects the material featureless and means offering to Kṛṣṇa alone, the independent, personal (*saviśeṣa*) Truth. Yet the *sādhaka* still grasps himself through his "I" (*asmitā*), which lies within the universe, and the activity he practices also remains within the universe. Therefore this too is external. That is, the *jīva* engaged in action, with external perception,

receives only the instruction to give his external actions to the independent Reality that is beyond all action. Then Rāmānanda purified this understanding: he took up the mood to which the understanding of a *jīva* risen above *karma* must be raised, and cited the evidence that the goal is attained by giving up *svadharma*.

*Giving up *svadharma* in the form of *varṇāśrama* and serving Hari —*

আজ্ঞায়ৈবং গুণান্ দোষান্ময়াদিষ্টানপি স্বকান্ ।
ধর্ম্মান্ সংত্যজ্য যঃ সর্ব্বান্ মাং ভজেৎ স চ সত্তমঃ ॥ ৬২ ॥

ājñāyaivaṁ guṇān doṣān
knowing thus the merits the faults
mayādiṣṭān api svakān
by Me enjoined even one's own
dharmān saṁtyajya yaḥ sarvān
duties giving up who all
māṁ bhajet sa ca sattamaḥ
Me worships he and the best

62 "Knowing in this way their merits and faults, he who gives up all his duties, even those I Myself have enjoined, and worships Me — he is the best of the saintly." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.11.32)[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the scriptures on *dharma* I, Bhagavān, have ordained many things as "*dharma*." He who weighs their merits and faults, gives up all these pursuits of *dharma* and worships Me is the best of all (a *sādhu*).

Anubhāṣya.

The words of Śrī Bhagavān answering Uddhava, who wished to know the marks of a *sādhu* dear to Bhagavān:

yaḥ (that *sādhaka* who) **guṇān doṣān** (material good and bad states and so on) **ājñāya** (knowing fully), **api mayā** (by Me, the teacher of Vedic *karma*, to those attached to *karma*) **ādiṣṭān** (enjoined) **sarvān svakān dharmān** (the worldly *dharmas* of the *varṇas*, brāhmaṇa, kṣatriya, vaiśya and śūdra, and the *dharmas* of the *āśramas*, *brahmacārī*, *gṛhastha*, *vānaprastha*, *sannyāsī* and so on) **santyajya** (casting them far away and completely) **mām**

(Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa, the independent, the shelter of the personal Truth) **bhajet**, **sa tu sattamaḥ** (the best of *sādhus*).

সর্ব্বধর্ম্মান্ পরিত্যজ্য মামেকং শরণং ব্রজ ।
অহং ত্বাং সর্ব্বপাপেভ্যো মোক্ষয়িষ্যামি মা শুচঃ ॥ ৬৩ ॥

sarva-dharmān parityajya
all dharmas giving up
mām ekaṁ śaraṇaṁ vraja
to Me alone for shelter come
ahaṁ tvāṁ sarva-pāpebhyo
I you from all sins
mokṣayiṣyāmi mā śucaḥ
shall free do not grieve

63 "Give up all *dharmas* and take shelter of Me alone. I shall free you from all sins; do not grieve." (Bhagavad-gītā, 18.66)[3]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Give up all *dharmas* and take shelter of Me alone, Bhagavān. Then I shall free you from all sins. Do not grieve.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Bhagavān's confidential instruction to Arjuna:

sarva-dharmān (the *dharmas* of the *varṇas* within the universe, brāhmaṇa, kṣatriya, vaiśya, śūdra and so on, and the *dharmas* of the *āśramas* within the universe, *brahmacārī*, *gṛhastha*, *vānaprastha*, the fourth *āśrama* and so on) **parityajya** (casting far away) **ekam** (beyond them, nondual Knowledge, with an unwavering mind) **mām** (Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa, the personal Truth) **śaraṇaṁ vraja** (go); **ahaṁ tvāṁ sarva-pāpebhyaḥ** (from the *adharma* within the universe that arises from abandoning the material, regular Vedic rites) **mokṣayiṣyāmi** (I shall deliver); **mā śucaḥ** (do not grieve over transient *dharmas*).

Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī Prabhu says in his own *Manaḥ-śikṣā*: "Do not perform either the *dharma* or the *adharma* that the *śrutis* describe; here in Vraja render abundant service to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa…"[37] "When Bhagavān, on whom one meditates within, shows someone His mercy, that person gives up a

mind fixed on worldly and Vedic ways." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 4.29.46) In this connection see *Bhāg.* 1.5.17.

(4) Devotion mixed with knowledge is not pure devotion —

প্রভু কহে, — এহো, বাহ্য, আগে কহ আর ৷
রায় কহে, জ্ঞানমিশ্রা ভক্তি — সাধ্যসার ॥ ৬৪ ॥

prabhu kahe, — eho bāhya, āge kaha āra
the Lord said this external further say more
rāya kahe, jñāna-miśrā bhakti — sādhya-sāra
Rāya said mixed with knowledge devotion of the goal the essence

64 The Lord said, "This is external. Go further." Rāya said, "Devotion mixed with knowledge is the essence of the goal.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Hearing this answer, the Lord called it too external and told him to speak of something higher. Then Rāya said, "Devotion mixed with knowledge (*jñāna-miśrā bhakti*) may be called the essence of the goal."

Anubhāṣya.

In the realization of a *jīva* who has risen above *karma*, his "I" (*asmitā*) abides in the river Virajā beyond the universe. There the three *guṇas* do not predominate: there is only equilibrium, the unmanifest state. Between Vaikuṇṭha, manifested by the internal potency, and the universe, manifested by the external potency, lie Brahmaloka and the river Virajā. These two places are the shelter of the realization of *jīvas* who are detached from matter and know only material featurelessness. They are not Vaikuṇṭha and lie outside it, and so they are external. A *sādhaka* within the universe who has given up all *dharmas* has no experience of Vaikuṇṭha or Goloka. Therefore such an inclination toward the goal, though it has given up material enjoyment, establishes only a nonspiritual featurelessness (*acit-nirviśeṣatva*), and so it too is external. Rāmānanda then understood this mood to be an external conception of the goal and cited the evidence that the goal higher than it is devotion mixed with knowledge.

Only a brāhmaṇa who has gained knowledge of his relationship with the Lord

*(*sambandha-jñāna*) becomes a Vaiṣṇava by serving Kṛṣṇa —*

ব্রহ্মভূতঃ প্রসন্নাত্মা ন শোচতি ন কাঙ্ক্ষতি ৷
সমঃ সর্ব্বেষু ভূতেষু মদ্ভক্তিং লভতে পরাম্ ॥ ৬৫ ॥

brahma-bhūtaḥ prasannātmā
one who has realised Brahman serene in self
na śocati na kāṅkṣati
not grieves not desires
samaḥ sarveṣu bhūteṣu
equal to all beings
mad-bhaktiṁ labhate parām
for Me devotion attains supreme

65 "One who has realised Brahman and is serene within neither grieves nor desires. Equal to all beings, he attains supreme devotion to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 18.54)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
It is said in the *Gītā*: "He who, by cultivating knowledge in the form of the doctrine of the nondifferent Brahman, himself becomes serene, free from grief and desire, and equal toward all beings, and who attains the state of Brahman, then obtains supreme devotion to Me." The purport is this: devotion mixed with *karma* (*karma-miśrā bhakti*) was spoken of earlier, and higher than it is devotion mixed with knowledge.

Anubhāṣya.
The words of Śrī Bhagavān to Arjuna:

brahma-bhūtaḥ (freed from an awareness confined to the universe and intent on featureless experience) **prasannātmā** (free from the quality of want) **na śocati** (does not grieve over material lack), **na kāṅkṣati** (does not long for material enjoyment), **sarveṣu bhūteṣu** (knowing that all beings are connected with service to Me) **samaḥ san**, **parām** (supreme, pure) **mad-bhaktiṁ labhate**.

(5) Only devotion free from knowledge deserves the name of pure devotion —

প্রভু কহে, — এহো বাহ্য, আগে কহ আর ৷
রায় কহে, জ্ঞানশূন্যা ভক্তি — সাধ্যসার ॥ ৬৬ ॥

prabhu kahe, — eho bāhya, āge kaha āra
the Lord said this external further say more
rāya kahe, jñāna-śūnyā bhakti — sādhya-sāra
Rāya said free from knowledge devotion of the goal the essence

66 The Lord said, “This is external. Go further.” Rāya said, “Devotion free of the pursuit of knowledge is the essence of the goal.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Hearing this, the Lord said, “This too is external. Tell Me what lies beyond it.” Rāya said that devotion free from knowledge (*jñāna-śūnyā bhakti*) is the essence of all goals.

Anubhāṣya.

Even in this state the *asmitā* and its function do not abide in pure Vaikuṇṭha and are not directed toward Vaikuṇṭha, and so this too is external. As long as there is only freedom from subjection to matter, or only an inclination toward pure experience beyond matter, there is no independent and personal realization of the real, true Object. Hence one's own experience and one's own mental disposition face outward. In truth, this is not the goal of the pure *jīva* either. When one imagines featurelessness, all the particulars of *sac-cid-ānanda* lie dormant. And before that, all the reasonings born of imagination have as their purport only meditation on the featureless. Therefore such an imagined state of liberation, intent on the featureless and devoid of the inclination to serve Bhagavān, is also external.

Only one who has completely surrendered to Kṛṣṇa is a pure devotee, who brings Kṛṣṇa under his control —

জ্ঞানে প্রয়াসমুদপাস্য নমন্ত এব ।
জীবন্তি সন্মুখরিতাং ভবদীয়বার্ত্তাম্ ।
স্থানে স্থিতাঃ শ্রুতিগতাং তনুবাঙ্মনোভির্ ।
যে প্রায়শোঽজিত জিতোঽপ্যসি তৈস্ত্রিলোক্যাম্ ॥ ৬৭ ॥

jñāne prayāsam udapāsya namanta eva
in knowledge the effort casting aside bowing down only
jīvanti san-mukharitāṁ bhavadīya-vārtām
live by the saintly spoken about You by the accounts
sthāne sthitāḥ śruti-gatāṁ tanu-vāṅ-manobhir
in their place remaining heard with body speech and mind
ye prāyaśo 'jita jito 'py asi tais tri-lokyām
who generally O Unconquered conquered even You are by them in the three worlds

67 "Those who give up striving for knowledge and, remaining where they are, live by the accounts of You that flow from the lips of the saints, bowing to You with body, speech and mind — by them, O Unconquerable One, You are conquered within the three worlds." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the *Bhāgavata* Brahmā said to Bhagavān: "O Bhagavān! There are devotees who have completely given up the endeavor of knowledge, the contemplation of undifferentiated Brahman. They hear the narrations about You that flow from the lips of *sādhus*, and they live abiding on the path of the *sādhus* with body, mind and words. In all the three worlds You are hard to attain, yet to them You become easily attainable."

Anubhāṣya.

Brahmā stole the calves and so on, and for this Śrī Kṛṣṇa crushed his pride. Then Brahmā, taking exclusive shelter of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, offers Him prayers:

jñāne (for the sake of knowledge) **prayāsam** (the troubles and so on born of effort) **udapāsya** (casting far away), **san-mukharitām** (sung by saints, the *mahā-bhāgavatas*, naturally manifest) **śruti-gatām** (reaching the ears) **bhavadīya-vārtām** (narrations about You, about Your name, form, qualities and pastimes) **ye sthāne sthitāḥ** (remaining in their own place, on the path of the *sādhus*) **tanu-vāṅ-manobhiḥ** (with body, mind and words) **namantaḥ** (surrendering themselves in every way) **eva jīvanti**, **ajita** (O Unconquerable One: beyond the senses, not to be overcome by nondevotees, dependent on no one, immeasurable), **tri-lokyām taiḥ** (by Your devotees alone) **prāyaśaḥ** (You) **jitaḥ** (conquered) **api asi**.

*(b) The perfection of *sādhana*: *prema-bhakti* (*bhāva*, the sprout of *prema*) —*

প্রভু কহে, — এহো হয়, আগে কহ আর ৷
রায় কহে, প্রেমভক্তি — সর্ব্বসাধ্যসার ॥ ৬৮ ॥

prabhu kahe, — eho haya, āge kaha āra
the Lord said this is so further say more
rāya kahe, prema-bhakti — sarva-sādhya-sāra
Rāya said loving devotion of all goals the essence

68 The Lord said, “This is so, but go further.” Rāya said, “Loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*) is the essence of all goals.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Hearing this, the Lord said, “Now the goal has indeed been determined. Tell Me what is higher than this.” The purport is this. Offering one's actions [to Kṛṣṇa] is higher than merely following *varṇāśrama-dharma*. Giving up *svadharma*, that is, accepting *sannyāsa* after giving up the *dharma* of one's *varṇa*, is higher than merely offering one's actions. Higher than that is devotion mixed with knowledge, the cultivation of Brahman. Yet all of these are external, because the object of the goal, pure devotion, is not found in any of these four conclusions. Devotion that is *āropa-siddhā* or *saṅga-siddhā* is never known as “pure devotion.” “*Svarūpa-siddhā bhakti*” is a separate truth: it is eternally distinct from *karma*, from offering one's actions, from *sannyāsa* in the form of giving up *karma*, and from devotion mixed with knowledge. The mark of this pure devotion is this: it is the cultivation of Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇānuśīlana*) in a favorable mood, free from other desires and unobstructed by knowledge, *karma* and the like. It alone is the object of the goal, for it is seen even while it is still being attained, and at the stage of perfection it is seen in its full purity. In answer to the Lord's last question Rāya said, “*Prema-bhakti* is the essence of all goals.” At first pure devotion appears as *śānta-bhakti*: in it there is as yet no sense that Kṛṣṇa is one's own (*mamatā*).

Anubhāṣya.

When the verse *jñāne prayāsam*… was spoken in determining the goal, Mahāprabhu accepted that inclination as the inclination toward the goal (*sādhya-vṛtti*). This is called *sādhana-bhakti*. Then the Lord told him to go further. After

sādhana-bhakti comes *bhāva-bhakti*, the sprout of *prema-bhakti*, and in *śānta-rasa* the quality of equanimity (*nairapekṣya*) predominates. Therefore Rāmānanda Rāya named as the goal *prema-bhakti* endowed with the four *rasas*. "*Sādhana-bhakti*" means *śraddhā*, *sādhu-saṅga*, *bhajana-anuṣṭhāna*, *anartha-nivṛtti*, *niṣṭhā*, *ruci* and *āsakti*.

*Kṛṣṇa is conquered only by a devotee's *prema* —*

নানোপচার-কৃতপূজনমার্ত্তবন্ধোঃ
প্রেম্ণৈব ভক্তহৃদয়ং সুখবিদ্রুতং স্যাৎ ৷
যাবৎ ক্ষুদস্তি জঠরে জরঠা পিপাসা
তাবৎ সুখায় ভবতো ননু ভক্ষ্য-পেয়ে ॥ ৬৯ ॥

nānopacāra-kṛta-pūjanam ārta-bandhoḥ
with many offerings performed worship of the Friend of the afflicted
premṇaiva bhakta-hṛdayaṁ sukha-vidrutaṁ syāt
by love only the devotee's heart melting with joy becomes
yāvat kṣud asti jaṭhare jaraṭhā pipāsā
as long as hunger is in the stomach strong thirst
tāvat sukhāya bhavato nanu bhakṣya-peye
so long for pleasure are indeed food and drink

69 "The Friend of the afflicted may be worshipped with many offerings, but only love makes the devotee's heart melt with joy — just as food and drink give pleasure only so long as there is hunger in the stomach and burning thirst." (Padyāvalī, 13)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Food and drink give joy only as long as hunger and thirst are strong in the stomach. In the same way, the Friend of the distressed may be worshiped with many kinds of offerings, but the devotees' hearts melt with bliss only when that worship is full of *prema*.

Anubhāṣya.

yāvat jaṭhare (in the stomach) **jaraṭhā** (intense) **kṣut asti**, **pipāsā** (and there is), **tāvat bhakṣya-peye** (as) **sukhāya** (for joy) **bhavataḥ**, (so) **ārta-bandhoḥ** (of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Lord of the wretched) **nānopacāra-kṛta-pūjanam** (worship and so on

with the various sixteen offerings) **bhakta-hṛdayam premṇā** (by devotion that pleases Kṛṣṇa's senses) **eva sukha-vidrutam** (melted with bliss) **syāt**.

*Love for Kṛṣṇa is attained only on the path of *rāga*; it is hard to attain in *vaidhī-bhakti* born of pious merit —*

কৃষ্ণভক্তিরসভাবিতা মতিঃ
ক্রীয়তাং যদি কুতোঽপি লভ্যতে ।
তত্র লৌল্যমপি মূল্যমেকলং
জন্মকোটিসুকৃতৈর্ন লভ্যতে ॥ ৭০ ॥

kṛṣṇa-bhakti-rasa-bhāvitā matiḥ
in Kṛṣṇa of devotion by the rasa imbued a mind
krīyatāṁ yadi kuto 'pi labhyate
let it be bought if anywhere it is available
tatra laulyam api mūlyam ekalaṁ
for it eagerness alone the price the only
janma-koṭi-sukṛtair na labhyate
of births in millions by pious deeds not is obtained

70 "A mind imbued with the *rasa* of devotion to Kṛṣṇa — buy it at once, if it can be found anywhere! Its only price is eagerness (*laulya*); it cannot be had for the pious deeds of ten million births." (Padyāvalī, 14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

There is a mind imbued with the *rasa* of devotion to Kṛṣṇa. It cannot be obtained by pious merit (*sukṛti*) earned in ten million births, yet it can be had for one single price, greed (*lobha*). Wherever you find such a mind, buy it at once.

Of these two verses, the first points to "*vaidhī-bhakti*," rooted in faith (*śraddhā*), and the second to *rāgānugā-bhakti*, rooted in greed (*lobha*). From here on Rāya Rāmānanda's words will rest on *rāgānugā-bhakti* alone; that is, from now on he takes up the *siddhānta* of *rāga-bhakti* and leaves aside the talk of *vaidhī-bhakti*.

Anubhāṣya.

kṛṣṇa-bhakti-rasa-bhāvitā (absorbed in the *rasa* of service to Kṛṣṇa) **matiḥ** (intelligence) **yadi kutaḥ** (from anywhere: from some place, time or person, or

from practice) **labhyate**, (then by you such intelligence) **krīyatām** (must certainly be acquired by paying the price); **tatra** (in this trade, in buying that intelligence) **ekalam laulyam** (greed) **eva** (indeed) **mūlyam**, (for that intelligence) **janma-koṭi-sukṛtaiḥ** (by fortune stored up over many births) **na labhyate** (that is, it is supremely rare).

*(1) "*Dāsya-prema*" is excellent —*

প্রভু কহে, — এহো হয়, আগে কহ আর ।
রায় কহে, দাস্য-প্রেম — সর্ব্বসাধ্যসার ॥ ৭১ ॥

prabhu kahe, — eho haya, āge kaha āra
the Lord said this is so further say more
rāya kahe, dāsya-prema — sarva-sādhya-sāra
Rāya said love in servitude of all goals the essence

71 The Lord said, "This is so, but go further." Rāya said, "Love in servitude (*dāsya-prema*) is the essence of all goals.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Having heard this much, the Lord said, "That is so. But tell Me what lies beyond it." In reply Rāya said, "*Dāsya-prema*, the *prema* of a servant, is the essence of all goals." When *mamatā*, the sense "He is mine," joins "devotion marked by *prema*," it becomes *dāsya-prema*. In *prema* in general (*prema-sādhāraṇya*) no relationship is yet established between Bhagavān and the devotee. When the sense of *mamatā*, "Bhagavān is my master," joins it, general *prema* becomes *dāsya-prema*, which is higher than general *prema*.

Anubhāṣya.

In the two verses quoted above *prema-bhakti* was determined as "the goal" in general. Therefore Śrī Mahāprabhu told Rāmānanda to go further and explain that "goal" in particular, step by step. Then [Rāmānanda] establishes "*dāsya-prema-bhakti*" as "the goal."

Only Kṛṣṇa's servant is heir to all His opulence —

যন্নামশ্রুতিমাত্রেণ পুমান্ ভবতি নির্ম্মলঃ ।
তস্য তীর্থপদঃ কিংবা দাসানামবশিষ্যতে ॥ ৭২ ॥

yan-nāma-śruti-mātreṇa
whose name by hearing merely
pumān bhavati nirmalaḥ
a person becomes pure
tasya tīrtha-padaḥ kiṁ vā
of Him whose feet are holy places what then
dāsānām avaśiṣyate
for the servants remains

72 "A person becomes pure merely by hearing His name. What, then, remains to be attained by the servants of Him whose feet are holy places?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 9.5.16)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *Śrī Bhāgavata* says: "Simply by hearing the name of Bhagavān a *jīva* becomes pure. What then is left to attain for those who are servants of that Bhagavān, whose feet are holy places?"

Anubhāṣya.
Durvāsā saw with a perverted vision born of the senses, was possessed by the evil desire to oppose Vaiṣṇavas, and was proud of being a brāhmaṇa. When Sudarśana, the Vaiṣṇava's weapon, began to torment him, it was stopped by the prayer of the *mahā-bhāgavata* Ambarīṣa. Seeing this, Durvāsā was freed from caste-consciousness and praised the pure devotee and Bhagavān thus:

yan-nāma-śruti-mātreṇa (simply by hearing the name of that Bhagavān) **pumān** (the *jīva*) **nirmalaḥ** (pure) **bhavati**, **tasya tīrtha-padaḥ** (of that Bhagavān at whose feet are the holy places) **dāsānām** (for the servants) **kiṁ vā avaśiṣyate**? (That is, nothing at all.)

The humility of one who serves Bhagavān —

ভবন্তমেবানুচরন্নিরন্তরঃ
প্রশান্তনিঃশেষমনোরথান্তরঃ ।
কদাহমৈকান্তিকনিত্যকিঙ্করঃ
প্রহর্ষয়িষ্যামি স নাথ জীবিতম্ ॥ ৭৩ ॥

bhavantam evānucaran nirantaraḥ
You alone serving constantly
praśānta-niḥśeṣa-mano-rathāntaraḥ
with every other desire completely stilled
kadāham aikāntika-nitya-kiṅkaraḥ
when shall I as a wholly devoted eternal servant
praharṣayiṣyāmi sa nātha jīvitam
gladden that very O Lord life

73 "When, O Lord, serving You alone without cease, with every other desire completely stilled, shall I live as Your wholly devoted eternal servant and fill my life with joy?" (Stotra-ratna, 43)[4]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 1.206.

*(2) "*Sakhya-prema*" is higher still —*

প্রভু কহে, — এহো হয়, কিছু আগে আর ।
রায় কহে, সখ্য-প্রেম — সর্ব্বসাধ্যসার ॥ ৭৪ ॥

prabhu kahe, — eho haya, kichu āge āra
the Lord said this is so a little further more
rāya kahe, sakhya-prema — sarva-sādhya-sāra
Rāya said love in friendship of all goals the essence

74 The Lord said, "This is so; go a little further." Rāya said, "Love in friendship (*sakhya-prema*) is the essence of all goals.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Hearing this, the Lord said, "If you can go a little further, you will find the essence of all." Rāya answered, "*Sakhya-prema*, the *prema* of a friend, for Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the essence of all goals." Rāya's purport is this. There is *mamatā* in *dāsya-prema*, but "fear" and "awe" (*sambhrama*) easily arise in it from the thought "Bhagavān is my master." When one gives up that "fear" and "awe" and embraces *viśrambha*, that is, "complete confidence," that *prema* becomes *sakhya-prema*. In this *prema* a "sense of equality" arises between Kṛṣṇa and His friends.

The glory of the Vraja cowherd boys' friendship with Kṛṣṇa —

ইত্থং সতাং ব্রহ্মসুখানুভূত্যা
দাস্যং গতানাং পরদৈবতেন ।
মায়াশ্রিতানাং নরদারকেণ
সার্দ্ধং বিজহ্রুঃ কৃতপুণ্যপুঞ্জাঃ ॥ ৭৫ ॥

itthaṁ satāṁ brahma-sukhānubhūtyā
thus for the sages the experience of the bliss of Brahman
dāsyaṁ gatānāṁ para-daivatena
servitude for those who have attained the Supreme Deity
māyāśritānāṁ nara-dārakeṇa
for those under māyā a human boy
sārdhaṁ vijahruḥ kṛta-puṇya-puñjāḥ
with (Him) played who had amassed of pious deeds heaps

75 "Thus the cowherd boys, who had amassed heaps of pious deeds, played with Him who is to the sages the experience of Brahman's bliss, to those who have taken up His service the Supreme Deity, and to those under the spell of *māyā* a human child." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.12.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *Śrī Bhāgavata* says: "On the path of knowledge He is manifest as the experience of the bliss of Brahman, to the devotees in *dāsya-rasa* as the Supreme Deity, and to those who take shelter of *māyā* as a human boy. With this Bhagavān, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the cowherd boys of Vraja, by the fruit of great pious merit, sported in *sakhya-rasa*."

Anubhāṣya.

Śukadeva describes to Parīkṣit the extraordinary good fortune of Kṛṣṇa's friends, the cowherd boys of Vraja, bound to Him by the thread of confiding love (*viśrambha-prema*), when Kṛṣṇa had gone out to the forest for a picnic:

ittham (thus) **kṛta-puṇya-puñjāḥ** (the cowherd boys, who had performed a mass of pious deeds) **satām** (for the *jñānīs* who hold the featureless) **brahma-sukhānubhūtyā** (manifest as the sole experience of the bliss of Brahman), **dāsyaṁ gatānām** (for those who have attained *bhajana*, that is, for devotees) **para-daivatena** (manifest as the Supreme Lord), **māyāśritānām** (for those bewildered

by Bhagavān's *māyā*) **nara-dārakeṇa** (manifest as a human boy) **bhagavatā sārdham** (in friendship) **vijahruḥ** (sported; the sense is: oh, the good fortune of Kṛṣṇa's friends!).

*(3) "*Vātsalya-prema*" is higher still —*

প্রভু কহে, — এহো উত্তম, আগে কহ আর ।
রায় কহে, বাৎসল্য-প্রেম — সর্ব্বসাধ্যসার ॥ ৭৬ ॥

prabhu kahe, — eho uttama, āge kaha āra
the Lord said this excellent further say more
rāya kahe, vātsalya-prema — sarva-sādhya-sāra
Rāya said parental love of all goals the essence

76 The Lord said, "This is excellent, but go further." Rāya said, "Parental love (*vātsalya-prema*) is the essence of all goals.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord said, "*Sakhya-rasa* is indeed higher than *dāsya-rasa*. Yet go a little further and you will find the essence of the goal." In reply Rāya said, "The *prema* of *vātsalya-bhāva*, the parental mood, is the essence of all goals." When the *prema* of *sakhya-rasa*, which is based on confidence (*viśrambha*), is joined by greater affection (*sneha*), *vātsalya-rasa* arises.

Anubhāṣya.

Hearing Rāmānanda determine "*sakhya-prema*" as the goal, Mahāprabhu called it "higher" than "*dāsya-prema*" and asked him to go further. Then Rāmānanda named "*vātsalya-prema*" as the goal.

The glory of Nanda's and Yaśodā's parental love —

নন্দঃ কিমকরোদ্ব্রহ্মন্ শ্রেয় এবং মহোদয়ম্ ।
যশোদা বা মহাভাগা পপৌ যস্যাঃ স্তনং হরিঃ ॥ ৭৭ ॥

nandaḥ kim akarod brahman
Nanda what did O brāhmaṇa
śreya evaṁ mahodayam
good deed such great fruit (bearing)
yaśodā vā mahā-bhāgā
Yaśodā or most fortunate
papau yasyāḥ stanaṁ hariḥ
drank whose breast Hari

77 "O brāhmaṇa, what good deed did Nanda perform to win such great fortune? And what did the most fortunate Yaśodā do, that Hari Himself drank from her breast?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.8.46)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam says: "O brāhmaṇa, what pious deeds did Nanda perform that Kṛṣṇa appeared as his son? And what pious deeds did Yaśodā perform that Kṛṣṇa, Parabrahman Himself, called her 'mother' and drank from her breast?"

Anubhāṣya.
The words of Parīkṣit, amazed at Śukadeva's description of Yaśodā's parental love for Kṛṣṇa:

brahman (O brāhmaṇa), **nandaḥ evam mahodayam** (so great an elevation, an unprecedented fruit) **kim śreyaḥ** (auspicious act) **akarot**, **mahā-bhāgā** (supremely fortunate) **yaśodā vā kim akarot**, [that] **hariḥ yasyāḥ** (Yaśodā's) **stanaṁ papau**?

The song of Yaśodā's glory —

নেমং বিরিঞ্চো ন ভবো ন শ্রীরপ্যঙ্গসংশ্রয়া ।
প্রসাদং লেভিরে গোপী যত্তৎ প্রাপ বিমুক্তিদাৎ ॥ ৭৮ ॥

nemaṁ viriñco na bhavo
not this Brahmā not Śiva
na śrīr apy aṅga-saṁśrayā
not Śrī even resting on His breast
prasādaṁ lebhire gopī
the mercy obtained the cowherd woman
yat tat prāpa vimukti-dāt
which that received from the Giver of liberation

78 “Neither Brahmā, nor Śiva, nor even Śrī, who rests on His breast, obtained the mercy that the cowherd woman (Yaśodā) received from the Giver of liberation.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.9.20)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The mercy that the *gopī* Yaśodā received from Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the giver of liberation to ordinary people, was not received by Brahmā, by Śiva, or even by Lakṣmī, who rests on Viṣṇu's chest.

Anubhāṣya.

His mother wanted to bind Kṛṣṇa with a rope, and Kṛṣṇa, seeing that she could not and was exhausted, let Himself be bound. Seeing this quality of Yaśodā's, her power over Kṛṣṇa, Śukadeva says to Parīkṣit:

gopī (Yaśodā) **vimukti-dāt** (from the nearness of Śrī Hari) **yat prasādaṁ prāpa**, **tat imaṁ prasādaṁ viriñcaḥ** (even Brahmā, [His] son,) **na**, **bhavaḥ** (Śambhu, equal to Himself,) **na**, **aṅga-saṁśrayā** (His consort) **śrīḥ** (Lakṣmī) **api na lebhire**.

*(4) “*Kānta-bhāva*” is the highest of all forms of *prema-bhakti* —*

প্রভু কহে, — এহো উত্তম, আগে কহ আর ।
রায় কহে, কান্তভাব — প্রেমসাধ্যসার ॥ ৭৯ ॥

prabhu kahe, — eho uttama, āge kaha āra
the Lord said this excellent further say more
rāya kahe, kānta-bhāva — prema-sādhya-sāra
Rāya said the mood of the beloved of love’s goal the essence

79 The Lord said, “This is excellent, but go further.” Rāya said, “Love for the Lord as one’s Beloved (*kānta-bhāva*) is the very essence of the goals of *prema*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord said, “Step by step this has become ever higher. Yet beyond it there is one more *rasa*, and that you may call ‘the essence of the goal.’” Rāya answered, “*Kānta-bhāva*, the mood of the beloved, toward Śrī Kṛṣṇa is the essence of all goals, the highest limit (*parākāṣṭhā*) of *prema*.” The purport is this. In general *prema* there is no *mamatā*; in *dāsya-rasa* there is no *viśrambha*, “confidence”; in *sakhya-rasa* there is no “abundance of affection”

(*snehādhikya*); and in *vātsalya-rasa* there is no “freedom from all reserve” (*niḥsaṅkoca-bhāva*). Therefore in none of these *rasas* does *prema*, the goal, reach its fullness. When *kānta-bhāva* toward Kṛṣṇa arises, then one finds a single, undivided truth of *prema*, free from all these lacks, the essence of all goals.

Anubhāṣya.

“*Vātsalya-prema*” is higher than *sakhya-prema*. But the Lord told Rāya to go further still, and then Rāmānanda named “*kānta-bhāva*” as that in which *prema* is the goal.

*The greatness of the *gopīs* of Vraja —*

নায়ং শ্রিয়োঽঙ্গ উ নিতান্তরতেঃ প্রসাদঃ
স্বর্যোষিতাং নলিনগন্ধরুচাং কুতোঽন্যাঃ ।
রাসোৎসবেঽস্য ভুজদণ্ডগৃহীতকণ্ঠ-
লব্ধাশিষাং য উদগাদ্ব্রজসুন্দরীণাম্ ॥ ৮০ ॥

nāyaṁ śriyo 'ṅga u nitānta-rateḥ prasādaḥ
not this of Śrī on the chest indeed wholly attached favour
svar-yoṣitāṁ nalina-gandha-rucāṁ kuto 'nyāḥ
of the celestial women of lotuses the fragrance having the lustre how then others
rāsotsave 'sya bhuja-daṇḍa-gṛhīta-kaṇṭha-
at the festival of rāsa His by the arms embraced around the neck
labdhāśiṣāṁ ya udagād vraja-sundarīṇām
who obtained their desire which arose of Vraja the beautiful women

80 “At the festival of the rāsa dance He embraced the beautiful women of Vraja around their necks with His arms, and they attained their heart’s desire. Such favour was not granted even to Śrī, who is wholly devoted to Him, nor to the celestial women, fragrant and radiant like lotuses — what then of others?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.47.60)[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In Vṛndāvana, at the *rāsa* festival, Śrī Kṛṣṇa held the beautiful girls of Vraja by the neck with His mighty arms. The mercy that dawned upon them was not attained

even by the wholly devoted potencies of Paravyoma, such as Lakṣmī, who rests on His chest. Nor was it the lot of the celestial women, who have the fragrance and luster of lotuses. What then to speak of other women?

Anubhāṣya.

Uddhava came to Vraja and stayed there several months. He gave joy to all by chanting narrations about Kṛṣṇa, yet he saw the agitation of the *gopīs*, whose hearts, burning in separation, were given to Kṛṣṇa alone. Then he praises their supreme good fortune:

rāsotsave (at the time of the *rāsa* pastime) **asya** (of Śrī Kṛṣṇa) **bhuja-daṇḍa-gṛhīta-kaṇṭha-labdhāśiṣām** (of the *gopīs* whose auspicious desires were fulfilled when He embraced their necks with His mighty arms) **vraja-sundarīṇām** (of the cowherd maidens) **yaḥ ayam** (mercy) **āvirbabhūva** (appeared), **nalina-gandha-rucām** (of those whose fragrance and luster are like the lotus) **svar-yoṣitām** (of the celestial women) **na abhūt**; **u** (oh!) **aṅge** (on the chest) **nitānta-rateḥ** (who takes shelter wholly and only in Him) **śriyaḥ** (of Lakṣmī) **api ayaṁ prasādaḥ na abhūt**; **anyāḥ striyaḥ tu kutaḥ** (thus objects of Kṛṣṇa's grace) **bhavanti**?

*Only the *gopīs* of Vraja are fit to see the form of Madana-mohana —*

তাসামাবিরভূচ্ছৌরিঃ স্ময়মানমুখাম্বুজঃ ।
পীতাম্বরধরঃ স্রগ্বী সাক্ষান্মন্মথমন্মথঃ ॥ ৮১ ॥

tāsām āvirabhūc chauriḥ
among them appeared Śauri
smayamāna-mukhāmbujaḥ
smiling lotus-faced
pītāmbara-dharaḥ sragvī
yellow garments wearing garlanded
sākṣān manmatha-manmathaḥ
directly of Cupid the enchanter

81 "Among them appeared Śauri (Kṛṣṇa), His lotus face smiling, wearing yellow garments and a garland — the very enchanter of Cupid." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.2)[6]

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 5.214.

কৃষ্ণ-প্রাপ্তির উপায় বহুবিধ হয় ।
কৃষ্ণপ্রাপ্তি-তারতম্য বহুত আছয় ॥ ৮২ ॥

kṛṣṇa-prāptira upāya bahu-vidha haya
of attaining Kṛṣṇa the means of many kinds are
kṛṣṇa-prāpti-tāratamya bahuta āchaya
of attaining Kṛṣṇa gradations many there are

82 There are many means of attaining Kṛṣṇa, and many degrees in attaining Him.

*Each *rasa* is the highest for its own devotees, and yet there are differences of degree among them —*

কিন্তু যাঁর যেই রস, সেই সর্ব্বোত্তম ।
তটস্থ হঞা বিচারিলে, আছে তর-তম ॥ ৮৩ ॥

kintu yāṁra yei rasa, sei sarvottama
but whose whatever rasa that the best
taṭa-stha hañā vicārile, āche tara-tama
impartial becoming if one considers there are higher and highest

83 But whatever *rasa* a devotee has is for him the best. Yet, considered impartially, one *rasa* stands higher than another.

Anubhāṣya.
These words should not be taken to mean that any notion or whim of anyone's mind is the highest; license can never be the highest.

"Devotion to Hari that claims to be exclusive but lacks the rules of the *śrutis*, *smṛtis*, *Purāṇas*, *Pañcarātra* and so on is only a disturbance."[38] What is meant here is not a harmony of pure devotion with a mental *dharma* full of self-interest: with keeping up the *dharma* of the *gṛhavratas*, and, for its sake, with trading in the *Bhāgavata*, in mantras, in disciples and in *kīrtana*, which the scriptures condemn and which is full of offenses, with a social life turned away from God, with worldly custom and the like. The Āuls, Bāuls, Kartābhajās, Neḍās,

Daraveśas, Sāīs, Atibāḍīs, Cūḍādhārīs and Gaurāṅga-nāgarīs; those who preach the doctrine of the "new *gosvāmīs*," or caste *gosvāmīs*, and deceive people by passing off the doctrine of these caste *gosvāmīs* as "the doctrine of the Six Gosvāmīs"; the nondevotees of Kṛṣṇa; the opponents of the Gaura-mantra and of Gaura's name; the composers of new ditties; the traders in Deities; hired reciters and their like; those who preach as "Vedic brahminism" a brahminism of caste born of association with low castes; the *smārtas*; the opponents of the *Sātvata-pañcarātra*; the Māyāvādīs; those who keep company with women, and the rest, can never be one with or equal to those who own nothing (*akiñcanas*), who do everything for Kṛṣṇa, who serve Hari at every moment, who have renounced everything and sold themselves to Śrī Guru-Gaurāṅga: the lifelong *brahmacārīs*, the self-controlled householders, the *vānaprasthas*, and those who wear the dress of *tridaṇḍīs*.

Kavirāja Gosvāmī introduced these words in connection with the five perfected *bhāvas* (*siddha-bhāvas*). The *rasikas* of these five *rasas* serve in five *bhāvas*: *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura*. After the *anarthas* have ceased, whichever of these perfected *bhāvas* awakens in someone according to the nature of his eternally perfect *svarūpa* is indeed the highest for one qualified for that *rasa*. For the object of them all is Śrī Kṛṣṇa, not material demigods and others who are not Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Yet when one judges from outside, that is, impartially, a difference of degree is felt in the relishing of *rasa* in these five *bhāvas*. Thus in *dāsya-rasa* both *śānta-rasa* and *dāsya-rasa* are present at once, and so it is higher than *śānta-rasa*. In *sakhya-rasa* *śānta* and *dāsya* are present, and so it is higher still than *śānta* and *dāsya*. *Vātsalya-rasa* includes *śānta*, *dāsya* and *sakhya*, and so it holds more wonder than those three earlier *rasas*. And in *madhura-rasa* all four earlier *rasas* are present, and so its wonder and sweetness are the highest of all. The Vaiṣṇava *mahājanas*, expert in *bhakti-siddhānta*, have examined in this graded order the subtlest truths of realizing the *svarūpa*. Unfortunately, people bewildered by the divine *māyā* and expert in false *siddhānta* cannot grasp any of these *siddhāntas* and so find fault with pure Vaiṣṇava *siddhānta*. This only shows the misfortune of all these childish talkers.

যথোত্তরমসৌ স্বাদবিশেষোল্লাসময়্যপি ।
রতির্বাসনয়া স্বাদ্বী ভাসতে কাপি কস্যচিৎ ॥ ৮৪ ॥

yathottaram asau svāda-
in ascending order this
viśeṣollāsa-mayy api
of special taste full of delight although
ratir vāsanayā svādvī
love by inclination sweet
bhāsate kāpi kasyacit
appears some one to someone

84 “Although love (*rati*), rising from one kind to the next, is ever richer in delight, by the inclination of the heart one particular kind seems sweetest to a particular devotee.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.5.38)

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.45.

Śānta* and the other three *rasas* find their culmination in *madhura-rasa
—

পূর্ব্ব-পূর্ব্ব-রসের গুণ — পরে পরে হয়।
এক-দুই গণনে পঞ্চ পর্য্যন্ত বাড়য় ॥ ৮৫ ॥

pūrva-pūrva-rasera guṇa — pare pare haya
of each preceding rasa the qualities in each following are
eka-dui gaṇane pañca paryanta bāḍaya
one two in counting five up to increase

85 The qualities of each preceding *rasa* are present in the one that follows; counting one, two and so on, they increase up to five.

গুণাধিক্যে স্বাদাধিক্য বাড়ে প্রতি রসে।
শান্ত-দাস্য-সখ্য-বাৎসল্যের গুণ মধুরেতে বৈসে ॥ ৮৬ ॥

guṇādhikye svādādhikya bāḍe prati-rase
with more qualities more taste grows in each rasa
śānta-dāsya-sakhya-vātsalyera guṇa madhurete vaise
of śānta dāsya sakhya vātsalya the qualities in mādhurya dwell

86 As the qualities increase, the taste increases in each *rasa*; and the qualities of *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya* and *vātsalya* all dwell in *madhura*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"O Lord, earlier I named many means of the goal, that is, of attaining Kṛṣṇa. The only difference among them is that the degree of attaining Kṛṣṇa must be judged by the particular means. Whatever means people are qualified to adopt, it is best for them to hold to that means and attain Kṛṣṇa as befits their stage, and that is for them the object of the goal. In particular, for those qualified to attain *rasa*, all four *rasas*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura*, are excellent. For one qualified for a particular *rasa*, that very *rasa* is the best of all."

When one is absorbed in the *rāga* that awakens for a *rasa*, one sees no difference of degree among the four *rasas*. But viewed from outside, that is, impartially, these *rasas* do differ in degree. The five *rasas*, *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura*, rise by degrees one after another. In *śānta-rasa* there is one quality, fidelity to Kṛṣṇa alone; in *dāsya-rasa* *mamatā* joins it, and it becomes richer. In *sakhya-rasa* fidelity to Kṛṣṇa alone and *mamatā* are joined by *viśrambha*, confidence, and blossom still more. In *vātsalya-rasa* the three qualities of *śānta*, *dāsya* and *sakhya* appear joined with an abundance of affection. In *madhura-rasa*, that is, in *kānta-bhāva*, these four qualities become free of all reserve and attain the highest sweetness. Here, as the qualities increase, the sweetness of taste increases. Therefore, judged impartially, *madhura-rasa* is the best of all.

A material example: the other four elements culminate in the fifth great element, "earth" —

আকাশাদির গুণ যেন পর-পর-ভূতে ।
দুই-তিন-গণনে বাড়ে পঞ্চ পৃথিবীতে ॥ ৮৭ ॥

ākāśādira guṇa yena para-para bhūte
of ether and the rest the qualities as in each following element
dui-tina-gaṇane bāḍe pañca pṛthivīte
two three in counting increase five in earth

87 It is as with the qualities of ether and the other elements: in each following element they increase — two, three — until earth has all five.

*Kṛṣṇa is conquered by *prema* marked by *śṛṅgāra-rasa* —*

পরিপূর্ণ-কৃষ্ণপ্রাপ্তি এই 'প্রেমা' হৈতে ।
এই প্রেমার বশ কৃষ্ণ, — কহে ভাগবতে ॥ ৮৮ ॥

paripūrṇa-kṛṣṇa-prāpti ei 'premā' haite
complete of Kṛṣṇa attainment from this prema
ei premāra vaśa kṛṣṇa, — kahe bhāgavate
of this prema under the control Kṛṣṇa says in the Bhāgavata

88 Kṛṣṇa is attained completely through this *prema*. Kṛṣṇa is under the control of this *prema*, as the *Bhāgavata* says:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

To explain the difference of degree among the *rasas*, a material example is given. There are five great elements: "ether," "air," "fire," "water" and "earth." Ether has one quality, "sound." Air has two qualities, "sound" and "touch." Fire has three, "sound," "touch" and "form." Water has four, "sound," "touch," "form" and "taste." Earth has five, "sound," "touch," "form," "taste" and "smell." Now see: from ether onward, the number of qualities grows step by step in each successive element, and in earth all five are found. In the same way, in *śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura* the qualities increase step by step, and in *madhura-rasa* all five qualities are found in fullness. Therefore the full attainment of Kṛṣṇa is found only in *prema* in the form of *madhura*, or *śṛṅgāra-rasa*. The *Bhāgavata* says that Kṛṣṇa is wholly conquered by *prema* that has blossomed in *madhura-rasa*.

*Only *prema-bhakti* for Kṛṣṇa gives Kṛṣṇa —*

ময়ি ভক্তির্হি ভূতানামমৃতত্বায় কল্পতে ।
দিষ্ট্যা যদাসীন্মৎস্নেহো ভবতীনাং মদাপনঃ ॥ ৮৯ ॥

mayi bhaktir hi bhūtānām
to Me devotion indeed of beings
amṛtatvāya kalpate
for immortality is fit
diṣṭyā yad āsīn mat-sneho
by good fortune which arose for Me the love
bhavatīnāṁ mad-āpanaḥ
of you bringing Me

89 "Devotion to Me brings living beings to immortality. And how fortunate you are to have the love that brings you to Me!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.82.44)[7]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.23.

The deeper a devotee's worship, the more devotion to Kṛṣṇa he attains —

কৃষ্ণের প্রতিজ্ঞা দৃঢ় সর্ব্বকালে আছে ।
যে যৈছে ভজে, কৃষ্ণ তারে ভজে তৈছে ॥ ৯০ ॥

kṛṣṇera pratijñā dṛḍha sarva-kāle āche
Kṛṣṇa's promise firm at all times is
ye yaiche bhaje, kṛṣṇa tāre bhaje taiche
who as worships Kṛṣṇa him reciprocates so

90 Kṛṣṇa has a firm promise that holds for all time: as one worships Him, so does He reciprocate.[8]

Anubhāṣya.
Worldly people reason like this: "In whatever mood one worships, one attains Bhagavān. By whatever means one worships Bhagavān, by *karma*, knowledge, *yoga* or austerity, it makes no difference. Just as different roads lead to one place, so different paths lead to Bhagavān. By whatever name one calls Bhagavān, Kālī, Durgā, Śiva, Gaṇeśa, Rāma, Hari or Brahman, it is all the same. Or, just as one man has different names and answers to any of them, so it is with Bhagavān."

All these words please people of a childish mental *dharma*, but those who take the essence (*sāragrāhīs*) consider them full of false conclusions. When someone

desires heaven and the like and worships an administrative demigod, the *māyā-śakti*, which is turned away from Bhagavān, gives him as his fruit faith in those administrative demigods. So she deprives him of the fruit of the ultimate good and makes him wander on the wheel of *karma*, along the chain of births and deaths, now in heaven, now in the world of mortals. But to those who pray for eternal service to Bhagavān, Bhagavān gives His eternal service. It is therefore true that however one worships, one gets a fruit according to one's worship. But it must be specially noted that not all fruits are equal. The fruit of one who desires *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa* and the fruit of one who prays for eternal, causeless service to Kṛṣṇa are not the same. The fruit of *dharma*, *artha* and the rest is a perishable heaven and the like; the fruit of *mokṣa* in the form of *sāyujya* and the like is self-annihilation and the like; the highest fruit of causeless service to Hari is ever-fresh service to Hari, that is, love for Bhagavān. Therefore between the fruits of one who desires *dharma*, *artha* and *kāma*, one who desires featureless liberation, and one devoted to Hari's service, the difference is as between heaven and the netherworld. Of this there is no doubt.

Mahāmāyā, the mother of the world, who presides over the material world, and the other administrative demigods are the external potency of Śrī Bhagavān and a distorted display of His majesty (*virūpa-vaibhava*). By Bhagavān's order they manage the various parts of the work of creation. The creation of the world is no concern of Bhagavān's internal potency. All that takes place in the spiritual abode is the work of the internal potency, and it is accomplished by *yogamāyā*. *Yogamāyā* is Bhagavān's internal potency, or *cit-śakti*. Those who pray for service to Bhagavān in the spiritual abode receive the sincere mercy of *yogamāyā*, which turns them toward the service of Kṛṣṇa. But those who in the material universe desire other things, *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and the like, for the sake of worldly prosperity (*abhyudaya*), or who wish for a featureless destiny turned away from Bhagavān's service, worship Mahāmāyā or demigods such as Rudra. That is why we see the damsels of Vraja worshiping the *cit-śakti*, *yogamāyā*, to obtain the son of the cowherd Nanda as their husband, that is, to obtain eternal service to Him in the spiritual abode. And in the *Saptaśatī* we see that King Suratha and a vaiśya named Samādhi considered themselves needy *jīvas* within *varṇāśrama* and so devoted themselves to the worship of Mahāmāyā, who presides over matter. Therefore wherever a “doctrine of synthesis” (*samanvaya-vāda*) is preached that makes “*yogamāyā*” and “material *māyā*” one, like trying to sell “puffed rice and rock candy” at the same

price, one must recognize ignorance, foolishness, and a failure to realize Bhagavān's true nature.

Secondly, in this world one sees “a blind boy named Padmalocana” (“lotus-eyed”), but with Bhagavān it is not so. There is no difference between Bhagavān's name and Bhagavān Himself: no name of Bhagavān is meaningless or different from His real being. Śrī Bhagavān has many names: Paramātmā, Brahman, the Creator, Nārāyaṇa, Rukmiṇī-ramaṇa, Gopīnātha, Kṛṣṇa and others. But one who calls Bhagavān “the Creator” will not be able to relish the *rasa* of Nārāyaṇa. For names such as “the Creator” were given by sense-born knowledge, the knowledge of the *jīvas* of this world who are turned away from Viṣṇu. The word “Creator” does not give a realization of Bhagavān's full being: creation is not the work of His *svarūpa-śakti*; it points only to His outward-turned potency. The word “Brahman” does not reveal Bhagavān's six kinds of majesty either: His featureless aspect is called “Brahman,” and so this name does not point to His complete form of eternity, knowledge and bliss (*sac-cid-ānanda-vigraha*). The word “Paramātmā” does not give full knowledge of Bhagavān either: “Paramātmā” is the name of only a partial manifestation of Him, as the indwelling Lord in the heart of each individual *jīva*. Again, even one who worships Nārāyaṇa cannot realize Kṛṣṇa's sweetness (*mādhurya*). And a devotee of Kṛṣṇa sees in Kṛṣṇa alone the whole of the supreme wonder, in which Nārāyaṇa's majesty is covered by sweetness, and so he has no desire to worship Nārāyaṇa. The *gopīs* never address Śrī Kṛṣṇa as “Rukmiṇī-ramaṇa.” In worldly dictionaries “Rukmiṇī-ramaṇa” and “Śrī Kṛṣṇa” are synonyms, words of one class, yet one cannot be used in place of the other. If someone does so out of foolishness, the fault of *rasābhāsa* arises. Those who have realized Bhagavān's true nature do not commit such *rasābhāsa* or go against *siddhānta*, as ignorant society does. And yet, through the strength of Kali, fools proclaim unruly false conclusions as broad-mindedness, a “great doctrine of synthesis,” and brand true *siddhānta* as bigotry and narrowness.

*Kṛṣṇa cannot give Himself in return for the *gopīs'* service in *madhura-rasa*, and so He is in their debt —*

এই ‘প্রেমে’র অনুরূপ না পারে ভজিতে ।
অতএব ‘ঋণী’ হয় — কহে ভাগবতে ॥ ৯১ ॥

ei ‘preme’ra anurūpa nā pāre bhajite
this of prema in equal measure not He can reciprocate
ataeva ‘ṛṇī’ haya — kahe bhāgavate
therefore a debtor He becomes says the Bhāgavata

91 But He cannot reciprocate this *prema* in equal measure, and so He becomes a debtor, as the *Bhāgavata* says:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kṛṣṇa's general promise is that as one worships Him, so Kṛṣṇa reciprocates. In the other *rasas* Kṛṣṇa is able to reciprocate in the measure of the devotee's worship. But in *prema* that has blossomed in *madhura-rasa*, Kṛṣṇa found no reciprocation equal to their worship, and He said, “O beautiful girls of Vraja, I have not been able to repay My debt to you.”

*Kṛṣṇa's debt for the *gopīs'* *prema* can never be repaid —*

ন পারয়েঽহং নিরবদ্যসংযুজাং
স্বসাধুকৃত্যং বিবুধায়ুষাপি বঃ ৷
যা মাভজন্ দুর্জ্জয়-গেহশৃঙ্খলাঃ
সংবৃশ্চ্য তদ্বঃ প্রতিযাতু সাধুনা ॥ ৯২ ॥

na pāraye ’haṁ niravadya-saṁyujāṁ
not am able I of the faultlessly united
sva-sādhu-kṛtyaṁ vibudhāyuṣāpi vaḥ
own good deed in a god’s lifetime even to you
yā mābhajan durjaya-geha-śṛṅkhalāḥ
who Me worshipped hard to conquer of home the fetters
saṁvṛścya tad vaḥ pratiyātu sādhunā
completely cutting that your let it be requited by the good deed

92 “O gopīs, your union with Me is faultless. Even in a lifetime of the gods I could not repay you for what you have done: you cut the fetters of home, so hard to break, and came to Me. So let your own good deed be your reward.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.22)[9]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.177–180.

The sweetness of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes is revealed only in the sweet love of the gopīs —

যদ্যপি কৃষ্ণ-সৌন্দর্য্য — মাধুর্য্যের ধুর্য্য ।
ব্রজদেবীর সঙ্গে তাঁর বাড়য়ে মাধুর্য্য ॥ ৯৩ ॥

yadyapi kṛṣṇa-saundarya — mādhuryera dhurya
although Kṛṣṇa's beauty of sweetness the summit
vraja-devīra saṅge tāṁra bāḍaye mādhurya
of Vraja of the goddesses in the company His increases sweetness

93 Although Kṛṣṇa's beauty is the summit of sweetness, in the company of the goddesses of Vraja His sweetness increases still more.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The highest limit of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness lies in His beauty, which has no equal and nothing above it (*asamordhva*). Yet in the company of the goddesses of Vraja (*vraja-devīs*) that sweetness grows without end. Therefore love for Gopījana-vallabha, the beloved of the gopīs, is the essence of the goal for all devotees. In no other state of *rasa* does the devotee attain Kṛṣṇa as he does here, in the fullness of His sweetness.

Kṛṣṇa among the gopīs is like an emerald among jewels —

তত্রাতিশুশুভে তাভির্ভগবান্ দেবকীসুতঃ ।
মধ্যে মণীনাং হৈমানাং মহামারকতো যথা ॥ ৯৪ ॥

tatrātiśuśubhe tābhir
there shone exceedingly with them
bhagavān devakī-sutaḥ
Bhagavān Devakī's son
madhye maṇīnāṁ haimānāṁ
among gems golden
mahā-mārakato yathā
a great emerald like

94 "There, with them, Bhagavān, the son of Devakī, shone exceedingly, like a great emerald among golden gems." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.33.6)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Bhagavān, the son of Devakī, is the essence of all beauty. Yet among the goddesses of Vraja He shone with special splendor, like a great emerald (*marakata*) among golden jewels.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Śukadeva describes to Parīkṣit the beauty of Kṛṣṇa among the gopīs of the *rāsa-līlā*. **tatra** (in Vṛndāvana, in the circle of the *rāsa*) **haimānāṁ** (of jewels set in gold) **madhye mahā-marakataḥ yathā**, (so) **tābhiḥ** (surrounded by the goddesses of Vraja) **bhagavān devakī-sutaḥ atiśuśubhe**.

(c) Though the gopīs' love for Kṛṣṇa is the limit of the goal, the Lord asks again —

প্রভু কহে, এই — ‘সাধ্যাবধি’ সুনিশ্চয় ।
কৃপা করি’ কহ, যদি আগে কিছু হয় ॥ ৯৫ ॥

prabhu kahe, — ei ‘sādhyāvadhi’ suniścaya
the Lord said this the limit of the goal certainly
kṛpā kari’ kaha, yadi āge kichu haya
mercy showing say if further something there is

95 The Lord said, “This is certainly the limit of the goal. But be kind and tell Me if there is anything beyond.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Having heard these conclusions, Mahāprabhu said, “Love for Śrī Gopījana-vallabha is indeed the limit of the truth of the goal (*sādhya-tattva*). Still, if there is anything more, tell Me.”

*Rāmānanda realizes that the Lord who asks is the One who has no equal and none above Him (*asamordhva*) —*

রায় কহে, — ইহার আগে পুছে হেন জনে ।
এতদিন নাহি জানি, আছয়ে ভুবনে ॥ ৯৬ ॥

rāya kahe, — ihāra āge puche hena jane
Rāya said beyond this asks such a person
eta-dina nāhi jāni, āchaye bhuvane
till now not I knew exists in the world

96 Rāya said, “Until now I did not know that there was anyone in the world who would ask beyond this.

(d) Śrī Rādhā's love for Kṛṣṇa is the crest jewel of all goals —

ইঁহার মধ্যে রাধার প্রেম — ‘সাধ্যশিরোমণি’ ।
যাঁহার মহিমা সর্ব্বশাস্ত্রেতে বাখানি ॥ ৯৭ ॥

iṁhāra madhye rādhāra prema — ‘sādhya-śiromaṇi’
among these Rādhā’s love the crest-jewel of goals
yāṁhāra mahimā sarva-śāstrete vākhāni
whose glory in all the scriptures is praised

97 Among them all, Rādhā’s love is the crest-jewel of all goals; its glory is proclaimed in all the scriptures.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Of the love for Śrī Kṛṣṇa that all the gopīs share, Śrī Rādhā's love for Kṛṣṇa is the crest jewel of all goals (*sādhya-śiromaṇi*). Ordinary *jīvas* are given no instruction to take up the *bhāva* that belongs to Her position. In the perfected state, however, a *jīva* may become fit to take up a very exalted *bhāva* of love for Kṛṣṇa that follows that *bhāva*, that is, conforms to it. In the stage of practice one should follow the *bhāva* of Rādhikā's friends (*sakhīs*) and their maidservants. The *bhāva* of Rādhikā on seeing Uddhava, which was seen in Mahāprabhu, is beyond the *jīva's* reach, though it may be followed in some other form.

Like Śrī Rādhā, Śrī Rādhā-kuṇḍa too is dearest to Kṛṣṇa —

যথা রাধা প্রিয়া বিষ্ণোস্তস্যাঃ কুণ্ডং প্রিয়ং তথা ।
সর্ব্বগোপীষু সৈবৈকা বিষ্ণোরত্যন্তবল্লভা ॥ ৯৮ ॥

yathā rādhā priyā viṣṇos
as Rādhā dear to Viṣṇu
tasyāḥ kuṇḍaṁ priyaṁ tathā
Her pond dear so
sarva-gopīṣu saivaikā
among all gopīs She alone
viṣṇor atyanta-vallabhā
of Viṣṇu most beloved

98 "As Rādhā is dear to Viṣṇu, so is Her pond dear to Him; among all the gopīs She alone is His most beloved." (Padma Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 45)[10]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.215.

*The *Bhāgavata's* hint at Śrī Rādhā and Her being without a second —*

অনয়ারাধিতো নূনং ভগবান্ হরিরীশ্বরঃ ।
যন্নো বিহায় গোবিন্দঃ প্রীতো যামনয়দ্রহঃ ॥ ৯৯ ॥

anayārādhito nūnaṁ
by Her worshipped surely
bhagavān harir īśvaraḥ
Bhagavān Hari the Lord
yan no vihāya govindaḥ
since us leaving Govinda
prīto yām anayad rahaḥ
pleased whom led to a secret place

99 "Surely the Lord, Bhagavān Hari, has been worshipped by Her, for Govinda, pleased, has left us and led Her away to a secluded place." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.28)[11]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.88.

The Lord's delight; He praises Rāmānanda Rāya —

প্রভু কহে, — আগে কহ, শুনিতে পাই সুখে ।
অপূর্ব্বামৃত-নদী বহে তোমার মুখে ॥ ১০০ ॥

prabhu kahe — āge kaha, śunite pāi sukhe
the Lord said further speak hearing I obtain joy
apūrvāmṛta-nadī vahe tomāra mukhe
of wondrous nectar a river flows from your mouth

100 The Lord said, "Go on — I am happy to hear you. A river of wondrous nectar flows from your lips.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa's love for the peerless Śrī Rādhā, independent of all others —

চুরি করি' রাধাকে নিল গোপীগণের ডরে ।
অন্যাপেক্ষা হৈলে প্রেমের গাঢ়তা না স্ফুরে ॥ ১০১ ॥

curi kari' rādhāke nila gopī-gaṇera ḍare
secretly Rādhā He took away of the gopīs out of fear
anyāpekṣā haile premera gāḍhatā nā sphure
regard for others if there is of love the depth not shows

101 Fearing the other gopīs, He stole Rādhā away; for when there is regard for others, the depth of love does not show itself.

Kṛṣṇa's undivided love for Śrī Rādhā —

রাধা লাগি' গোপীরে যদি সাক্ষাৎ করে ত্যাগ ।
তবে জানি, — রাধায় কৃষ্ণের গাঢ়-অনুরাগ ॥ ১০২ ॥

rādhā lāgi' gopīre yadi sākṣāt kare tyāga
for Rādhā's sake the gopīs if openly He makes abandonment
tabe jāni, — rādhāya kṛṣṇera gāḍha-anurāga
then we know for Rādhā Kṛṣṇa's deep attachment

102 If for Rādhā's sake He openly abandons the other gopīs, then we know how deeply Kṛṣṇa is attached to Rādhā."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the *rāsa-līlā* Śrī Kṛṣṇa saw that while Rādhikā was together with all the other gopīs, His love for Her could not be independent (*nirapekṣa*). Because of regard for the others, the depth of love did not unfold. Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa, wary of the gopīs, stole Rādhikā away from the place of the *rāsa* dance and went off, apart from the other gopīs. The verse *kaṁsārir api* (verse 105) is the example here.

Śrī Rādhā's love for Kṛṣṇa has no comparison —

রায় কহে, — তবে শুন প্রেমের মহিমা ।
ত্রিজগতে রাধা প্রেমের নাহিক উপমা ॥ ১০৩ ॥

rāya kahe, — tabe śuna premera mahimā
Rāya said then hear of the love the glory
tri-jagate rādhā-premera nāhika upamā
in the three worlds of Rādhā's love there is no comparison

103 Rāya said, "Then hear the glory of that love. In the three worlds there is nothing to compare with Rādhā's love.

When the servant is not seen, the One she serves laments the loss of her service —

গোপীগণের রাস-নৃত্য-মণ্ডলী ছাড়িয়া ।
রাধা চাহি' বনে ফিরে বিলাপ করিয়া ॥ ১০৪ ॥

gopī-gaṇera rāsa-nṛtya-maṇḍalī chāḍiyā
of the gopīs of the rāsa dance the circle leaving
rādhā cāhi' vane phire vilāpa kariyā
Rādhā seeking in the forest He wanders lamenting doing

104 Leaving the circle of the gopīs' *rāsa* dance, He wandered through the forest in search of Rādhā, lamenting.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the circle of the *rāsa* Śrī Rādhikā saw the gopīs' *mamatā* — their sense of "He is mine," such as is found in ordinary love — and out of the contrariness born of [Her love's] crookedness (*kauṭilya-vāmatā*) She left the circle. Kṛṣṇa wanted

Śrīmatī to nourish the *rasa* of the *rāsa-līlā*. Without Her, Śrī Kṛṣṇa grew dejected and, lamenting, began to wander through the forest in search of Śrīmatī.

Śrī Rādhā is the very embodiment of loving service to Kṛṣṇa —

কংসারিরপি সংসারবাসনাবদ্ধশৃঙ্খলাম্ ।
রাধামাধায় হৃদয়ে তত্যাজ ব্রজসুন্দরীঃ ॥ ১০৫ ॥

kaṁsārir api saṁsāra-
the enemy of Kaṁsa too of the essence (of the rāsa)
vāsanā-baddha-śṛṅkhalām
by the desire bound the chain
rādhām ādhāya hṛdaye
Rādhā placing in the heart
tatyāja vraja-sundarīḥ
left of Vraja the beauties

105 "Placing Rādhā in His heart — the chain that bound His desire for the very essence of the *rāsa* — Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of Kaṁsa, left the other beauties of Vraja." (Gīta-govinda, 3.1)[12]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.219.

ইতস্ততস্তামনুসৃত্য রাধিকা-
মনঙ্গবাণব্রণখিন্নমানসঃ ।
কৃতানুতাপঃ স কলিন্দনন্দিনী-
তটান্তকুঞ্জে বিষসাদ মাধবঃ ॥ ১০৬ ॥

itas tatas tām anusṛtya rādhikām
here there Her searching for Rādhikā
anaṅga-bāṇa-vraṇa-khinna-mānasaḥ
of Ananga by the arrows by the wounds wearied in mind
kṛtānutāpaḥ sa kalinda-nandinī
filled with remorse He of Kalinda's daughter (the Yamunā)
taṭānta-kuñje viṣasāda mādhavaḥ
on the edge of the bank in a grove sank in despair Mādhava

106 "Searching here and there for Rādhikā, His mind wearied by the wounds of Ananga's arrows and filled with remorse, Mādhava sank down in despair in a grove on the edge of the Yamunā's bank." (Gīta-govinda, 3.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Mādhava's mind was wounded by the arrows of Anaṅga, and He was filled with remorse. In the forest on the bank of the Yamunā, the daughter of Kalinda, He searched everywhere for Rādhikā but did not find Her; then He entered a grove and gave way to grief.

Anubhāṣya.
anaṅga-bāṇa-vraṇa-khinna-mānasaḥ (He whose mind was worn by wounds from Kāma's arrows) **mādhavaḥ itas tataḥ tāṁ rādhikām anusṛtya** (searching for) **kṛtānutāpaḥ** (He by whom an *anu*, a later, pain [*tāpa*] was made, that is, incurred: overcome with grief for His own act of neglecting Rādhikā) **kalinda-nandinī-taṭānta-kuñje** (in a grove at the edge of the Yamunā's bank) **viṣasāda** (became despondent).

Reflection on these two verses —

এই দুই-শ্লোকের অর্থ বিচারিলে জানি ।
বিচারিতে উঠে যেন অমৃতের খনি ॥ ১০৭ ॥

ei dui-ślokera artha vicārile jāni
of these two verses the meaning if one considers we know
vicārite uṭhe yena amṛtera khani
in considering rises as if of nectar a mine

107 Reflect on the meaning of these two verses and it becomes clear; as one reflects, a mine of nectar seems to open up.

*The description of the *rāsa* —*

শতকোটি গোপী-সঙ্গে-রাসবিলাস ।
তার মধ্যে এক-মূর্ত্ত্যে রহে রাধা-পাশ ॥ ১০৮ ॥

śata-koṭi gopī-saṅge rāsa-vilāsa
hundreds of millions of gopīs with the rāsa pastime
tāra madhye eka-mūrtye rahe rādhā-pāśa
among them in one form He stays at Rādhā's side

108 In the *rāsa* pastime with hundreds of millions of gopīs, He stayed at Rādhā's side in one of His forms.

*Contrariness (*vāmatā*) predominates in Śrī Rādhā's love for Kṛṣṇa —*

সাধারণ-প্রেমে দেখি সর্ব্বত্র 'সমতা' ।
রাধার কুটিল-প্রেমে হইল 'বামতা' ॥ ১০৯ ॥

sādhāraṇa-preme dekhi sarvatra 'samatā'
in ordinary love we see everywhere equality
rādhāra kuṭila-preme haila 'vāmatā'
in Rādhā's winding love arose contrariness

109 In ordinary love one sees equality everywhere; but in Rādhā's winding love there arose contrariness (*vāmatā*).

*The crookedness (*kauṭilya*) of love for Kṛṣṇa —*

অহেরিব গতিঃ প্রেম্ণঃ স্বভাবকুটিলা ভবেৎ ।
অতো হেতোরহেতোশ্চ যূনোর্মান উদঞ্চতি ॥ ১১০ ॥

aher iva gatiḥ premṇaḥ
of a snake like the movement of love
svabhāva-kuṭilā bhavet
by nature winding is
ato hetor ahetoś ca
therefore with cause without cause and
yūnor māna udañcati
of the young pair pique arises

110 “Like the movement of a snake, the course of love is winding by nature. Therefore pique (*māna*) arises between the young lovers, with cause and without cause.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, Śṛṅgāra-bheda-kathana, 102)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the circle of the *rāsa* there was one form of Kṛṣṇa between every two gopīs, and one form of Kṛṣṇa beside Śrī Rādhikā; thus He manifested Himself. At this Rādhikā displayed the “contrariness” (*vāmatā*) of Her crooked love. The *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* says that love by nature moves crookedly, like a snake; therefore between a young man and a young woman *māna* of two kinds arises, “without cause” and “with cause.”

Anubhāṣya.
aheḥ (of a snake) **iva premṇaḥ gatiḥ svabhāva-kuṭilā** (bent by its very nature) **bhavet**; **ataḥ** (for this reason) **hetoḥ** (when a cause arises) **ahetoḥ ca** (and even when there is no cause) **yūnoḥ** (of the beloved and the Lover) **mānaḥ udañcati** (arises).

*Śrī Rādhā leaves the *rāsa*, and Kṛṣṇa searches for Her —*

ক্রোধ করি’ রাস ছাড়ি’ গেলা মান করি’ ।
তাঁরে না দেখিয়া ব্যাকুল হৈল শ্রীহরি ॥ ১১১ ॥

krodha kari’ rāsa chāḍi’ gelā māna kari’
anger showing the rāsa leaving She went pique showing
tāṁre nā dekhiyā vyākula haila śrī-hari
Her not seeing distressed became Śrī Hari

111 In anger and pique She left the *rāsa*, and Śrī Hari, not seeing Her, became distressed.

সম্যক্ বাসনা কৃষ্ণের ইচ্ছা রাসলীলা ।
রাসলীলা-বাসনাতে রাধিকা শৃঙ্খলা ॥ ১১২ ॥

samyak vāsanā kṛṣṇera icchā rāsa-līlā
the complete desire of Kṛṣṇa the wish the rāsa-līlā
rāsa-līlā-vāsanāte rādhikā śṛṅkhalā
in the desire for the rāsa-līlā Rādhikā the chain

112 Kṛṣṇa's whole desire is set on the *rāsa-līlā*, and in that desire Rādhikā is the chain that holds it all together.

তাঁহা বিনা রাসলীলা নাহি ভায় চিত্তে ।
মণ্ডলী ছাড়িয়া গেলা রাধা অন্বেষিতে ॥ ১১৩ ॥

tāṁhā vinā rāsa-līlā nāhi bhāya citte
Her without the rāsa-līlā not pleases the heart
maṇḍalī chāḍiyā gelā rādhā anveṣite
the circle leaving He went Rādhā to seek

113 Without Her the *rāsa-līlā* did not please His heart, so He left the circle and went to look for Rādhā.

Anubhāṣya.
See above the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* on verse 104.

ইতস্ততঃ ভ্রমিয়া কাঁহা রাধা না পাঞা ।
বিষাদ করেন কামবাণে খিন্ন হঞা ॥ ১১৪ ॥

itas-tataḥ bhramiyā kāṁhā rādhā nā pāñā
here and there wandering nowhere Rādhā not finding
viṣāda karena kāma-bāṇe khinna hañā
despair He shows by Kāma's arrows wearied becoming

114 Wandering here and there and finding Rādhā nowhere, He fell into despair, wearied by the arrows of the god of love (Kāma).

Śrī Rādhikā, the embodiment of the fulfillment of Kṛṣṇa's desires, has no equal and none above Her —

শতকোটি-গোপীতে নহে কাম-নির্ব্বাপণ ।
তাহাতেই অনুমানি শ্রীরাধিকার গুণ ॥ ১১৫ ॥

śata-koṭi-gopīte nahe kāma-nirvāpaṇa
by hundreds of millions of gopīs not of desire the quenching
tāhātei anumāni śrī rādhikāra guṇa
from that we infer of Śrī Rādhikā the qualities

115 Even hundreds of millions of gopīs could not quench His desire. From this we can infer the qualities of Śrī Rādhikā."

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.68–97, and also 122–143, 214–219, 239–262.

Before Rāmānanda, the speaker, the Lord takes the role of a listener and the attitude of a disciple —

প্রভু কহে, — যে লাগি' আইলাম তোমা-স্থানে ।
সেই সব তত্ত্ববস্তু হৈল মোর জ্ঞানে ॥ ১১৬ ॥

prabhu kahe — ye lāgi' āilāma tomā-sthāne
the Lord said for which I came to you
sei saba tattva-vastu haila mora jñāne
all those truths became My known

116 The Lord said, "All the truths for which I came to you have now become known to Me.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 8, verse 1.

Thus far the Lord has heard of the stages of worship of Kṛṣṇa —

এবে জানিলুঁ সেব্য-সাধন-নির্ণয় ।
আগে আর আছে কিছু, শুনিতে মন হয় ॥ ১১৭ ॥

ebe jāniluṁ sevya-sādhana-nirṇaya
now I have known of the One to be served of the means the determination
āge āra āche kichu, śunite mana haya
further more there is something to hear the desire is

117 Now I know who is to be served and by what means. Yet there is something more beyond, and I wish to hear it.[13]

Anubhāṣya.
A variant reading: *sādhya-sādhana-nirṇaya* (instead of *sevya-sādhana-nirṇaya*).

*The Lord's question: He asks Rāmānanda to describe the true nature of (1) Kṛṣṇa, (2) Rādhā, (3) *rasa* and (4) *prema* —*

'কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ' কহ 'রাধার স্বরূপ' ।
'রস' — কোন্ তত্ত্ব, 'প্রেম' — কোন্ তত্ত্বরূপ ॥ ১১৮ ॥

'kṛṣṇera svarūpa' kaha 'rādhāra svarūpa'
Kṛṣṇa's nature tell Rādhā's nature
'rasa' kon tattva, 'prema' — kon tattva-rūpa
rasa what truth prema of what truth the form

118 Tell Me the true nature of Kṛṣṇa and the true nature of Rādhā; what truth *rasa* is, and of what truth *prema* is the form.

কৃপা করি' এই তত্ত্ব কহ ত' আমারে ।
তোমা-বিনা কেহ ইহা নিরূপিতে নারে ॥ ১১৯ ॥

kṛpā kari' ei tattva kaha ta' āmāre
mercy showing this truth tell indeed to Me
tomā-vinā keha ihā nirūpite nāre
besides you no one this to explain is able

119 Be kind and tell Me these truths: no one but you can explain them."

Rāmānanda considers himself the "instrument" and the Lord "the One who

plays it” —

রায় কহে, — ইহা আমি কিছুই না জানি ।
তুমি যেই কহাও, সেই কহি বাণী ॥ ১২০ ॥

rāya kahe, — ihā āmi kichui nā jāni
Rāya said of this I anything not know
tumi yei kahāo, sei kahi vāṇī
You whatever make (me) say that I speak words

120 Rāya said, “I know nothing of this. I speak only the words You make me speak.

তোমার শিক্ষায় পড়ি যেন শুক-পাঠ ।
সাক্ষাৎ ঈশ্বর তুমি, কে বুঝে তোমার নাট ॥ ১২১ ॥

tomāra śikṣāya paḍi yena śuka-pāṭha
by Your teaching I recite like a parrot’s lesson
sākṣāt īśvara tumi, ke bujhe tomāra nāṭa
directly the Lord You who understands Your play

121 I repeat Your teaching like a parrot reciting its lesson. You are the Lord Himself — who can understand Your play?

হৃদয়ে প্রেরণ কর, জিহ্বায় কহাও বাণী ।
কি কহিয়ে ভাল-মন্দ, কিছুই না জানি ॥ ১২২ ॥

hṛdaye preraṇa kara, jihvāya kahāo vāṇī
in the heart inspiration You give with the tongue You make (me) speak words
ki kahiye bhāla-manda, kichui nā jāni
what I say good or bad anything not I know

122 You inspire my heart and make my tongue speak the words; I do not know at all whether what I say is good or bad.”

Calling Himself “averse to Kṛṣṇa” and “wretched,” the Lord tries to trick

Rāmānanda —

প্রভু কহে, — মায়াবাদী আমি ত' সন্ন্যাসী ।
ভক্তিতত্ত্ব নাহি জানি, মায়াবাদে ভাসি ॥ ১২৩ ॥

prabhu kahe, — māyāvādī āmi ta' sannyāsī
the Lord said a Māyāvādī I indeed sannyāsī
bhakti-tattva nāhi jāni, māyāvāde bhāsi
of bhakti the truth not I know in Māyāvāda I float

123 The Lord said, "I am a Māyāvādī sannyāsī. I do not know the truth of *bhakti*; I am adrift in Māyāvāda.

*The Lord speaks of what distinguishes Sārvabhauma and Rāmānanda and of the difference between them: Sārvabhauma is a brāhmaṇa who grants liberation; Rāmānanda is a knower of the truth of Kṛṣṇa, an ācārya who performs *kīrtana*, a Vaiṣṇava —*

সার্ব্বভৌম-সঙ্গে মোর মন নির্ম্মল হৈল ।
'কৃষ্ণভক্তি-তত্ত্ব কহ', তাঁহারে পুছিল ॥ ১২৪ ॥

sārvabhauma-saṅge mora mana nirmala haila
in Sārvabhauma's company My mind pure became
'kṛṣṇa-bhakti-tattva kaha', tāṁhāre puchila
of Kṛṣṇa-bhakti the truth tell him I asked

124 In Sārvabhauma's company My mind became pure, and I asked him, 'Tell Me the truth of devotion to Kṛṣṇa.'

তিঁহো কহে, — আমি নাহি জানি কৃষ্ণকথা ।
সবে রামানন্দ জানে, তিঁহো নাহি এথা ॥ ১২৫ ॥

tiṁho kahe — āmi nāhi jāni kṛṣṇa-kathā
he said I not know about Kṛṣṇa talks
sabe rāmānanda jāne, tiṁho nāhi ethā
only Rāmānanda knows he not here

125 He said, ‘I do not know the talks about Kṛṣṇa. Only Rāmānanda knows them, and he is not here.’

The Vaiṣṇava who plays the part of a “deceiver” —

তোমার ঠাঞি আইলাঙ তোমার মহিমা শুনিয়া ।
তুমি মোরে স্তুতি কর ‘সন্ন্যাসী’ জানিয়া ॥ ১২৬ ॥

tomāra ṭhāñi āilāṅa tomāra mahimā śuniyā
to you I came your glory hearing
tumi more stuti kara ‘sannyāsī’ jāniyā
you Me praise a sannyāsī considering

126 Hearing of your glory, I came to you — and you praise Me, thinking of Me as a sannyāsī.

Anubhāṣya.

The guru-Vaiṣṇava is rich with the treasure of transcendental love for Kṛṣṇa, and to him the worth of external material wealth is utterly trifling. Therefore one who seeks the highest good (*niḥśreyas*) and tries to become a disciple of the guru-Vaiṣṇava should never parade before him the arrogance of worldly intoxication. Sometimes a person, relying on his pride of wealth, learning and beauty, comes before the guru-Vaiṣṇava only in appearance, but in reality does not approach him with obeisance, sincere inquiry and service. Then the Vaiṣṇava too gives him the outward honor he desires and sends him away. Regarding him as a non-brāhmaṇa or a *śūdra*, the Vaiṣṇava never gives him divine knowledge, that is, the transcendental realization of one's relationship with Kṛṣṇa. As a result, that person is cheated of the highest goal and goes straight down the road to hell. This is what Śrī Gaurasundara taught as the ācārya, the guru of the world. In the eyes of worldly people He Himself stood in the highest position of *varṇāśrama-dharma* (the brāhmaṇa *varṇa* and the *sannyāsa āśrama*), and He showed Śrī Rāmānanda Prabhu standing lower than Himself (in the *śūdra varṇa* and the householder *āśrama*). In this way He warned the foolish *jīvas*, struck down by Kali, for whom knowledge born of the senses is everything, against such folly.

Whatever his position, only a knower of the truth of Kṛṣṇa gives divine

knowledge —

কিবা বিপ্র, কিবা ন্যাসী, শূদ্র কেনে নয়।
যেই কৃষ্ণতত্ত্ববেত্তা, সেই 'গুরু' হয় ॥ ১২৭ ॥

kibā vipra, kibā nyāsī, śūdra kene naya
whether a vipra whether a sannyāsī a śūdra why not
yei kṛṣṇa-tattva-vettā, sei 'guru' haya
whoever of Kṛṣṇa the truth knows he a guru is

127 Whether one is a *vipra*, a *sannyāsī* or a *śūdra* — whoever knows the truth of Kṛṣṇa is a guru.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Lord said, "Do not think that since I was born in a brāhmaṇa family and have taken *sannyāsa*, it is improper for Me to learn *dharma* from *śūdras*." For a brāhmaṇa guru is needed only for instruction in the *dharma* of *varṇāśrama* and for initiation (*dīkṣā*). But the knowledge of the truth of Kṛṣṇa is the highest goal (*paramārtha*) of all *jīvas*. When one asks who is qualified to be the guru of this knowledge of the truth, the conclusion is simply this: whether brāhmaṇa or *śūdra* by birth, householder or *sannyāsī*, only one who knows the truth of Kṛṣṇa can be a guru. The *Śrī Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* says that one should not take a Kṛṣṇa mantra from a person of low *varṇa* while a qualified person of high *varṇa* is available. That statement, however, is meant for Vaiṣṇavas who are mindful of public opinion, that is, for those who live in the world and wish to aim in some measure at the highest goal by the accepted rules. For those who know the purport of *vaidhī* and *rāgānugā bhakti* and wish to attain pure devotion to Kṛṣṇa, the rule is to choose as guru a qualified knower of the truth of Kṛṣṇa, in whatever *varṇa* or *āśrama* he may be found. The *Śrī Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* quotes the *Padma Purāṇa*: "The devotees of Bhagavān are not *śūdras*; they are the best of *bhāgavatas*. In every *varṇa*, the *śūdras* are those who are not devoted to Janārdana. A brāhmaṇa expert in the six duties and learned in mantras and *tantras* cannot be a guru if he is not a Vaiṣṇava; a Vaiṣṇava, even a dog-eater, is a guru. Even one born in a great family, initiated into all the sacrifices and studying a thousand branches [of the Vedas] cannot be a guru if he is not a Vaiṣṇava. Brāhmaṇas, *kṣatriyas* and *vaiśyas* are the gurus of those born *śūdras*; and *śūdras* who are dear to Bhagavān are the gurus of those three."

Anubhāṣya.

Whether by *varṇa* he is a brāhmaṇa or a *kṣatriya*, *vaiśya* or *śūdra*, whether by *āśrama* he is a *sannyāsī*, *brahmacārī*, *vānaprastha* or householder — in whatever *varṇa* or *āśrama* he may be, only a knower of the truth of Kṛṣṇa can be a guru, that is, one who shows the path, a *dīkṣā-guru* and a *śikṣā-guru*. A guru's qualification depends only on his knowledge of the truth of Kṛṣṇa, not on *varṇa* or *āśrama*. This order of Śrī Mahāprabhu does not contradict the orders of scripture. In keeping with this purport, Śrī Viśvambhara Mahāprabhu received initiation from the *sannyāsī* Śrī Īśvara Purī, Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu from the *sannyāsī* Mādhavendra Purī Gosvāmī (according to another opinion, from Śrīmad Lakṣmīpati Tīrtha), and Śrī Advaita Ācārya from that same *sannyāsī* Śrī Mādhavendra Purī. Śrī Rasikānanda received *pāñcarātrika* initiation from Śrī Śyāmānanda, who was not born in a family of brāhmaṇas by birth; Śrī Gaṅgānārāyaṇa Cakravartī and Śrī Rāmakṛṣṇa Bhaṭṭācārya from Śrīla Narottama Ṭhākura, who also was not born in a family of brāhmaṇas by birth; and Śrī Yadunandana Cakravartī of Kāṭoyā from Śrī Gadādhara dāsa. Nothing prevented many others, such as Dharma-vyādha, from being *śikṣā-gurus*.

The *Mahābhārata* orders this clearly, and the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* says the same: “Whatever marks are declared to reveal a person's *varṇa*, if they are seen in someone else as well, he should be designated by that very [*varṇa*].” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.11.32[39]) The verb here stands in the injunctive mood (*vidhi-liṅ*). Therefore, for one who follows the conviction of the Vaiṣṇavas, it is natural to recognize a knower of the truth of Kṛṣṇa as a brāhmaṇa by conduct (*vṛtta-brāhmaṇa*). And where, by the custom current in Kali, there is no brāhmaṇa status without a connection by seed, even a *śūdra* by birth, if he knows the truth of Kṛṣṇa, attains brāhmaṇa status according to scripture and can become a guru. This is what Śrī Mahāprabhu subtly explained.

Those knowers of the truth of Kṛṣṇa who do not accept the *sāvitrya-saṁskāra* described in Kātyāyana's “*guhya-sūtra*”[40] of the Vedic Vājasaneya branch are simply *daikṣya* brāhmaṇas of the Ekāyana branch. But foolish people often fail to understand that they are “brāhmaṇas of Acyuta,” and go to hell. For this reason, in the family of Rasikānanda Prabhu, in the family of Śrī Mukunda dāsa of Śrīkhaṇḍa and in the family of Navanī Hoḍa, the *sāvitrya* brāhmaṇa *saṁskāra* has been performed from time immemorial, together with the work of ācāryas for a *sampradāya* whose disciples are brāhmaṇas by birth. Vaiṣṇavas whose joy is *bhajana* (*bhajanānandīs*) did not accept the *sāvitrya-saṁskāra*, but it does

not follow that their example is the only rule. Vaiṣṇavas determine *varṇa* by its marks. Fools, however, cannot determine *varṇa* by such marks, and therefore Śrī Mahāprabhu explained the purport of scripture clearly.

The conclusion collected in the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* agrees with Śrī Mahāprabhu's own example and teaching, yet to a fool they seem different. In his judgment the word “guru” in this verse means only the *śravaṇa-guru* or the *śikṣā-guru* in *bhajana*, not the guru who gives *dīkṣā* or mantra. For in his opinion the right to give divine knowledge is determined and certified by family descent, that is, by blood or seed. So in his view devotion to Kṛṣṇa, the natural function of the pure self, is not independent. What is more, by his foolishness the superiority and greatness of the *dīkṣā-guru*, the giver of mantra, exceed those of the “*śravaṇa-guru*” or the “*śikṣā-guru* in *bhajana*”! On this one should especially study the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 1.47. In fact such a notion is merely the fruit of an offense born of sense-derived knowledge.

The Lord asks Rāmānanda to glorify the truth of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa —

‘সন্ন্যাসী’ বলিয়া মোরে না করিহ বঞ্চন ।
কৃষ্ণ-রাধা-তত্ত্ব কহি’ পূর্ণ কর মন ॥ ১২৮ ॥

‘sannyāsī’ baliyā more nā kariha vañcana
a sannyāsī calling (Me) Me not do deceive
kṛṣṇa-rādhā-tattva kahi’ pūrṇa kara mana
of Kṛṣṇa of Rādhā the truth telling fulfil (My) heart

128 Do not deceive Me by treating Me as a sannyāsī. Tell Me the truth of Kṛṣṇa and Rādhā and fulfil My heart’s desire.”

*The Lord's *māyā* bewilders even the greatest sages, but Rāmānanda, who knows the real truth, is steady and composed —*

যদ্যপি রায় — প্রেমী, মহাভাগবতে ।
তাঁর মন কৃষ্ণমায়া নারে আচ্ছাদিতে ॥ ১২৯ ॥

yadyapi rāya — premī, mahā-bhāgavate
although Rāya full of love a great devotee
tāṁra mana kṛṣṇa-māyā nāre ācchādite
his mind Kṛṣṇa's māyā cannot cover

129 Rāya was full of *prema*, a great devotee; Kṛṣṇa's *māyā* could not cover his mind.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.85–89.

*The servant moves by the power of the Lord's will, and this is not servitude to *māyā*: it shows the sovereignty of the Lord's will-power and Rāmānanda's submission —*

তথাপি প্রভুর ইচ্ছা — পরম প্রবল ।
জানিলেহ রায়ের মন হৈল টলমল ॥ ১৩০ ॥

tathāpi prabhura icchā — parama prabala
still of the Lord the will supremely powerful
jānileha rāyera mana haila ṭalamala
though he knew Rāya's mind became unsteady

130 Yet the Lord's will is supremely powerful, and, though he knew the truth, Rāya's mind began to waver.

রায় কহে, — আমি — নট, তুমি — সূত্রধার ।
যেই মত নাচাও, সেই মত চাহি নাচিবার ॥ ১৩১ ॥

rāya kahe, — āmi — naṭa, tumi — sūtra-dhāra
Rāya said I a dancer You the puppeteer
yei mata nācāo, sei mata cāhi nācibāra
in whatever way You make (me) dance in that way I wish to dance

131 Rāya said, "I am a dancer, and You are the master of the stage (*sūtra-dhāra*): as You make me dance, so I wish to dance.

Anubhāṣya.

Sūtradhāra: “One who, entering the stage, first indicates the thread (*sūtra*) [of the action] to be performed is called the *sūtradhāra*.” He is the chief actor, who opens the play.

মোর জিহ্বা — বীণাযন্ত্র, তুমি — বীণা-ধারী ।
তোমার মনে যেই উঠে, তাহাই উচ্চারি ॥ ১৩২ ॥

mora jihvā — vīṇā-yantra, tumi — vīṇā-dhārī
my tongue a vīṇā the instrument You the player of the vīṇā
tomāra mane yei uṭhe, tāhāi uccāri
in Your mind whatever rises that alone I utter

132 My tongue is a *vīṇā*, and You are the one who plays it: whatever rises in Your mind, that alone I utter.

(1) The description of the truth of Kṛṣṇa begins; Kṛṣṇa's true nature —

পরম ঈশ্বর কৃষ্ণ — স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ।
সর্ব্ব-অবতারী, সর্ব্বকারণ-প্রধান ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

parama īśvara kṛṣṇa — svayaṁ bhagavān
supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself Bhagavān
sarva-avatārī, sarva-kāraṇa-pradhāna
the source of all avatāras of all causes the chief

133 Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Lord, Bhagavān Himself, the source of all *avatāras* and the foremost cause of all causes.

অনন্ত বৈকুণ্ঠ, আর অনন্ত অবতার ।
অনন্ত ব্রহ্মাণ্ড ইঁহা, — সবার আধার ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

ananta vaikuṇṭha, āra ananta avatāra
endless Vaikuṇṭhas and endless avatāras
ananta brahmāṇḍa iṁhā, — sabāra ādhāra
endless universes He of all the support

134 Endless are the Vaikuṇṭhas, endless the *avatāras* and endless the universes, and He is the support of them all.

সচ্চিদানন্দ-তনু, ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ।
সর্ব্বৈশ্বর্য্য-সর্ব্বশক্তি-সর্ব্বরস-পূর্ণ ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

sac-cid-ānanda-tanu, vrajendra-nandana
of being knowledge bliss His body of the king of Vraja the son
sarvaiśvarya-sarvaśakti-sarvarasa-pūrṇa
with all majesty with all potencies with all rasas full

135 His body is eternal being, knowledge and bliss; He is the son of the king of Vraja, full of all majesty, all potencies and all *rasas*.

ঈশ্বরঃ পরমঃ কৃষ্ণঃ সচ্চিদানন্দবিগ্রহঃ ।
অনাদিরাদির্গোবিন্দঃ সর্ব্বকারণকারণম্ ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

īśvaraḥ paramaḥ kṛṣṇaḥ
the Lord Supreme Kṛṣṇa
sac-cid-ānanda-vigrahaḥ
of being knowledge bliss whose form
anādir ādir govindaḥ
without beginning the beginning Govinda
sarva-kāraṇa-kāraṇam
of all causes the cause

136 "Kṛṣṇa, Govinda, is the Supreme Lord; His form is eternal being, knowledge and bliss. He has no beginning, yet He is the beginning of all, the cause of all causes." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.1)[14]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.107.

Madana-mohana, the form eternally served in Vraja —

বৃন্দাবনে 'অপ্রাকৃত নবীন মদন' ।
কামগায়ত্রী-কামবীজে যাঁর উপাসন ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

vṛndāvane 'aprākṛta navīna madana'
in Vṛndāvana transcendental ever-new Madana (Cupid)
kāma-gāyatrī kāma-bīje yāṁra upāsana
by the Kāma-gāyatrī with the Kāma-bīja whose worship

137 In Vṛndāvana He is the transcendental, ever-new Madana, worshipped with the Kāma-gāyatrī and the Kāma-bīja.

Anubhāṣya.

Vṛndāvana — the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (Chapter 5, verse 56) says: "There the beloveds are Lakṣmīs, and the Lover is the Supreme Person; the trees are wish-fulfilling trees, the earth is made of multitudes of *cintāmaṇi* gems, the water is nectar; speech there is song, walking is dance, the flute is the dear companion; the light is spiritual bliss, and that supreme [reality] is what is relished. There a great ocean of milk flows from the *surabhi* [cows], and time does not pass away, not even half a blink of an eye. I worship that Śvetadvīpa, which only a few saints, rarely wandering on this earth, know as Goloka."

[The meaning of the verse:] "In the transcendental Vṛndāvana everything is spiritual. The transcendental Lakṣmīs, that is, the gopīs, are the beloveds; the Supreme Person, Kṛṣṇa, is the Lover of all. The trees there are wish-fulfilling trees, the ground is full of *cintāmaṇi* gems, the water is nectar, speech is song, walking is dance, the flute is the dear companion; all that shines — the moon, the sun and the rest — is full of spiritual bliss. It is this transcendental, spiritual mood that one should relish and cultivate. There an ocean of milk flows from the spiritual cows. There even half a blink of an eye is eternity; in other words, time there does not pass in vain and turn into another time. This abode of Vṛndāvana, manifest in the world, that Śvetadvīpa which a few rare saints who know the truth of Kṛṣṇa know as Goloka — that is what I worship."

Vṛndāvana cannot be seen through earthly knowledge, which one gains and enjoys with one's own material senses guided by a material intellect; for the transcendental Vṛndāvana is the transcendental field of Kṛṣṇa's transcendental pastimes. Śrīla Narottama Ṭhākura sings in his *Prārthanā*: "When will Nitāicānd bestow His mercy on me? When will the desires of worldly life become trifling to me? When will my mind give up the objects of the senses and become pure? When shall I behold Śrī Vṛndāvana? When will longing for the feet of Rūpa and Raghunātha arise in me? When shall I understand the love of the Divine Couple?" See Madhya 14.219–226.

Aprākṛta navīna madana (the transcendental, ever-new Madana). *Kāma* exists in both states: in the material, worldly one, and in its opposite, the spiritual, transcendental one. But material *kāma* is disturbed by time: it is felt only at the moment it appears, and the next moment it fades and is gone. Transcendental *kāma*, however, is ever new: in time it has no end, and it shines always. The *kāma* perceptible to the material senses is a movement of the material body and mind. It is present in the nature of every *jīva* who has turned away from Kṛṣṇa and is bent on gratifying his senses, but it is only momentary. And the Madana whom the spiritual senses serve is Kṛṣṇacandra, Manmatha-manmatha: He is ever new, He is the *svayaṁ-rūpa*, the original form.

Kāma-gāyatrī. "You are called *gāyatrī* because you save the one who sings [you]" — that is, that which saves the singer or gives salvation through singing. (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 21.125): "The form of the Kāma-gāyatrī mantra is Kṛṣṇa's own form. It has twenty-four and a half syllables; those syllables are moons, and, making Kṛṣṇa rise, they have filled the three worlds with longing for Him (*kāma*)." [The mantra itself:] "*Klīṁ.* Let us know Kāmadeva; let us meditate on Puṣpabāṇa; may that Anaṅga inspire us." Kāmadeva (see verse 187), that is, Kṛṣṇa as Madana-mohana, is the Deity who is the Lord of *sambandha*; Puṣpabāṇa, that is, Govinda, is the Lord of *abhidheya*; and Anaṅga, that is, Gopījana-vallabha, is the Lord of *prayojana*. The *kāma-gāyatrī* is transcendental. The *sādhaka* worships Kṛṣṇa in transcendental realization, relying on the transcendental composition [of the mantra].

The *Brahma-saṁhitā* (Chapter 5, verses 27–28) says: "Then the movement of the sound of the flute, the embodiment of the three Vedas, appeared and at once entered the lotus mouths of Svayambhū. The lotus-born, receiving from it the *gāyatrī* as it was sung, and purified by the original guru, became twice-born. Then Vidhi, awakened by the three Vedas, having come to know the ocean of truth, praised Keśava with this hymn, the essence of the Vedas." Then the movement of the sound of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's flute, the embodiment of the three Vedas (the mother of the Vedas, of three times eight syllables, threefold, that is, consisting of *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana*), appeared and suddenly entered the lotus mouths of Svayambhū Brahmā. Brahmā, born of the lotus, received initiation into the *gāyatrī* that came forth from the song of the flute, and the original guru, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, performed for him the rite of the twice-born (see the commentary of Śrī Jīva Prabhu). Awakened by remembering the *gāyatrī* — the embodiment of the three Vedas, that is, endowed with *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* —

Brahmā became immersed in the ocean of truth, that is, attained realization. With that hymn, the essence of the Vedas, he served Keśava and won His love.

Kāma-bīja — the transcendental "*klīṁ*." The *Brahma-saṁhitā* (Chapter 5, verse 3) says: "…[that] which abides in the *rasa* of the great bliss, the bliss of *prema*, and is joined with the mantra shining as light, the *kāma-bīja*." With the transcendental *kāma-gāyatrī* joined to the transcendental *kāma-bīja*, one performs transcendental worship of the transcendental, ever-new form of Madana-mohana. Thus the *Gopāla-tāpanī Upaniṣad* says: "And the worship (*rasana*) is this: beginning with the *kāma* [*bīja*] formed by the union of water, earth, [fire] and the moon, '*kṛṣṇāya*' is the first word, '*govindāya*' the second, '*gopījana*' the third, '*vallabhāya*' the fourth, '*svāhā*' the fifth. Chanting this five-word [mantra] with its five limbs — heaven and earth, sun and moon together with fire — one attains Brahman in that form." The commentary of Śrī Viśvanātha Cakravartī: "'Water' is the syllable *ka*, because it denotes water; 'earth' is the syllable *la*, because *la* is its *bīja*; '*ī*,' the long *ī*, is fire, because it arises in the joining of sounds (*sandhi*); the 'moon' is the *anusvāra*, because it resembles it in shape. Their union is their joining; the *kāma-bīja* born of that joining comes first, and '*kṛṣṇāya*' is one word — this is the meaning." In other words, the *bīja* "*klīṁ*" is manifested by the joining of water (the syllable *ka*), earth (the syllable *la*), *ī* (the long *ī*, or fire) and the moon (the *anusvāra*). Placing this *bīja* "*klīṁ*" at the beginning of the Kṛṣṇa mantra, one worships the Supreme Brahman named Kṛṣṇa — the *rasana*, that is, the worship that pleases Him. See Ādi 5.212–214, 219, 221–222.

The attracting power of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness —

পুরুষ, যোষিত্, কিবা স্থাবর-জঙ্গম ।
সর্ব্ব-চিত্তাকর্ষক, সাক্ষাৎ মন্মথ-মদন ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

puruṣa, yoṣit, kibā sthāvara-jaṅgama
men women or the unmoving and the moving
sarva-cittākarṣaka, sākṣāt manmatha-madana
of all the hearts attracting directly of Cupid the enchanter

138 He draws the hearts of all — men and women, the moving and the unmoving; He is the very enchanter of Cupid.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In Vṛndāvana, the abode made of spirit, Śrī Kṛṣṇa is present in the form of the ever-new Madana, beyond *prakṛti*. By the word *madana* worldly poets usually mean *kāma* as it is in the material world — the mutual attraction of lumps of flesh, a principle utterly material and base. Bound by matter, the *jīvas* have identified themselves with the body and accepted the rule of that *kāma*. When a *jīva* comes to know the truth of his relationship with Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-sambandha-tattva*), he attains a transcendental, spiritual position. That position is of two kinds: *svarūpa-gata* (in one's own true nature) and *vastu-gata* (in actual fact). Sometimes the *jīva* has already realized the truth, but "in actual fact" his connection with matter has not yet gone. If in such a state the spiritual truth has dawned in him to some degree, he dwells in Vṛndāvana "in his true nature," but not "in actual fact." When by Kṛṣṇa's will even the trace of his connection with gross and subtle matter is gone, he dwells in Vṛndāvana "in actual fact." Dwelling in one's true nature includes *sādhana*: then the *jīva* worships Kṛṣṇa with the spiritual *kāma-gāyatrī* and the spiritual *kāma-bīja*. Man and woman, the moving and the unmoving — Kṛṣṇa, who captivates every heart, whose very nature is Manmatha-manmatha, the Cupid of Cupid, attracts them all.

The *kāma-gāyatrī* is a particular Vedic mantra of twenty-four and a half syllables. The *kāma-bīja* is the seed syllable (*bīja*) that is chanted in the worship of Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 4.147–148.

তাসামাবিরভূচ্ছৌরিঃ স্ময়মানমুখাম্বুজঃ ।
পীতাম্বরধরঃ স্রগ্বী সাক্ষান্মন্মথ-মন্মথঃ ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

tāsām āvirabhūc chauriḥ
among them appeared Śauri
smayamāna-mukhāmbujaḥ
smiling lotus-faced
pītāmbara-dharaḥ sragvī
yellow garments wearing garlanded
sākṣān manmatha-manmathaḥ
directly of Cupid the enchanter

139 “Among them appeared Śauri (Kṛṣṇa), His lotus face smiling, wearing yellow garments and a garland — the very enchanter of Cupid.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.2)[15]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 5.214.

নানা-ভক্তের রসামৃত নানাবিধ হয় ।
সেই সব রসামৃতের ‘বিষয়’ ‘আশ্রয়’ ॥ ১৪০ ॥

nānā-bhaktera rasāmṛta nānā-vidha haya
of various devotees the nectar of rasa of various kinds is
sei saba rasāmṛtera ‘viṣaya’ ‘āśraya’
of all those nectars of rasa the object the abode

140 Different devotees taste different kinds of the nectar of *rasa*; in all of them Kṛṣṇa is the object (*viṣaya*), and the devotee the abode (*āśraya*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the five kinds of worship through the nectar of *rasa* described above, the devotee is the *āśraya* (the abode) of that *rasa*, and Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the object of worship, is its *viṣaya* (the object).

Anubhāṣya.
Viṣaya — Kṛṣṇa. ***Āśraya*** — the devotee, the abode of *rasa*.

Glory to the Beloved of Vārṣabhānavī —

অখিলরসামৃতমূর্ত্তিঃ প্রসৃমর-রুচিরুদ্ধ-তারকা-পালিঃ ।
কলিত-শ্যামা-ললিতো রাধাপ্রেয়ান্ বিধুর্জয়তি ॥ ১৪১ ॥

akhila-rasāmṛta-mūrtiḥ
of all rasas of the nectar the embodiment
prasṛmara-ruci-ruddha-tārakā-pāliḥ
by His spreading radiance who has subdued Tārakā Pāli
kalita-śyāmā-lalito
who has made His own Śyāmā Lalitā
rādhā-preyān vidhur jayati
to Rādhā most dear the moon may He be glorious

141 "Glory to the Moon, the embodiment of the nectar of all *rasas*, who with His spreading radiance has subdued Tārakā and Pāli, who has won Śyāmā and Lalitā, and who is dearest to Rādhā!" (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.1.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
(*Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*) May Śrī Kṛṣṇacandra be victorious — the embodiment of the nectar of all *rasas*, who with His spreading radiance captivated the two *sakhīs* named Tārakā and Pāli, who won over Śyāmā and the *sakhī* Lalitā, and who is supremely dear to Rādhā. The purport is this: in whatever *rasa* one worships Him, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, though He is the embodiment of the nectar of that *rasa*, is the one supreme object (*viṣaya*) of Rādhikā's *rasa* alone.

Anubhāṣya.
akhila-rasāmṛta-mūrtiḥ (He whose form is the nectar, that is, the highest bliss, containing all the *rasas*: the five principal ones beginning with *śānta* and the seven secondary ones beginning with *hāsya*) **prasṛmara-ruci-ruddha-tārakā-pāliḥ** (He who with His spreading, that is, expanding, radiance captured, that is, subdued, Tārakā and Pāli) **kalita-śyāmā-lalitaḥ** (He who made Śyāmā and Lalitā His own) **rādhā-preyān** (dearest to Rādhā) **vidhuḥ** (Kṛṣṇacandra) **jayati**.

Kṛṣṇa's sweetness captivates Kṛṣṇa Himself —

শৃঙ্গার-রসরাজময়-মূর্ত্তিধর ।
অতএব আত্মপর্য্যন্ত-সর্ব্ব-চিত্ত-হর ॥ ১৪২ ॥

śṛṅgāra-rasarāja-maya-mūrti-dhara
of śṛṅgāra the king of rasas made of a form bearing
ataeva ātma-paryanta-sarva-citta-hara
therefore up to Himself of all the hearts stealing

142 He bears a form made of *śṛṅgāra*, the king of *rasas*; therefore He steals all hearts, even His own.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śṛṅgāra is the king of *rasas* (*rasa-rāja*), and Śrī Kṛṣṇa bears a form made of it. Therefore Kṛṣṇa's beautiful form steals the heart even of Kṛṣṇa Himself.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.144 and 222.

Kṛṣṇa, who eternally sports with the beauties of Vraja —

বিশ্বেষামনুরঞ্জনেন জনয়ন্নানন্দমিন্দীবর-
শ্রেণীশ্যামলকোমলৈরুপনয়ন্নঙ্গৈরনঙ্গোৎসবম্ ৷
স্বচ্ছন্দং ব্রজসুন্দরীভিরভিতঃ প্রত্যঙ্গমালিঙ্গিতঃ
শৃঙ্গারঃ সখি মূর্ত্তিমানিব মধৌ মুগ্ধো হরিঃ ক্রীড়তি ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

viśveṣām anurañjanena janayann ānandam indīvara-
of all by gladdening producing bliss of blue lotuses
śreṇī-śyāmala-komalair upanayann aṅgair ananaṅgotsavam
a row dark tender bringing with His limbs a festival of Ananga
svacchandaṁ vraja-sundarībhir abhitaḥ praty-aṅgam āliṅgitaḥ
freely by the Vraja beauties all around limb by limb embraced
śṛṅgāraḥ sakhi mūrtimān iva madhau mugdho hariḥ krīḍati
śṛṅgāra O friend embodied as it were in spring enchanted Hari sports

143 "O friend, see how Hari sports in spring! Delighting all and giving them bliss, with limbs dark and tender as a row of blue lotuses He brings a festival to the god of love; freely embraced on every side by the beauties of Vraja, He is, as it were, *śṛṅgāra* embodied, enchanted Himself." (Gīta-govinda, 1.11)[16]

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 4.224.

The sweetness of Kṛṣṇa's form attracts Nārāyaṇa and even Lakṣmī —

লক্ষ্মীকান্তাদি অবতারের হরে মন ।
লক্ষ্মী-আদি নারীগণের করে আকর্ষণ ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

lakṣmī-kāntādi avatārera hare mana
of Lakṣmī's Lord and other avatāras He steals the mind
lakṣmī-ādi nārī-gaṇera kare ākarṣaṇa
of Lakṣmī and other women He makes attraction

144 He steals the minds of *avatāras* such as the Lord of Lakṣmī, and He attracts women such as Lakṣmī.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 5.223 and Madhya 9.111–156.

দ্বিজাত্মজা মে যুবয়োর্দিদৃক্ষুণা
ময়োপনীতা ভুবি ধর্ম্মগুপ্তয়ে ।
কলাবতীর্ণাববনের্ভরাসুরান্
হত্বেহ ভূয়স্ত্বরয়েতমন্তি মে ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

dvijātmajā me yuvayor didṛkṣuṇā
the brāhmaṇa's sons by Me you two wishing to see
mayopanītā bhuvi dharma-guptaye
by Me were brought on earth of dharma for the protection
kalāvatīrṇāv avaner bharāsurān
with My portions descended of the earth the burden the asuras
hatveha bhūyas tvarayetam anti me
having slain here again hurry back near Me

145 "I brought the brāhmaṇa's sons here because I wished to see you two, who have descended to earth with all your potencies for the protection of *dharma*. When you have slain the *asuras*, the burden of the earth, hurry back to Me here." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.89.58)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Bhūmā-puruṣa said, “O Kṛṣṇa and Arjuna, I brought the brāhmaṇa's sons here because I wished to see you. You have descended with all Your parts to protect the *dharma* of the world; kill the *asuras* who burden the earth and quickly come back here.” The purport is this: the Bhūmā-puruṣa, the husband of Lakṣmī, was enchanted by Śrī Kṛṣṇa's sweetness and, wishing to see His form, took *darśana* of Kṛṣṇa on the pretext of stealing the brāhmaṇa's sons.

Anubhāṣya.

In Dvārakā Arjuna vowed to save a brāhmaṇa's son from untimely death, but his efforts failed. Seeing this, Śrī Kṛṣṇa took Arjuna with Him to show him the brāhmaṇa's sons. By the power of the Sudarśana disc He crossed the dreadful mass of darkness, the transformation of *prakṛti* that lies beyond the universe. In the midst of the great waters, in “Mahākālapura,” they saw Śeṣaśāyī lying on the thousand-hooded Ananta and offered Him obeisance. Then Bhagavān Śeṣaśāyī, the Lord of Parameṣṭhī, said to Śrī Kṛṣṇa and Arjuna:

dharma-guptaye (to protect *dharma*) **kalāvatīrṇau** (You two who have descended, that is, appeared, with all Your parts, with all Your potencies) **yuvayoḥ didṛkṣuṇā** (by one who wishes to see) **me** (in My) **bhuvi** (abode, in Mahākālapura) **dvijātmajāḥ** (the brāhmaṇa's sons) **mayā upanītāḥ** (have been brought); **bhūyaḥ** (again) **avaneḥ** (of the earth) **bharāsurān** (the *asuras* who are a burden, the Daityas hostile to Viṣṇu) **hatvā iha** (here) **me anti** (near) **tvarayā** (quickly) **itam** (come).

কস্যানুভাবোঽস্য ন দেব বিদ্মহে
তবাঙ্ঘ্রিরেণুস্পর্শাধিকারঃ ।
যদ্বাঞ্ছয়া শ্রীর্ললনাচরত্তপো
বিহায় কামান্ সুচিরং ধৃতব্রতা ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

kasyānubhāvo 'sya na deva vidmahe
of what merit his not O Lord we know
tavāṅghri-reṇu-sparśādhikāraḥ
of Your feet of the dust of the touch the right
yad-vāñchayā śrīr lalanācarat tapo
for which longing Śrī the best of women performed austerity
vihāya kāmān su-ciraṁ dhṛta-vratā
giving up desires for a very long time holding vows

146 "O Lord, we do not know by what merit this one has gained the right to touch the dust of Your feet. Longing for it, Śrī, the best of women, renounced all desires and practised austerities, keeping her vows for a very long time." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.16.36)[17]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"O Lord! Desiring the dust of Your feet, Kamalā performed austerities for a long time, giving up all desires and keeping vows. By what pious merit this serpent Kāliya earned the right to that dust of Your feet, we do not know."

Anubhāṣya.
When Śrī Kṛṣṇa's kicks had made the serpent Kāliya faint and broken his heads, the serpent's wives addressed Kṛṣṇa with a prayer.

yad-vāñchayā (by the desire for which — the desire for the right to touch the dust of His lotus feet) **śrīḥ** (Lakṣmī, whom Brahmā and others serve) **lalanā** (the best of women, greater than we are) (even all) **kāmān vihāya dhṛta-vratā** (firm in vows, an ascetic, chaste) **suciraṁ tapaḥ acarat**, **asya** (of this Kāliya, though he was born a serpent) **tava aṅghri-reṇu-sparśādhikāraḥ** (the right, that is, the capacity, to touch such rare dust of [Your] feet) **kasya** (of what pious merit) **anubhāvaḥ** (is the fruit) — (this we) **na vidmahe** (do not know).

He Himself is enchanted by His own sweetness —

আপন-মাধুর্য্যে হরে আপনার মন ।
আপনা আপনি চাহে করিতে আলিঙ্গন ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

āpana-mādhurye hare āpanāra mana
by His own sweetness He steals His own mind
āpanā āpani cāhe karite āliṅgana
Himself He Himself wishes to make embrace

147 His own sweetness steals His own mind, and He longs to embrace Himself.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.148 and 158.

He Himself longs to relish His own sweetness as Rādhikā relishes it —

অপরিকলিতপূর্ব্বঃ কশ্চমৎকারকারী
স্ফুরতি মম গরীয়ানেষ মাধুর্য্যপূরঃ ৷
অয়মহমপি হন্ত প্রেক্ষ্য যং লুব্ধচেতাঃ
সরভসমুপভোক্তুং কাময়ে রাধিকেব ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

aparikalita-pūrvaḥ kaś camatkāra-kārī
never experienced before some wonder-working
sphurati mama garīyān eṣa mādhurya-pūraḥ
appears My greater this of sweetness flood
ayam aham api hanta prekṣya yaṁ lubdha-cetāḥ
this I even alas seeing which with greedy heart
sa-rabhasam upabhoktuṁ kāmaye rādhikeva
eagerly to enjoy I desire like Rādhikā

148 "What wondrous flood of My sweetness, never known before and surpassing all, appears here! Alas, seeing it, even I long with an eager heart to enjoy it, as Rādhikā does." (Lalita-mādhava, 8.34)[18]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.146.

(2) The description of the truth of Rādhikā begins —

এই ত' সংক্ষেপে কহিল কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ ।
এবে সংক্ষেপে কহি শুন রাধা-তত্ত্বরূপ ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

ei ta' saṅkṣepe kahila kṛṣṇera svarūpa
thus indeed in brief I have told Kṛṣṇa's nature
ebe saṅkṣepe kahi śuna rādhā-tattva-rūpa
now in brief I tell hear of Rādhā's truth the form

149 Thus I have told you briefly of Kṛṣṇa's true nature. Now hear, briefly, the truth of Rādhā.

Kṛṣṇa's three potencies —

কৃষ্ণের অনন্ত শক্তি, তাতে তিন — প্রধান ।
'চিচ্ছক্তি', 'মায়াশক্তি', 'জীবশক্তি'-নাম ॥ ১৫০ ॥

kṛṣṇera ananta-śakti, tāte tina — pradhāna
Kṛṣṇa's endless potencies among them three chief
'cic-chakti', 'māyā-śakti', 'jīva-śakti'-nāma
the spiritual potency the māyā potency the jīva potency by name

150 Kṛṣṇa's potencies are endless, and among them three are chief: the spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*), the potency of *māyā* (*māyā-śakti*) and the potency of the *jīvas* (*jīva-śakti*).

'অন্তরঙ্গা', 'বহিরঙ্গা', 'তটস্থা' কহি যারে ।
অন্তরঙ্গা 'স্বরূপ-শক্তি' — সবার উপরে ॥ ১৫১ ॥

'antaraṅgā', 'bahiraṅgā', 'taṭasthā' kahi yāre
internal external marginal we call which
antaraṅgā 'svarūpa-śakti' — sabāra upare
the internal His own potency all above

151 They are called the internal, the external and the marginal; the internal, His own potency (*svarūpa-śakti*), is above all.

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 2.101–103 and 5.42, 45, 57–58.

বিষ্ণুশক্তিঃ পরা প্রোক্তা ক্ষেত্রজ্ঞাখ্যা তথাপরা ।
অবিদ্যা কর্ম্মসংজ্ঞান্যা তৃতীয়া শক্তিরিষ্যতে ॥ ১৫২ ॥

viṣṇu-śaktiḥ parā proktā
Viṣṇu's potency superior is declared
kṣetrajñākhyā tathā parā
called the knower of the field likewise superior
avidyā-karma-saṁjñānyā
called ignorance and karma another
tṛtīyā śaktir iṣyate
a third potency is held to be

152 "The potency of Viṣṇu is declared to be superior; the potency called the knower of the field (*kṣetrajña*) is likewise superior; and the other, called ignorance and karma, is held to be a third potency." (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 6.7.61)[19]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 7.119.

*Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa-śakti*, not different from His *svarūpa* —*

সচ্চিদানন্দময় কৃষ্ণের স্বরূপ ।
অতএব স্বরূপ-শক্তি হয় তিন-রূপ ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

sac-cid-ānanda-maya kṛṣṇera svarūpa
of being knowledge bliss made Kṛṣṇa's nature
ataeva svarūpa-śakti haya tina-rūpa
therefore His own potency is of three forms

153 Kṛṣṇa's nature is made of eternal being, knowledge and bliss; therefore His own potency has three forms.

*The three aspects of the *svarūpa-śakti* —*

আনন্দাংশে ‘হ্লাদিনী’, সদংশে ‘সন্ধিনী’ ।
চিদংশে ‘সম্বিৎ’, যারে জ্ঞান করি’ মানি ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

ānandāṁśe ‘hlādinī’, sad-aṁśe ‘sandhinī’
in the aspect of bliss hlādinī in the aspect of being sandhinī
cid-aṁśe ‘samvit’, yāre jñāna kari’ māni
in the aspect of consciousness samvit which as knowledge making we regard

154 In the aspect of bliss She is Hlādinī, in the aspect of being Sandhinī, and in the aspect of consciousness Samvit, which we know as knowledge.[20]

হ্লাদিনী সন্ধিনী সম্বিৎ ত্বয্যেকা সর্ব্বসংশ্রয়ে ।
হ্লাদতাপকরী মিশ্রা ত্বয়ি নো গুণবর্জ্জিতে ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

hlādinī sandhinī samvit
hlādinī sandhinī samvit
tvayy ekā sarva-saṁśraye
in You one of all the shelter
hlāda-tāpa-karī miśrā
of joy of pain causing mixed
tvayi no guṇa-varjite
in You not of the guṇas devoid

155 “O Lord, You are the basis of all, and in You Hlādinī, Sandhinī and Samvit are one potency. But that which causes joy, pain and a mixture of the two is not in You, for You are beyond the guṇas.” (Viṣṇu Purāṇa, 1.12.69)[21]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.61–63.

*Why she is called *hlādinī*, and what she does —*

কৃষ্ণকে আহ্লাদে, তাতে নাম — ‘হ্লাদিনী’ ।
সেই শক্তি-দ্বারে সুখ আস্বাদে আপনি ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

kṛṣṇake āhlāde, tāte nāma — 'hlādinī'
Kṛṣṇa she gladdens therefore the name hlādinī
sei śakti-dvāre sukha āsvāde āpani
through that potency happiness tastes He Himself

156 Because she gladdens Kṛṣṇa, her name is Hlādinī; through that potency He Himself tastes happiness.

সুখরূপ কৃষ্ণ করে সুখ আস্বাদন ।
ভক্তগণে সুখ দিতে 'হ্লাদিনী' — কারণ ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

sukha-rūpa kṛṣṇa kare sukha āsvādana
of happiness the very form Kṛṣṇa does of happiness tasting
bhakta-gaṇe sukha dite 'hlādinī' — kāraṇa
to the devotees happiness to give hlādinī the cause

157 Kṛṣṇa, happiness itself, tastes happiness, and Hlādinī is the cause of the happiness He gives His devotees.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.59–60.

**Hlādinī* and Śrī Rādhikā —*

হ্লাদিনীর সার অংশ, তার 'প্রেম' নাম ।
আনন্দচিন্ময়রূপ রসের আখ্যান ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

hlādinīra sāra aṁśa, tāra 'prema' nāma
of hlādinī the essential part its prema the name
ānanda-cinmaya-rūpa rasera ākhyāna
of bliss spiritual whose form of rasa the designation

158 The essential part of Hlādinī is called prema. It bears the name of rasa, whose form is spiritual bliss.

প্রেমের পরম-সার 'মহাভাব' জানি ।
সেই মহাভাবরূপা রাধা-ঠাকুরাণী ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

premera parama-sāra ‘mahābhāva’ jāni
of prema the highest essence mahābhāva is known
sei mahābhāva-rūpā rādhā-ṭhākurāṇī
of that mahābhāva the embodiment Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī

159 The highest essence of prema is known as *mahābhāva*, and Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī is that *mahābhāva* embodied.

তয়োরপ্যুভয়োর্মধ্যে রাধিকা সর্ব্বথাধিকা ।
মহাভাবস্বরূপেয়ং গুণৈরতিবরীয়সী ॥ ১৬০ ॥

tayor apy ubhayor madhye
of these two even both among
rādhikā sarvathādhikā
Rādhikā in every way superior
mahābhāva-svarūpeyaṁ
of mahābhāva the embodiment She
guṇair ativarīyasī
in virtues far surpassing

160 “Of the two, Rādhikā is superior in every way. She is the embodiment of *mahābhāva*, and in virtues She surpasses all.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, 4.3)[22]

*Śrī Rādhā's “*svarūpa*” and “body” are one and the same, and it is wholly made of love for Kṛṣṇa —*

প্রেমের ‘স্বরূপ-দেহ’ — প্রেম-বিভাবিত ।
‘কৃষ্ণের প্রেয়সী-শ্রেষ্ঠা’ জগতে বিদিত ॥ ১৬১ ॥

premera ‘svarūpa-deha’ — prema-vibhāvita
of prema of the own form (svarūpa) the body with prema imbued
kṛṣṇera preyasī-śreṣṭhā jagate vidita
of Kṛṣṇa of the beloveds the foremost in the world known

161 Her body is the very form of prema, steeped in prema, and the world knows Her as the foremost of Kṛṣṇa’s beloveds.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
If one studies the fourth chapter of the Ādi-līlā here, all these points will be well understood.

আনন্দচিন্ময়রস প্রতিভাবিতাভি
স্তাভির্য এব নিজরূপতয়া কলাভিঃ ৷
গোলোক এব নিবসত্যখিলাত্মভূতো
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ১৬২ ॥

ānanda-cinmaya-rasa-pratibhāvitābhis
with blissful spiritual rasa imbued
tābhir ya eva nija-rūpatayā kalābhiḥ
with them who indeed as His own form with the portions (of potency)
goloka eva nivasaty akhilātma-bhūto
in Goloka indeed dwells of all the soul being
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

162 "I worship Govinda, the original Person, the Soul of all. He dwells eternally in Goloka with the gopīs, His potencies (*kalās*), who are one with Him in nature and imbued with blissful spiritual rasa." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.37)[23]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.68–72.

Śrī Rādhā is made of the fulfillment of Kṛṣṇa's desires —

সেই মহাভাব হয় 'চিন্তামণি-সার' ৷
কৃষ্ণ-বাঞ্ছা পূর্ণ করে এই কার্য্য তাঁর ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

sei mahābhāva haya 'cintāmaṇi-sāra'
that mahābhāva is of cintāmaṇi the essence
kṛṣṇa-vāñchā pūrṇa kare ei kārya tāṁra
Kṛṣṇa's desires fulfilled makes this work Her

163 That *mahābhāva* is the essence of *cintāmaṇi*, the wish-fulfilling gem. Her work is to fulfil Kṛṣṇa's desires.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.87 and 94.

*The eight *sakhīs* are expansions of Her body (*kāya-vyūha*), not different from Her —*

'মহাভাব-চিন্তামণি' রাধার স্বরূপ ।
ললিতাদি সখী — তাঁর কায়ব্যূহরূপ ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

'mahābhāva-cintāmaṇi' rādhāra svarūpa
of mahābhāva the cintāmaṇi Rādhā's own nature
lalitādi sakhī — tāṁra kāya-vyūha-rūpa
Lalitā and the other sakhīs Her of the body of the expansions the form

164 Rādhā's own nature is the *cintāmaṇi* of *mahābhāva*, and Lalitā and the other *sakhīs* are expansions of Her body (*kāya-vyūha*).

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.79 and Ādi 5.213, 215.

*The description of Śrī Rādhikā, the embodiment of love (*praṇaya*) for Kṛṣṇa —*

রাধা-প্রতি কৃষ্ণ-স্নেহ — সুগন্ধি উদ্বর্ত্তন ।
তা'তে সুগন্ধি দেহ — উজ্জ্বল-বরণ ॥ ১৬৫ ॥

rādhā-prati kṛṣṇa-sneha — sugandhi udvartana
toward Rādhā Kṛṣṇa's affection fragrant unguent
tāte sugandhi deha — ujjvala-varaṇa
by that fragrant the body bright of complexion

165 Kṛṣṇa's affection (*sneha*) for Rādhā is the fragrant unguent, and by it Her body is fragrant and radiant in complexion.

Anubhāṣya.

Fragrant unguent (*udvartana*) — a scented paste (*ābāṭā*) with which the body is cleansed. Kṛṣṇa's *sneha* is that paste; because the body is anointed with it, it is full of fragrance and radiant.

Śrī Rādhā bathes in three streams —

কারুণ্যামৃত-ধারায় স্নান প্রথম ।
তারুণ্যামৃত-ধারায় স্নান মধ্যম ॥ ১৬৬ ॥

kāruṇyāmṛta-dhārāya snāna prathama
of the nectar of compassion in the stream the bath first
tāruṇyāmṛta-dhārāya snāna madhyama
of the nectar of youth in the stream the bath middle

166 Her first bath is in the stream of the nectar of compassion, the next in the stream of the nectar of youth.

The description of Śrī Rādhā's form —

লাবণ্যামৃত-ধারায় তদুপরি স্নান ।
নিজ-লজ্জা-শ্যাম-পট্টসাটী-পরিধান ॥ ১৬৭ ॥

lāvaṇyāmṛta-dhārāya tad-upari snāna
of the nectar of loveliness in the stream after that the bath
nija-lajjā-śyāma-paṭṭasāṭī-paridhāna
of Her own modesty dark silk sari the wearing

167 After that She bathes in the stream of the nectar of loveliness (*lāvaṇya*) and puts on Her own modesty as a dark silk sari.

কৃষ্ণ অনুরাগ — দ্বিতীয় অরুণ-বসন ।
প্রণয়-মান-কঞ্চুলিকায় বক্ষ আচ্ছাদন ॥ ১৬৮ ॥

kṛṣṇa-anurāga — dvitīya aruṇa-vasana
for Kṛṣṇa anurāga the second rose-red garment
praṇaya-māna-kañculikāya vakṣa ācchādana
of praṇaya of māna by the bodice of the breast the covering

168 Her *anurāga* for Kṛṣṇa is Her second garment, rose-red, and Her breast is covered by the bodice of *praṇaya* and *māna*.

সৌন্দর্য্য — কুঙ্কুম, সখী-প্রণয় — চন্দন ।
স্মিতকান্তি — কর্পূর, তিন — অঙ্গে বিলেপন ॥ ১৬৯ ॥

saundarya — kuṅkuma, sakhī-praṇaya — candana
beauty kuṅkuma of the sakhīs the love sandal paste
smitakānti — karpūra, tina — aṅge vilepana
the lustre of Her smile camphor these three on the limbs the ointment

169 Her beauty is *kuṅkuma*, the love of Her *sakhīs* is sandal paste, and the lustre of Her smile is camphor; these three anoint Her limbs.

কৃষ্ণের উজ্জ্বল রস — মৃগমদ-ভর ।
সেই মৃগমদে বিচিত্রি কলেবর ॥ ১৭০ ॥

kṛṣṇera ujjvala rasa — mṛgamada-bhara
Kṛṣṇa's radiant rasa of musk an abundance
sei mṛgamade vicitri kalevara
with that musk painted the body

170 Kṛṣṇa's *ujjvala-rasa* is abundant musk, and Her body is painted with that musk.

Anubhāṣya.

The *svarūpa* of Śrīmatī Rādhikā is the *cintāmaṇi* of *mahābhāva* that fulfills Kṛṣṇa's desires. Lalitā and the other *sakhīs* are like expansions of Her body (*kāya-vyūha*), that is, Her manifestations. (1) Anointed with the paste of Kṛṣṇa's *sneha*, She takes the first, morning bath; its water is the nectar of compassion, that is, new youth full of compassion at the beginning of *kaiśora*, when *pauganḍa* has passed. (2) The water of the second, midday bath is the nectar of youth, that is, manifest youth. (3) The water of the next, afternoon bath is the nectar of loveliness, that is, full youth. In other words, the bodily qualities — age, form and loveliness — are the water of the three baths.

Her garments are of two kinds: (1) the lower garment and (2) the upper. (1) The lower garment is modesty: a blue *sāṛī* woven of dark silk threads. The second

garment is red: it is *anurāga* for Kṛṣṇa. Śrī Rādhā's breast is covered by a bodice, the *māna* of *praṇaya* for Kṛṣṇa. The *kuṅkuma* is beauty, a bodily quality of Śrī Rādhā; the sandal is Her comeliness (*abhirūpatā*), that is, the love (*praṇaya*) of the *sakhīs*; the camphor is Her sweetness (*mādhurya*), that is, the luster of Her smile. These three anoint Her body, that is, Her body is adorned with beauty, comeliness and sweetness. The musk (*mṛgamada*) is Kṛṣṇa's *ujjvala-rasa*; this is Her bodily quality of softness (*mārdava*).

প্রচ্ছন্ন-মান বাম্য — ধম্মিল্ল-বিন্যাস ।
'ধীরাধীরাত্মক' গুণ — অঙ্গে পট্টবাস ॥ ১৭১ ॥

pracchanna-māna vāmya — dhammilla-vinyāsa
concealed māna contrariness of the hair the arrangement
'dhīrādhīrātmaka' guṇa — aṅge paṭṭa-vāsa
of dhīrādhīrā the quality on the body the silk wrap

171 Her concealed *māna* and contrariness (*vāmya*) are the arrangement of Her hair, and Her nature as *dhīrādhīrā*, at once composed and impetuous, is the silk wrap on Her body.

Anubhāṣya.

Hidden *māna* — though full of crookedness within, She shows compliance (*dākṣiṇya*) outwardly. ***Vāmya*** — contrariness, the absence of straightforwardness; see the *Anubhāṣya* on Madhya 14.161. ***Dhammilla*** — hair tied in a knot (*khõpā*).

The quality of being *dhīrādhīrā*. The *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* says: "The *dhīrādhīrā* speaks to her Beloved with crooked words and with tears; one endowed with the qualities of the *dhīrā* and the *adhīrā* is called *dhīrādhīrā*." The heroine who speaks to her Beloved with crooked words, as is the way of the *dhīrā*, and speaks with tear-filled eyes, as is the way of the *adhīrā*, is the "*dhīrādhīrā*." See Madhya 14.143–153. The qualities of the "*dhīrādhīrā madhyā*" are also found in the *dhīrādhīrā pragalbhā*. Of the three — the *pragalbhā*, the *madhyā* and the *mugdhā* — the *pragalbhā*, greatly angered, is ready to strike; the *madhyā*, possessed by incomplete anger, speaks harsh words; and the *mugdhā*, only slightly angered, weeps. This quality shows itself especially in the state of the *khaṇḍitā*.

Paṭṭavāsa — a head covering (*pāgaḍī*), a silken upper cloth of a single piece. A variant reading is *paṭavāsa*: a tent, fragrant powder, rice paste (*piṭāli*), a *sāṛī*.

রাগ-তাম্বূলরাগে অধর উজ্জ্বল ।
প্রেমকৌটিল্য — নেত্রযুগলে কজ্জল ॥ ১৭২ ॥

rāga-tāmbūla-rāge adhara ujjvala
of rāga of betel with the red the lips shine
prema-kauṭilya — netra-yugale kajjala
of prema the winding ways on the two eyes kohl

172 Her lips shine with the red of the betel of *rāga*, and the winding ways of *prema* are the kohl on Her eyes.

Anubhāṣya.
The color of the betel is *rāga* for Kṛṣṇa; it makes Her lips shine. The black on Her eyes is the crookedness of love.

'সূদ্দীপ্ত-সাত্ত্বিক' ভাব, হর্ষাদি 'সঞ্চারী' ।
এই সব ভাব-ভূষণ সব-অঙ্গে ভরি' ॥ ১৭৩ ॥

'sūddīpta-sāttvika' bhāva, harṣādi 'sañcārī'
sūddīpta sāttvika bhāvas joy and the rest sañcārī
ei saba bhāva-bhūṣaṇa saba-aṅge bhari'
these all of bhāvas ornaments all the limbs filling

173 The *sūddīpta sāttvika bhāvas* and the *sañcārī bhāvas*, beginning with joy — all these *bhāvas* are ornaments filling Her every limb.

Anubhāṣya.
The *sūddīpta sāttvika-bhāvas* — see Madhya 6.12. **The thirty-three *sañcārī-bhāvas* beginning with *harṣa*** — see Madhya 3.127 and the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* on Madhya 14.167–168.

'কিলকিঞ্চিতাদি'-ভাব-বিংশতি-ভূষিত ।
গুণশ্রেণী-পুষ্পমালা সর্ব্বাঙ্গে পূরিত ॥ ১৭৪ ॥

'kila-kiñcitādi'-bhāva-viṁśati-bhūṣita
kila-kiñcita and the rest bhāvas twenty adorned
guṇa-śreṇī-puṣpamālā sarvāṅge pūrita
of virtues of the row the flower garland all the limbs filling

174 She is adorned with the twenty *bhāvas*, beginning with *kila-kiñcita*, and the flower garland of Her many virtues covers Her whole body.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"The *bhāvas* beginning with *kila-kiñcita*" — there are twenty of them. The twenty *bhāvas* are: (1) those born of the body (*aṅgaja*) — *bhāva*, *hāva*, *helā*; (2) those born of the self (*ātmaja*) — *śobhā*, *kānti*, *dīpti*, *mādhurya*, *pragalbhatā*, *audārya* and *dhairya*; (3) those born of nature (*svabhāvaja*) — *kila-kiñcita*, *līlā*, *vilāsa*, *vicchitti*, *vibhrama*, *moṭṭāyita*, *kuṭṭamita*, *bibboka*, *lalita* and *vikṛta*.

"The flower garland of qualities." Śrīmatī's qualities are of three kinds: mental, verbal and bodily. Gratitude, forbearance, compassion and the like are mental; speech that delights the ear and the like are verbal; and excellences, age, form, loveliness, beauty and the like are bodily qualities.

Anubhāṣya.

The *bhāvas* beginning with *kila-kiñcita* — see Madhya 14.168. **The flower garland of qualities** — see Madhya 23.82–86.

The twenty-five qualities described in the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*: "Why say much? Her qualities, like Hari's, are beyond count. Here four kinds of qualities of the Queen of Vṛndāvana are named: those residing in the body, in speech, in the mind, and those connected with others."[41] What more can be said? Like Śrī Hari, Śrī Rādhikā eternally possesses countless qualities. They fall into four groups: (a) those residing in the body (*aṅgastha*), (b) those residing in speech (*uktistha*), (c) those residing in the mind (*manastha*), and (d) those connected with others (*para-sambandhaga*).

(a) The qualities residing in the body are six: 1) *madhurā* — charming; 2) *nava-vayāḥ* — youthful (*kiśorī*); 3) *calāpāṅgā* — with restless sidelong glances; 4) *ujjvala-smitā* — with a radiant smile; 5) *cāru-saubhāgya-rekhā-yuktā* — marked with beautiful lines of good fortune, the signs of the moon on Her feet and

elsewhere; 6) *gandhonmādita-mādhavā* — who maddens Mādhava with Her fragrance.

(b) The qualities residing in speech are three: 1) *saṅgīta-prasarābhijñā* — expert in the art of song; 2) *ramya-vāk* — whose speech is charming; 3) *narma-paṇḍitā* — skilled in jesting.

(c) The qualities residing in the mind are ten: 1) *vinītā* — modest; 2) *karuṇā-pūrṇā* — full of compassion; 3) *vidagdhā* — clever and refined; 4) *pāṭavānvitā* — adroit; 5) *lajjā-śīlā* — shy, which comes from noble birth, good character and the like; 6) [endowed with] *maryādā* — never straying from the path of the virtuous; 7) *dhairya-śālinī* — steady, that is, patient in suffering; 8) *gāmbhīrya-śālinī* — deep; 9) *suvilāsā* — graceful in play; 10) *mahābhāva-paramotkarṣa-tarṣiṇī* — who longs for the highest summit of *mahābhāva*.

(d) The qualities connected with others are six: 1) *gokula-prema-vasati* — the abode of Gokula's love; 2) *jagac-chreṇī-lasad-yaśāḥ* — whose fame shines through all the worlds; 3) *gurv-arpita-guru-snehā* — on whom the elders bestow great affection; 4) *sakhī-praṇayitā-vaśā* — subject to the love of Her friends; 5) *kṛṣṇa-priyāvalī-mukhyā* — foremost among Kṛṣṇa's beloveds; 6) *santatāśrava-keśavā* — to whom Keśava is always obedient.

সৌভাগ্য-তিলক চারু-ললাটে উজ্জ্বল ।
প্রেম-বৈচিত্ত্য — রত্ন, হৃদয় — তরল ॥ ১৭৫ ॥

saubhāgya-tilaka cāru-lalāṭe ujjvala
of good fortune the tilaka on the lovely forehead shines
prema-vaicittya — ratna, hṛdaya — tarala
prema-vaicittya the jewel the heart the pendant

175 The *tilaka* of good fortune shines on Her lovely forehead. *Prema-vaicittya* — the dread of separation that love feels even in the Beloved’s presence — is the jewel, and Her heart is the pendant.

Anubhāṣya.

Prema-vaicittya: “The pain that, by the very nature of love at its height, arises from the thought of separation even in the Beloved's presence is called *prema-vaicittya*.” By the nature of love at its height, even when She is near the Beloved, anguish (*ārti*) arises from fear of separation from Him: this is “*prema-

vaicittya*," and it is a jewel. ***Tarala**** — the gem in the middle of a necklace, a pendant (*dhukdhuki*).

মধ্য-বয়স, সখী-স্কন্ধে কর-ন্যাস ।
কৃষ্ণলীলা-মনোবৃত্তি-সখী আশপাশ ॥ ১৭৬ ॥

madhya-vayasa, sakhī-skandhe kara-nyāsa
middle age on a sakhī's shoulder the placing of the hand
kṛṣṇalīlā-manovṛtti-sakhī āśa-pāśa
of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes the thoughts the sakhīs all around

176 Her budding youth (*madhya-vayasa*) is Her hand resting on a friend's shoulder, and Her thoughts of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes are the *sakhīs* all around Her.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"The *sakhīs* are Her thoughts of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes." The eight states of mind of Śrīmatī, who is the very bliss of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, are the eight *sakhīs*, and the states that follow them are all the other *mañjarīs*.

Anubhāṣya.
Laying Her hand on a friend's shoulder is the very mood of a *kiśorī* in the middle of youth; and the friends near Her are Her thoughts of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes.

নিজাঙ্গ-সৌরভালয়ে গর্ব্ব-পর্য্যঙ্ক ।
তা'তে বসি' আছে, সদা চিন্তে কৃষ্ণসঙ্গ ॥ ১৭৭ ॥

nijāṅga-saurabhālaye garva-paryaṅka
of Her own body of the fragrance in the chamber of pride the couch
tā'te vasi' āche, sadā cinte kṛṣṇa-saṅga
on that seated She is always thinks of Kṛṣṇa's company

177 In the chamber of Her own bodily fragrance stands the couch of pride. Seated on it, She always thinks of being with Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
In the chamber of fragrance, Her own body; on the couch, or bed, of pride.

কৃষ্ণ-নাম-গুণ-যশ — অবতংস-কাণে ।
কৃষ্ণ-নাম-গুণ-যশ-প্রবাহ-বচনে ॥ ১৭৮ ॥

kṛṣṇa-nāma-guṇa-yaśa — avataṁsa kāṇe
Kṛṣṇa's name qualities fame the ear-ornaments in the ears
kṛṣṇa-nāma-guṇa-yaśa-pravāha-vacane
of Kṛṣṇa's name qualities fame a flood in Her speech

178 Kṛṣṇa's name, qualities and fame are the ornaments in Her ears, and a flood of Kṛṣṇa's name, qualities and fame pours forth in Her speech.

কৃষ্ণকে করায় শ্যামরস-মধু পান ।
নিরন্তর পূর্ণ করে কৃষ্ণের সর্ব্বকাম ॥ ১৭৯ ॥

kṛṣṇake karāya śyāma-rasa-madhu pāna
Kṛṣṇa She makes of śyāma-rasa the honey drink
nirantara pūrṇa kare kṛṣṇera sarva-kāma
constantly fulfilled She makes Kṛṣṇa's every desire

179 She makes Kṛṣṇa drink the honey of *śyāma-rasa*, and She constantly fulfils all His desires.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śyāma-rasa is the *madhura-rasa*.

Anubhāṣya.
Avataṁsa — a particular ear ornament. Kṛṣṇa's name, qualities and fame are the ornament of Her ears. The stream of words about Kṛṣṇa's name, qualities and fame is the flow of the honey of *śyāma-rasa*; that is what Śrīmatī gives Kṛṣṇa to drink.

Anubhāṣya.
The author shows in detail that Śrī Rādhā is the transformation (*vikāra*) of love (*praṇaya*) for Kṛṣṇa, that is, love for Kṛṣṇa embodied. Her feelings within, all the limbs of Her body, Her dress and the rest — every one of them is an adornment, a beauty, of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Śrī Rādhikā is the embodied ocean of love for Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণের বিশুদ্ধ প্রেম-রত্নের আকর ।
অনুপম-গুণগণ পূর্ণ কলেবর ॥ ১৮০ ॥

kṛṣṇera viśuddha-prema-ratnera ākara
for Kṛṣṇa of pure love of the jewel the mine
anupama-guṇagaṇa-pūrṇa kalevara
matchless with a host of virtues filled the body

180 She is the mine of the jewel of pure love for Kṛṣṇa, and Her body is filled with a host of matchless virtues.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In describing Śrī Rādhikā's qualities, Kavirāja Gosvāmī relies on the prayer of Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī called *Premāmbhoja-makaranda*:

"[You,] whose form is manifested by the radiant *cintāmaṇi* of *mahābhāva*, who shine anointed with the finest fragrant unguent — the love (*praṇaya*) of Your friends; who are bathed in the waves of the nectar of compassion, the stream of the nectar of youth and the floods of the nectar of loveliness, and who make Indirā fade; whose limbs are covered by the silken garment of modesty, who are adorned with the saffron of beauty, whose body is painted with radiant dark musk; trembling, tears, hair standing on end, stupor, perspiration, faltering voice, flushing, madness and numbness — You who are adorned with ornaments of these nine finest jewels and wear a garland of flowers, the series of Your qualities, who are perfumed with the fragrant powder of the fine quality of being *dhīrā-adhīrā*; whose braided hair is hidden *māna*, who shine with the *tilaka* of good fortune, whose ears glitter with the earrings of hearing Kṛṣṇa's name and fame; whose lips are red with the betel of *rāga*, whose eye-black is the crookedness of love, who are scented with the camphor of the smile that flows from playful words; who sit playfully on the couch of pride in the inner chamber of fragrance and are marked with the trembling pendant of *prema-vaicittya*; whose breasts are hidden by the fine bodice tied with the anger of *praṇaya*, whose *kacchapī vīṇā* sounds with the fame and beauty that dry up the faces and hearts of Your rivals; who have playfully laid Your lotus hand on the shoulder of Your friend, youth (*madhyatā*), who are Śyāmā and serve the honey drink of the joy of love for Śyāma — bowing to You, this person, holding a straw between his teeth, begs: revive this miserable one by sprinkling him with the nectar of service to You! The merciful one does not

abandon one who has come for shelter, even if he is wicked; therefore, O Gāndharvikā, alas, alas, do not abandon this one either, such as he is! Whoever recites this king of prayers called *Premāmbhoja-makaranda*, the cause of Śrī Rādhikā's mercy, will attain service to Her."

[The meaning of the prayer:] Her form is manifested by the radiant *cintāmaṇi* of *mahābhāva*; the love (*praṇaya*) of the *sakhīs* for Kṛṣṇa is the fragrant *kuṅkuma* and the rest, from which She has gained a beautiful luster (1). In the morning Her form is bathed in the nectar of compassion, at midday in the nectar of youth, and in the evening in the nectar of loveliness (2). She wears the silken garment of modesty, is adorned with the *kuṅkuma* of beauty, and Her body is painted with dark musk, the *rasa* of *śṛṅgāra* (3). She is adorned with nine finest jewels: trembling, tears, hair standing on end, stupor, perspiration, faltering voice, flushing, madness and numbness (4). Her qualities — beauty, sweetness and the rest — rest on Her body as a garland of flowers. She has perfumed Her moods of being *dhīrā* and *adhīrā* with fragrant powder, that is, with camphor and the like (5). Her braided hair, that is, Her hair tied in a knot (*khõpā*), is *māna* hidden within; Her forehead shines with the *tilaka* of good fortune; the ornament of Her ears is hearing Kṛṣṇa's name and fame (6). Her lips are colored red with the betel of *anurāga*; She wears the crookedness of love as eye-black; She is scented with the camphor of the gentle smile that jokes (*narma*) bring (7). When She reclines on the couch of pride in the inner chamber of fragrance, the necklace of *vipralambha* swings on Her as a pendant, *prema-vaicittya* (8). Her breasts are covered by a bodice, the anger of *praṇaya*; Her *kacchapī vīṇā* is the fame and beauty that dry up the faces and hearts of Her rivals (9). She has laid Her lotus hand, Her play, on the shoulder of Her friend, youth; though She has many qualities, She serves the honey that delights Kṛṣṇa, the Kandarpa (10). Holding a straw between my teeth I pray to such a Śrī Rādhā: revive this miserable one by giving him the nectar of service to You (11). O Gāndharvikā, as merciful Kṛṣṇa does not abandon those who surrender to Him, so You too do not abandon one who takes shelter of You (12).

Anubhāṣya.

Śrīmatī Rādhikā is the mine of the jewel of pure love for Kṛṣṇa, that is, the embodied ocean of love for Kṛṣṇa; and Śrī Rādhikā's body is full of incomparable qualities. See Madhya 23.81–86.

Rādhikā is the original mine of love for Kṛṣṇa —

কা কৃষ্ণস্য প্রণয়জনিভূঃ শ্রীমতী রাধিকৈকা
কাস্য প্রেয়স্যনুপমগুণা রাধিকৈকা ন চান্যা ।
জৈহ্ম্যং কেশে দৃশি তরলতা নিষ্ঠুরত্বং কুচেঽস্যা
বাঞ্ছাপূর্ত্যৈ প্রভবতি হরে রাধিকৈকা ন চান্যা ॥ ১৮১ ॥

kā kṛṣṇasya praṇaya-jani-bhūḥ śrīmatī rādhikaikā
who of Kṛṣṇa of love the birthplace Śrīmatī Rādhikā alone
kāsya preyasy anupama-guṇā rādhikaikā na cānyā
who His beloved of matchless virtues Rādhikā alone not and another
jaihmyaṁ keśe dṛśi taralatā niṣṭhuratvaṁ kuce 'syā
crookedness in the hair in the eyes restlessness firmness in the breasts whose
vāñcā-pūrtyai prabhavati hare rādhikaikā na cānyā
of the desires for the fulfillment is able of Hari Rādhikā alone not and another

181 "Who is the birthplace of Kṛṣṇa's love? Śrīmatī Rādhikā alone. Who is His beloved of matchless virtues? Rādhikā alone, and no other. Crookedness in Her hair, restlessness in Her eyes, firmness in Her breasts — Rādhikā alone, and no other, is able to fulfil Hari's desires." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 11.122)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Who is the birthplace of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's *praṇaya*? Śrīmatī Rādhikā alone. Who is Kṛṣṇa's Beloved of incomparable qualities? Rādhikā alone, and no other. Crookedness in the hair, restlessness in the eyes, firmness in the breasts and the like belong to Rādhikā alone. Rādhikā alone can fulfill Hari's desires, and no one else.

Anubhāṣya.

(In the form of questions and answers he describes Śrī Rādhikā's glory.) **kṛṣṇasya praṇaya-janibhūḥ** (the birthplace of *praṇaya*) **kā**? — **ekā rādhikā**. **asya** (of this Kṛṣṇa) **preyasī** (the object of His love) **kā**? — **anupama-guṇā** (endowed with incomparable qualities) **ekā rādhikā**, **na ca anyā**. **asyāḥ** (of Rādhikā alone) **keśe jaihmyaṁ** (crookedness), **dṛśi** (in the eyes) **taralatā** (restlessness), **kuce**

niṣṭhuratvaṁ (firmness); **hareḥ vāñchā-pūrtyai** (to fulfill the desires) **prabhavati** (is able) [Rādhikā alone], **na ca anyā** (and no other is like Her).

Rādhikā's many qualities that bring Kṛṣṇa under Her control —

যাঁর সৌভাগ্য-গুণ বাঞ্ছে সত্যভামা ।
যাঁর ঠাঞি কলাবিলাস শিখে ব্রজ-রামা ॥ ১৮২ ॥

yāṁra saubhāgya-guṇa vāñche satyabhāmā
whose of good fortune the quality desires Satyabhāmā
yāṁra ṭhāñi kalā-vilāsa śikhe vraja-rāmā
from whom of the arts the graceful play learn the women of Vraja

182 Satyabhāmā longs for Her good fortune, and the women of Vraja learn the graceful arts from Her.

যাঁর সৌন্দর্য্যাদি-গুণ বাঞ্ছে লক্ষ্মী-পার্ব্বতী ।
যাঁর পতিব্রতা-ধর্ম্ম বাঞ্ছে অরুন্ধতী ॥ ১৮৩ ॥

yāṁra saundaryādi-guṇa vāñche lakṣmī-pārvatī
whose beauty and other qualities desire Lakṣmī and Pārvatī
yāṁra pativratā-dharma vāñche arundhatī
whose of chastity the virtue desires Arundhatī

183 Lakṣmī and Pārvatī long for Her beauty and other virtues, and Arundhatī longs for Her steadfast fidelity (*pativratā-dharma*).

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.69, 75–79, 90–96.

যাঁর সদ্গুণ-গণনে কৃষ্ণ না পায় পার ।
তাঁর গুণ গণিবে কেমনে জীব ছার ॥ ১৮৪ ॥

yāṁra sadguṇa-gaṇane kṛṣṇa nā pāya pāra
whose of good qualities in the counting Kṛṣṇa not finds the end
tāṁra guṇa gaṇibe kemane jīva chāra
Her qualities will count how a jīva insignificant

184 Even Kṛṣṇa finds no end in counting Her virtues; how then could an insignificant *jīva* count them?"

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.122–124, 240–248, 255.

*Thus far the truth of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa; now begins the description of the truth of *rasa* and *prema* —*

প্রভু কহে, — জানিলুঁ কৃষ্ণ-রাধা-প্রেম-তত্ত্ব ।
শুনিতে চাহিয়ে দুঁহার বিলাস-মহত্ত্ব ॥ ১৮৫ ॥

prabhu kahe, — jāniluṁ kṛṣṇa-rādhā-prema-tattva
the Lord said I have understood of Kṛṣṇa and Rādhā of the love the truth
śunite cāhiye duṁhāra vilāsa-mahattva
to hear I wish of the two of the pastimes the greatness

185 The Lord said, "I have understood the truth of the love of Kṛṣṇa and Rādhā. Now I wish to hear of the greatness of Their pastimes."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The greatness of the pastimes is the glory of the love-pastimes of the Two.

The description of the conduct of the youthful Kiśora and Kiśorī of Vraja —

রায় কহে, — কৃষ্ণ হয় 'ধীর-ললিত' ।
নিরন্তর কামক্রীড়া — যাঁহার চরিত ॥ ১৮৬ ॥

rāya kahe, — kṛṣṇa haya 'dhīra-lalita'
Rāya said Kṛṣṇa is dhīra-lalita
nirantara kāma-krīḍā — yāṁhāra carita
ceaseless love-play whose conduct

186 Rāya said, "Kṛṣṇa is *dhīra-lalita*, the carefree and playful hero, whose nature is ceaseless love-play (*kāma-krīḍā*).

বিদগ্ধো নবতারুণ্যঃ পরিহাস-বিশারদঃ ।
নিশ্চিন্তো ধীরললিতঃ স্যাৎ প্রায়ঃ প্রেয়সীবশঃ ॥ ১৮৭ ॥

vidagdho nava-tāruṇyaḥ
clever ever fresh in youth
parihāsa-viśāradaḥ
in jesting expert
niścinto dhīra-lalitaḥ
free from care dhīra-lalita
syāt prāyaḥ preyasī-vaśaḥ
is generally by His beloveds controlled

187 "Clever, ever youthful, expert in jesting, free from care and generally controlled by His beloveds — such is the *dhīra-lalita* hero." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.230)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The hero who is clever, freshly youthful, expert in jesting, free from anxiety and submissive to his beloveds is "*dhīra-lalita*."

Anubhāṣya.
vidagdhaḥ (a *rasika*) **nava-tāruṇyaḥ** (endowed with fresh youth) **parihāsa-viśāradaḥ** (skilled in secret play) **niścintaḥ** (free from anxiety) **dhīra-lalitaḥ** (hero) **prāyaḥ preyasī-vaśaḥ** (subject to His beloveds according to the degree of their love) **syāt**.

Kṛṣṇa, eternally absorbed in pastimes with Rādhā —

রাত্রি-দিন কুঞ্জে ক্রীড়া করে রাধা-সঙ্গে ।
কৈশোর বয়স সফল কৈল ক্রীড়া-রঙ্গে ॥ ১৮৮ ॥

rātri-dina kuñje krīḍā kare rādhā-saṅge
night and day in the bowers play He does with Rādhā
kaiśora vayasa saphala kaila krīḍā-raṅge
of youth the age fruitful He made in joyful play

188 Day and night He sports with Rādhā in the bowers, and in that joyful play He has made His youth fruitful.

বাচা সূচিতশর্ব্বরীরতিকলাপ্রাগল্ভ্যয়া রাধিকাং
ব্রীড়াকুঞ্চিতলোচনাং বিরচয়ন্নগ্রে সখীনামসৌ ৷
তদ্বক্ষোরুহচিত্রকেলীমকরীপাণ্ডিত্যপারং গতঃ
কৈশোরং সফলীকরোতি কলয়ন্ কুঞ্জে বিহারং হরিঃ ॥ ১৮৯ ॥

vācā sūcita-śarvarī-rati-kalā-prāgalbhyayā rādhikāṁ
by speech hinting of the night's love arts at the boldness Rādhikā
vrīḍā-kuñcita-locanāṁ viracayann agre sakhīnām asau
with shyness closed eyes making before the friends He
tad-vakṣoruha-citra-kelī-makarī-pāṇḍitya-pāraṁ gataḥ
on Her breasts of the picture of playful makarīs of the skill the limit having reached
kaiśoraṁ saphalī-karoti kalayan kuñje vihāraṁ hariḥ
youth fruitful makes performing in the bower pastimes Hari

189 "By words that hinted boldly at the arts of love of the night before, He made Rādhikā close Her eyes in shyness before Her friends; then, drawing playful *makarīs* on Her breasts, He showed the utmost skill. So Hari, sporting in the bowers, makes His youth fruitful." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.1.231)[24]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.117.

*The highest state of the eternal, spiritual pastimes of service is "*prema-vilāsa-vivarta*"; it is not the attainment of a material, featureless *kevalādvaita* —*

প্রভু কহে, — এহো হয়, আগে কহ আর ৷
রায় কহে, — ইহা বই বুদ্ধি-গতি নাহি আর ॥ ১৯০ ॥

prabhu kahe, — eho haya, āge kaha āra
the Lord said this too is so further speak more
rāya kahe, — ihā vai buddhi-gati nāhi āra
Rāya said this beyond of my intelligence the reach is not any further

190 The Lord said, “This is so, but go further and tell Me more.” Rāya said, “Beyond this my understanding does not reach.

যেবা ‘প্রেমবিলাস-বিবর্ত্ত’ এক হয়।
তাহা শুনি’ তোমার সুখ হয়, কি না হয় ॥ ১৯১ ॥

yebā ‘prema-vilāsa-vivarta’ eka haya
what prema-vilāsa-vivarta one there is
tāhā śuni’ tomāra sukha haya, ki nā haya
that hearing Your happiness will be or not will be

191 There is one thing more, called *prema-vilāsa-vivarta*. Will hearing of it make You happy, or not?”

Anubhāṣya.

“That which goes beyond the path of imagination (*bhāvanā*), becomes the ground of an abundance of wonder, and is deeply relished in a heart made radiant by [pure] *sattva* — that is considered *rasa*.”[42] *Rasa* is relished only in a heart full of the radiance of *viśuddha-sattva*. It is not something that the body and mind, bearing the gross and subtle *upādhis* of the outer or inner world, can relish. The semblance of selfhood (*asmitābhāsa*) seen in the secondary, gross and subtle world is what the words “intellect” (*buddhi*) and “mind” (*manas*) denote; they are not the self. An object full of *rasa* is perceived only by senses full of *rasa*. Senses full of *rasa*, by seeing, touching and the rest, all full of *rasa*, render loving service to Nanda-nandana — the crown of *rasikas*, the fountain of *rasa*, the *viṣaya-vigraha*. This is not merely the impersonalist's state of the absence of matter, in which “what is not That” has simply been rejected (*atan-nirasta*); that is why the definition of *rasa* specially records that it goes beyond the path of *bhāvanā*. One who teaches of the seer and the seen (*dṛg-dṛśya-vādī*) gains experiences in the material world rooted in sense gratification. Even if they serve merely as an antidote to material *vivarta*, they cannot approach transcendental *rasa*. The wonder that arises from the properties of the body and mind is incomplete, light and perishable; that is why spiritual *rasa* is said to reveal the weight of wonder. *Prema* is a pure, spiritual reality. Love (*prīti*) for what is not spiritual is perishable and rests only in *kāma*, whose nature is base. The suffering that comes in the material world when sense gratification is obstructed is the “*vivarta*” of material love. *Prema-vilāsa* and

vilāsa-vivarta produce no lack, no inferiority (*avaratā*) and nothing unworthy. Śrī Rāmānanda, the relisher of transcendental *rasa*, enacting the pastime of asking whether Śrī Gaurasundara would approve the song he had composed and sung, described *prema-vilāsa-vivarta*.

The book *Vivarta-vilāsa* by Bhaktadāsa Bāul is the exact opposite of Śrī Jagadānanda's *Prema-vivarta* and Śrī Rāmānanda's *prema-vilāsa-vivarta*. The present community proud of its education, following talk of material *vivarta-vilāsa*, sets up a perverse understanding of *prema-vilāsa-vivarta*. By this it may obtain the title “Ph.D.” from the material *vidyāsāgaras* in the “temple of material learning.” But to obtain the title “Ph.D.” in the “temple of higher knowledge” (*parā-vidyā*), one must give up material ego and be established in one's eternal *svarūpa*. Between religious scriptures made by men and transcendental philosophical scriptures there is a difference as between heaven and the netherworld. Śrīmad Madhvācārya showed it clearly to the *sampradāya* that rejects *svagata* and *sajātīya* distinctions, relying on their own favorite method of reasoning. The community of material philosophers lives in a material *prema-vilāsa-vivarta*; therefore they will not be able to understand *prema-vilāsa-vivarta* through their own concocted experience. As an elephant cannot be fitted onto a plate, so transcendental experience is impossible for the advocate of the ascending path (*āroha-vādī*), with his wild dancing and yet utterly feeble strength.

Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya's words speak of the variety of pastimes and the *vilāsa-vivarta* of *adhirūḍha mahābhāva* — *mohana*, *mādana* and the rest — contained in “*prema-vaicittya*.” The *prākṛta-sahajiyā* cannot follow this. The *prākṛta-sahajiyā* will only be eager to drag the meaning of Śrī Rāmānanda's song into *kevala-nirviśeṣa-vāda*. But that was neither what Śrī Rāmānanda meant to say nor what Śrī Gaurasundara was to hear. Therefore Śrī Gaurasundara judged it improper to proclaim the hidden wonder and uniqueness of *bhajana* in a society of shallow material philosophers, and with His own hand He covered the lotus mouth of Śrī Rāmānanda, who was singing of Kṛṣṇa. This establishes that the song cannot be grasped by the experience of a material philosopher who looks at the external world.

If, however, the reasoning given above is adopted, the field of the *śuddhādvaita-vādī* can be established in place of *kevalādvaita-vāda*. The *śuddhādvaita-vādī* says: the nondual knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*) that is pointed to in an effort to remove the inferiority present in the dual world is imaginary; it has no *prema-

vilāsa*. Moreover, in *prema-vilāsa-vivarta* the line *nā so ramaṇa, nā hāma ramaṇī* (“he is not the lover, nor am I the beloved”)[43] can be misinterpreted. If this *vivarta* of interpretation seizes the material *vivarta-vādī*, it makes him call the attainment of *kevalādvaita* — the absence of *viṣaya* and *āśraya* — “*advaya-jñāna*,” and throws him back into material *vivarta*. Here the *śuddhādvaita-vādī* says: the words *nā so ramaṇa, nā hāma ramaṇī* do not destroy the real truth; their aim is to remove the apprehension of impure duality that arises when, in the Reality, the Reality and its potency are distinguished. To say this in the language of the *viśiṣṭādvaita-vādī*: the Reality is hard to know, but when potency (*śakti*) and its possessor (*śaktimān*) are known as nondifferent, the Reality becomes knowable through knowing the potency. Some separate the potency of the Reality from the Reality and imagine two separate entities, the “*ramaṇa*” (the lover) and the “*ramaṇī*” (the beloved). In their judgment this statement of Śrī Rāmānanda merely removes the distinction between a material possessor of potency and material potency.

The community of *prākṛta-sahajiyās* thinks that the material enjoyer, the “*ramaṇa*,” is different from the material object of enjoyment, the “*ramaṇī*,” and greatly honors impure dualistic reasoning. To be saved from it, the reasoning of *cintya-dvaitādvaita* was introduced. The *acintya-bhedābheda* reasoning of Śrī Rāmānanda or Śrī Gaurasundara is somewhat different from this. Here the reasoning of *śuddha-dvaita* and the reasoning of *acintya-bhedābheda* should be considered of one order. The *acintya-bhedābheda* reasoning differs from the reasonings of the *śuddhādvaita-vādī*, the *śuddha-dvaita-vādī*, the *cintya-dvaitādvaita-vādī* and the *viśiṣṭādvaita-vādī*. Therefore the Ācārya of *acintya-bhedābheda*, Himself not different from Vrajendranandana, proclaimed this through the holy mouth of Śrī Rāmānanda, the transcendental *sahajika*. It is of this very Rāmānanda that Śrī Gaurāṅgasundara said: “In the whole southern country I have seen no one like you, who follows the transcendental *sahaja-dharma*. ‘I am one *bāul*, you are a second *bāul*! Therefore you and I are equal.’”[44] In saying this Śrī Gaurasundara displayed the reasoning of *acintya-bhedābheda*; therefore Śrī Jīvapāda in his *Sarva-saṁvādinī* accepted the Vedānta philosophy of the Gauḍīyas as “*acintya-bhedābheda*.”

In explaining *acintya-bhedābheda* the community of *prākṛta-sāhajikas* tells the story of bathing in the Gaṅgā with a body smeared with oil; but this is merely a *vivarta* of the material world. From such an example the truth of the manifestation of *bhedābheda* cannot be known. In establishing the nondifference

of potency and its possessor, Śrī Rāmānanda's song shows the lover and the beloved as if exchanging the awareness of their own *svarūpa* (*vyatyaya*) — precisely in order to explain clearly how the *viṣaya* awakens (*uddīpana*) the *āśraya* and the *āśraya* awakens the *viṣaya*. Yet let no *jīva* on this account become an *ahaṅgrahopāsaka*. *Ahaṅgrahopāsanā* is the folly of the *cin-mātra-vādī* and simply the opposite of spiritual *vilāsa*. It is for the sake of those who think that the nondual Reality (*advaya-jñāna-vastu*) has no *bhāva* of the *āśraya* that Śrī Kṛṣṇa's eternal Gaura-līlā, abiding in Goloka in the chamber of magnanimity (*audārya*), descends into the world. This exemplary pastime of *prema-vilāsa-vivarta* shows that the Gaura-līlā descended into the world will never be an object of enjoyment for the "Gaura-nāgarīs," who teach material *sambhoga*. Transcendental *prema-vilāsa* has no need of imaginary messengers such as "Kāñcanā." If one proclaims the topics of the *rasa* of worshipping Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-bhajana-rasa*) in a world starving for *kṛṣṇa-kathā*, the community of *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, wishing to show itself equal to the pure devotees, may fall into the *vivarta* of various doctrines. Knowing this, all these explanations have been kept for people of pure devotion alone.

এত বলি' আপন-কৃত গীত এক গাহিল ।
প্রেমে প্রভু স্বহস্তে তাঁর মুখ আচ্ছাদিল ॥ ১৯২ ॥

eta bali' āpana-kṛta gīta eka gāhila
so saying of his own composing a song one he sang
preme prabhu sva-haste tāṁra mukha ācchādila
in love the Lord with His own hand his mouth covered

192 Saying this, he sang a song of his own composition, and the Lord, overwhelmed with love, covered Rāya's mouth with His own hand.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"O Rāmānanda, all that you have said — the determination of the 'goal' (*sādhya*), the description of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, and the greatness of the pastimes of the Two — is true. But if there is anything beyond this, tell it." Rāya replied, "Beyond this I see no further course for the intellect. But there is one *bhāva* called '*prema-vilāsa-vivarta*,' and of that I shall speak; only I cannot say whether hearing it will please You." The purport is this: "Thus far I have described the true nature of the pastimes of love (*prema-vilāsa*). In the truth of *prema-vilāsa*

there are two kinds of *bhāva*: *sambhoga* and *vipralambha*. Without *vipralambha*, *sambhoga* is not nourished. Separation itself is called ‘*vipralambha*’; this is the *vivarta* of *prema-vilāsa*, that is, during separation, by the force of *adhirūḍha-bhāva*, *sambhoga* is manifest (*sphūrti*) even without *sambhoga*.” Hardly had Rāya Rāmānanda begun to sing a song of his own composition about this *rasa* when Mahāprabhu, overwhelmed by His own *bhāva*, covered his mouth. The song is Śrīmatī's words in separation, that is, the manifestation of *sambhoga* in the state of *vipralambha*.

A song composed by Rāya Rāmānanda himself —

পহিলেহি রাগ নয়নভঙ্গে ভেল ।
অনুদিন বাঢ়ল, অবধি না গেল ॥
না সো রমণ, না হাম রমণী ।
দুঁহু-মন মনোভব পেষল জানি’ ॥
এ সখি, সে-সব প্রেমকাহিনী ।
কানুঠামে কহবি বিছুরল জানি’ ॥
না খোঁজলুঁ দূতী, না খোঁজলুঁ আন্ ।
দুঁহুকো মিলনে মধ্যে পাঁচবাণ ॥
অব্ সোহি বিরাগ, তুঁহু ভেলি দূতী ।
সু-পুরুখ-প্রেমকি ঐছন রীতি ॥ ১৯৩ ॥

pahilehi rāga nayana-bhaṅge bhela
from the very first rāga through the play of the eyes arose
anudina bāḍhala, avadhi nā gela
day by day it grew a bound not it reached
nā so ramaṇa, nā hāma ramaṇī
not He the lover not I the beloved
duṁhu-mana manobhava peṣala jāni'
of the two the hearts Manobhava ground into one knowing
e sakhi, se-saba prema-kāhinī
O friend all those of love stories
kānu-ṭhāme kahabi vichurala jāni'
to Kānu you will tell He has forgotten knowing
nā khoṁjaluṁ dūtī, nā khoṁjaluṁ ān
not we sought a messenger not we sought anyone else
duṁhuko milane madhye pāṁca-bāṇa
of the two at the meeting in between the five arrows
ab sohi virāga, tuṁhu bheli dūtī
now that very virāga you have become the messenger
su-purukha-premaki aichana rīti
of a fine hero of the love such the way

193 "From the very first, love (*rāga*) arose from the play of our eyes. Day by day it grew and knew no bound. He was not the lover, nor was I the beloved: Manobhava, the god of love, blended our two hearts into one. O friend, if you find that He has forgotten, tell Kānu the whole story of our love. We sought no messenger and asked no one else: when we met, the five arrows were our go-between. Now that very *rāga* has become *virāga*, the pain of separation, and you have become the messenger. Such is the way of love for an excellent hero."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Ah, in the time of *pūrva-rāga*, before We had met, when We looked at each other a feeling arose that is called *rāga*. That *rāga* grew and grew and reached no 'limit' (*avadhi*), no measure. That *rāga* is born of the very nature of Us both. It is not that Kṛṣṇa, the enjoyer (*ramaṇa*), is its cause, nor that I, the enjoyed one (*ramaṇī*), am its cause. The *rāga* that arose when We saw each other became Manobhava, that is, Madana; it ground Our hearts together and made

them one. Now it is the time of separation. O friend, if you see that Kṛṣṇa has forgotten all those stories of Our love, tell Him this: when We met, We sought no messenger (*dūtī*) and asked no one else for anything — the five arrows of Anaṅga were the go-between of Our meeting. And now, in separation, that *rāga* has become *virāga*, that is, a special *rāga* — the *rāga* of separation, *adhirūḍha-bhāva* — and you, friend, are acting as the messenger! In the love of a noble hero you will see this custom everywhere."

The meaning is this. In the time of *sambhoga*, *rāga* is a go-between, as it were, in the form of Anaṅga. In the time of *vipralambha* it likewise becomes a messenger filled with *adhirūḍha-bhāva*, and serves as the messenger in *prema-vilāsa-vivarta*, that is, in the appearance of *sambhoga* in the midst of *vipralambha*; and so Śrīmatī addresses it as "friend" (*sakhī*) and speaks these words. The essential meaning is this: in the *sambhoga* of *prema-vilāsa* there is joy, and in *vipralambha* there is the same joy. More than that, in *vipralambha* (because at the summit of service She is absorbed in Kṛṣṇa) — just as one takes a snake for a rope[33] — a special kind of *sambhoga* arises: *adhirūḍha-mahābhāva* overcome by *vivarta*, in which She takes a *tamāla* tree and other things for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Pahilehi — first of all. ***Rāga*** — *pūrva-rāga*: "The *rati* that is born before meeting, from seeing, hearing and so on, and that blossoms in the two, the wise call *pūrva-rāga*."[45] ***Nayana-bhaṅge*** — in exchanging glances with each other; by the play of the eyes, that is, by sidelong glances — signs that join the feelings of their hearts. ***Anudina bāḍhala*** — grew day by day. ***Avadhi nā gela*** — no limit remained.

In mature (*prauḍhā*) *samarthā-rati* there are ten states: intense longing (*lālasā*), anxiety (*udvega*), sleeplessness (*jāgaryā*), emaciation (*tānava*), numbness (*jaḍatā*), impatience (*vyagratā*), sickness (*vyādhi*), madness (*unmāda*), fainting (*moha*) and death (*mṛtyu*); that is, anxious thought (*cintā*), wakefulness (*jāgara*), anxiety, emaciation, uncleanliness of the body (*malināṅgatā*), incoherent speech (*pralāpa*), sickness, madness, fainting and death. In *samañjasā-rati* there are six states: desire (*abhilāṣa*), anxious thought, remembrance (*smṛti*), praise of qualities (*guṇa-kīrtana*), anxiety, and madness with lamentation (*savilāpa unmāda*). In *sādhāraṇī-rati* there are sixteen kinds, that is, [the states] of *prauḍhā* and *samañjasā* up to madness with lamentation.

So — that enjoyer (*ramaṇa*), Śrī Kṛṣṇa; ***hāma*** — I, Śrī Rādhikā, the enjoyed one (*ramaṇī*). Neither of Us is its cause — in other words, We have no sense of being separate. ***Manobhava*** — Kandarpa: knowing this, he ground (*peṣala*) the hearts of both, the *ramaṇa* and the *ramaṇī*. ***Prema-kāhinī*** — the pastimes of love (*prema-vilāsa*). ***Kānu-ṭhāme*** — to Kṛṣṇa, in His presence. ***Kahabi*** — you will say. ***Bichurala*** — has forgotten. ***Jāni*** — knowing. ***Khoṅjaluṅ*** — We sought. ***Dūtī*** — she who acts as a go-between and brings hero and heroine together, that is, arranges their meeting. Messengers are of two kinds: the self-messenger (*svayaṁ-dūtī*) and the trusted messenger (*āpta-dūtī*). The self-messengers are the sidelong glance and the sound of the flute; the trusted messengers are Vīrā, Vṛndā and others. The ordinary messengers (*sādhāraṇa-dūtī*) are the craftswoman (*śilpa-kāriṇī*), the fortune-teller (*daivajñā*), the female ascetic (*liṅginī*) and others. ***Nā khoṅjaluṅ ān*** — We asked or sought no one else. ***Duṅhuke*** — of these two, Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. ***Milane*** — in Their union; ***madhye pāča-bāṇa*** — the five arrows born of form, taste, smell, sound and touch. ***Ab*** — now. ***Sohi*** — that *rāga*. ***Virāga*** — *adhirūḍha-mahābhāva* in separation (*vipralambha*). ***Tuṅhu*** — you. ***Bheli*** — have become. ***Su-purukha*** — of the excellent hero (*nāyaka*). ***Premaka*** — of love. ***Aichana*** — such.

The state in which the illusion of difference between Them is dispelled —

রাধায়া ভবতশ্চ চিত্তজতুনী স্বেদৈর্বিলাপ্য ক্রমাদ্-
যুঞ্জন্নদ্রি-নিকুঞ্জ-কুঞ্জরপতে নির্ধূত-ভেদভ্রমম্ ।
চিত্রায় স্বয়মন্বরঞ্জয়দিহ ব্রহ্মাণ্ডহর্ম্ম্যোদরে
ভূয়োভির্নব-রাগ-হিঙ্গুলভরৈঃ শৃঙ্গার-কারুকৃতী ॥ ১৯৪ ॥

rādhāyā bhavataś ca citta-jatunī svedair vilāpya kramād
of Rādhā of You and the lac of the hearts with the sweat melting gradually
yuñjann adri-nikuñja-kuñjara-pate nirdhūta-bheda-bhramam
joining of the hill of the bowers of the elephants O lord with removed of difference the illusion
citrāya svayam anvarañjayad iha brahmāṇḍa-harmyodare
for wonder himself colored here of the universe of the palace within
bhūyobhir nava-rāga-hiṅgula-bharaiḥ śṛṅgāra-kārukṛtī
with abundant of new rāga of vermilion masses of śṛṅgāra the skilled artist

194 “O lord of elephants, You who sport in the bowers of the hill! The artist skilled in *śṛṅgāra* gradually melted the lac of Rādhā’s heart and of Yours with the sweat of ecstasy and joined them, so that all thought of difference vanished. Then, here within the palace of the universe, he himself coloured them, to the wonder of all, with abundant vermilion of fresh *rāga*.” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi, 14.155)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O king of elephants[34] who dwell in the groves of Govardhana Hill! The Creator, expert in the art of *śṛṅgāra*, melted the lac of Your heart and Rādhikā's heart by the power of the *sāttvika-vikāras* and dispelled the illusion of difference. Then, in the palace of the universe, to increase the wonder of the world, He Himself richly dyed those two hearts with the vermilion of new *rāga*.

Anubhāṣya.

he adri-nikuñja-kuñjara-pate (O king of elephants in the forest groves of Govardhana Hill, O You who sport in the groves of Govardhana) **śṛṅgāra-kārukṛtī** (one very skilled in the craft of *śṛṅgāra*) **rādhāyāḥ bhavataś ca citta-jatunī** (the hearts, which are themselves lac) **svedaiḥ** (by transformations — inner and outer melting — or by the heat of fire) **kramāt** (little by little) **vilāpya** (having melted) **nirdhūta-bheda-bhramam** (difference itself is the illusion; having shaken it off and removed it) **yuñjan** (making [them]) **iha brahmāṇḍa-harmyodare** (the universe is a palace; within it) **citrāya** (for a marvel, to increase astonishment) **bhūyobhiḥ** (with manifold) **nava-rāga-hiṅgula-bharaiḥ** (dyes of vermilion — of new *anurāga*) **svayam anvarañjayat** (Himself dyed).

*Here is the limit of the goal (*sādhya*) —*

প্রভু কহে, — ‘সাধ্যবস্তুর অবধি’ এই হয়।
তোমার প্রসাদে ইহা জানিলুঁ নিশ্চয় ॥ ১৯৫ ॥

prabhu kahe, — ‘sādhya-vastura avadhi’ ei haya
the Lord said of the goal the limit this is
tomāra prasāde ihā jāniluṁ niścaya
by your grace this I have known for certain

195 The Lord said, “This is the limit of the goal (*sādhya-vastu*). By your grace I have come to know it for certain.

*The goal is attained only by *sādhana* —*

‘সাধ্যবস্তু’ ‘সাধন’ বিনা কেহ নাহি পায়।
কৃপা করি’ কহ, রায়, পাবার উপায় ॥ ১৯৬ ॥

‘sādhya-vastu’ ‘sādhana’ vinā keha nāhi pāya
the goal sādhana without anyone not attains
kṛpā kari’ kaha, rāya, pābāra upāya
mercy showing tell Rāya of attaining the means

196 No one attains the goal without *sādhana*. Be kind, Rāya, and tell Me the means of attaining it.”

Rāya submits to the Lord's will —

রায় কহে, — যেই কহাও, সেই কহি বাণী।
কি কহিয়ে ভাল-মন্দ, কিছুই না জানি ॥ ১৯৭ ॥

rāya kahe, — yei kahāo, sei kahi vāṇī
Rāya said whatever You make me say that I speak words
ki kahiye bhāla-manda, kichui nā jāni
what I say good or bad anything not I know

197 Rāya said, “Whatever You make me say, those are the words I speak. Whether what I say is good or bad, I do not know at all.

ত্রিভুবন-মধ্যে ঐছে হয় কোন্ ধীর।
যে তোমার মায়া-নাটে হইবেক স্থির ॥ ১৯৮ ॥

tribhuvana-madhye aiche haya kon dhīra
of the three worlds in the midst so is who steady
ye tomāra māyā-nāṭe haibeka sthira
who in Your of māyā the drama will be firm

198 Who in the three worlds is so steady that he can stay firm in the drama staged by Your power (*māyā*)?

Through Rāya's mouth the Lord Himself speaks and Himself listens —

মোর মুখে বক্তা তুমি, তুমি হও শ্রোতা ।
অত্যন্ত রহস্য, শুন, সাধনের কথা ॥ ১৯৯ ॥

mora mukhe vaktā tumi, tumi hao śrotā
through my mouth the speaker You You are the listener
atyanta rahasya, śuna, sādhanera kathā
most secret hear of sādhana the account

199 You are the speaker through my mouth, and You are also the listener. Now hear the account of *sādhana*, which is most secret.

*A description of the secret of *sādhana*; the mood of a beloved (*kānta-bhāva*) is attainable only in *madhura-rasa* —*

রাধাকৃষ্ণের লীলা এই অতি গূঢ়তর ।
দাস্য-বাৎসল্যাদি-ভাবে না হয় গোচর ॥ ২০০ ॥

rādhā-kṛṣṇera līlā ei ati gūḍhatara
of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa the pastimes these very deeply hidden
dāsya-vātsalyādi-bhāve nā haya gocara
of servitude parental love and the rest in the moods not become perceptible

200 These pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are deeply hidden. They cannot be perceived in the moods of servitude, parental love and the rest.

*The pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are nourished only by the *sakhīs* who follow Them —*

সবে এক সখীগণের ইহাঁ অধিকার ।
সখী হৈতে হয় এই লীলার বিস্তার ॥ ২০১ ॥

sabe eka sakhī-gaṇera ihāṁ adhikāra
only alone of the sakhīs here the right
sakhī haite haya ei līlāra vistāra
from the sakhīs comes of this pastime the unfolding

201 Only the *sakhīs* have the right of entry here, and from the *sakhīs* comes the unfolding of these pastimes.

সখী বিনা এই লীলা পুষ্ট নাহি হয় ।
সখী লীলা বিস্তারিয়া, সখী আস্বাদয় ॥ ২০২ ॥

sakhī vinā ei līlā puṣṭa nāhi haya
the sakhīs without this pastime nourished not is
sakhī līlā vistāriyā, sakhī āsvādaya
the sakhīs the pastime unfolding the sakhīs relish

202 Without the *sakhīs* these pastimes are not nourished. The *sakhīs* unfold the pastimes, and the *sakhīs* relish them.

সখী বিনা এই লীলায় অন্যের নাহি গতি ।
সখী ভাবে যে তাঁরে করে অনুগতি ॥ ২০৩ ॥

রাধাকৃষ্ণ-কুঞ্জসেবা-সাধ্য সেই পায় ।
সেই সাধ্য পাইতে আর নাহিক উপায় ॥ ২০৪ ॥

sakhī vinā ei līlāya anyera nāhi gati
the sakhīs without into this pastime of others there is no access
sakhī-bhāve ye tāṁre kare anugati
in the mood of the sakhīs who them does following
rādhā-kṛṣṇa-kuñjasevā-sādhya sei pāya
to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa in the bowers of service the goal he attains
sei sādhya pāite āra nāhika upāya
that goal to attain other there is no means

203–204 Without the *sakhīs*, no one else has access to these pastimes. One who follows them in the mood of a *sakhī* attains the goal: service to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa in the bowers. To attain that goal there is no other means.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Having heard all this, Mahāprabhu said, “The goal (*sādhya*) has been described in full. Now tell Me the *sādhana*, the means of attaining this highest goal.” In reply Rāmānanda Rāya said, “In the *rasas* of *dāsya*, *vātsalya* and the rest this confidential truth cannot be attained. Without the *sakhīs* of Vraja no one can enter these pastimes. If one accepts the mood of a *sakhī* of Vraja and performs *sādhana* following the *sakhīs*, one attains the goal — service to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa in the groves (*kuñja-sevā*); there is no other means.”

Anubhāṣya.

Sakhī. The *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* says: “A *sakhī* is she who fully expands the pastimes and sports of love; she is a casket holding the jewel of confidence.” She who fully expands the loving pastimes, sports and so on of Śrī Kṛṣṇa is called a *sakhī*. The *sakhīs* are a casket holding the jewel of Kṛṣṇa's confidence.

The activities of the *sakhīs*: “To praise to each other the love and qualities of the two, to awaken Their attachment, to arrange the meeting (*abhisāra*) of the two, to offer [another] *sakhī* to Kṛṣṇa, to jest, to reassure, to dress [Them], to skillfully open the heart, to conceal Her faults, to deceive her husband and others, to instruct, to bring Them together at the right time, to serve by fanning and so on, to reproach both of Them, to send messages, and to strive to protect the heroine's life — these are the activities of a *sakhī*.” That is: (1) praising the love and qualities of the hero and heroine to each other; (2) increasing the attachment of each for the other; (3) arranging the meeting (*abhisāra*) of the two; (4) offering a *sakhī* to Kṛṣṇa; (5) jesting; (6) giving reassurance; (7) dressing the hero and heroine (*nepathya*); (8) skill in expressing the feelings hidden in the heart; (9) concealing the heroine's faults; (10) deceiving her husband and others; (11) instruction; (12) bringing hero and heroine together at the proper time; (13) fanning with a *cāmara* and so on; (14) reproaching both; (15) sending messages; (16) striving to protect the heroine's life. See Ādi 4.211, 217–218.

The “Sakhī-bhekī,” the “Gaura-nāgarī” and other groups of *prākṛta-sahajiyās* identify with the body and adorn the material body, senses and skin — food for dogs and jackals. That never pleases Kṛṣṇa. All such artificial efforts, foreign to Kṛṣṇa, gratify only the material senses, and so Kṛṣṇa takes no enjoyment and no joy in them. The body, home, dress, ornaments and every act and effort of the spiritual Śrī Rādhā and Her *sakhīs* are all spiritual; they all please Kṛṣṇa's senses and bring Kṛṣṇa under their control; none of them is an event or object of the

fourteen worlds within Devī-dhāma. Kṛṣṇa is the enchanter of the worlds; they, however, enchant not the worlds but the heart of Him who enchants the worlds.

To yield to a mind bent on enjoyment and imagine oneself a *sakhī* in an imagined *siddha* body is also nothing but *ahaṅgrahopāsanā* (worshipping oneself as God); as a result the one who imagines this stays on in Devī-dhāma. Śrīla Jīva Gosvāmī Prabhu warned the conditioned *jīvas* about this too. Thus in the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* (Eastern Division, second wave) his commentary *Durgama-saṅgamanī* on the verse *pūrvair vatsala-sakhyādau…* says: "The meaning is: but not with the self-identification of being the king of Vraja and so on. The conception of being [His] father and so on can arise in two ways: as an independent [identity], and by imagining oneself identical with His father and others. Of these the latter is improper, just as worshipping oneself as identical with Bhagavān is improper: for their eternity will be established just like that of Bhagavān Himself, and so [such identification] is improper; and also because by such a particular conception about His associates one falls into offense." That is why Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu said (ibid.): "Remembering Kṛṣṇa and His dear associate whom one longs to serve, and delighting in talks about them, one should always live in Vraja. Longing for that *bhāva*, one should serve both in the *sādhaka* form and in the *siddha* form, following the people of Vraja." (Commentary: "The people of Vraja here are those dear to Kṛṣṇa and those who follow them; following them.") See Madhya 22.153, 155 and 157.

**Śṛṅgāra-rasa* is nourished by the *sakhīs* —*

বিভুরপি সুখরূপঃ স্বপ্রকাশোঽপি ভাবঃ
ক্ষণমপি ন হি রাধাকৃষ্ণয়োর্যা ঋতে স্বাঃ ।
প্রবহতি রসপুষ্টিং চিদ্বিভূতীরিবেশঃ
শ্রয়তি ন পদমাসাং কঃ সখীনাং রসজ্ঞঃ ॥ ২০৫ ॥

vibhur api sukha-rūpaḥ sva-prakāśo 'pi bhāvaḥ
boundless though happiness in form self-manifest though the bhāva
kṣaṇam api na hi rādhā-kṛṣṇayor yā ṛte svāḥ
a moment even not indeed of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa whom without Their own
pravahati rasa-puṣṭiṁ cid-vibhūtīr iveśaḥ
carries of rasa the fullness spiritual opulences as the Lord
śrayati na padam āsāṁ kaḥ sakhīnāṁ rasa-jñaḥ
takes shelter not at the feet of these who of the sakhīs a knower of rasa

205 "Though the love (*bhāva*) of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa is boundless, happiness itself and self-manifest, without Their own *sakhīs* it never for a moment carries the fullness of rasa, just as the Lord is not full without His spiritual opulences. What knower of rasa, then, would not take shelter at the feet of these *sakhīs*?" (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 10.17)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *bhāva* of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa is self-manifest; by nature it is happiness, and it is *vibhu*, that is, unlimited. Even so, without the *sakhīs* it cannot carry the fullness of *rasa* for even a moment — just as the Lord does not attain the fullness of His lordship without His spiritual opulences (*cid-vibhūti*). Which knower of *rasa* who has entered it, then, would not take shelter at the feet of the *sakhīs*?

Anubhāṣya.

rādhā-kṛṣṇayoḥ (of the youthful couple of Vraja) **bhāvaḥ** (spiritual play), **vibhuḥ** (supremely great) **api**, **sukha-rūpaḥ** (full of eternity, knowledge and bliss), **sva-prakāśaḥ** (self-manifest) **api**, **svāḥ** (Their own — the *sakhīs* who belong to Them and are *kāya-vyūhas*) **ṛte** (without) **rasa-puṣṭiṁ na hi pravahati**, **yathā īśaḥ** (the Lord) **cid-vibhūtīḥ iva** (that is: just as the Lord, full of eternity, knowledge and bliss, does not attain fullness without His eternal spiritual opulences and so on, so here too); (for this reason) **kaḥ rasa-jñaḥ** (an expert knower of the truth of Kṛṣṇa) **āsāṁ sakhīnāṁ padaṁ na śrayati** (would not take shelter? All expert devotees who know *madhura-rasa* take shelter at the feet of the *sakhīs*). (The Īśvara of the *kevalādvaita-vādīs* is a form stamped with imagination, the deity presiding over aggregate ignorance. Though he is endowed with opulences — the *jīvas* and the rest, which are called transformations of impure *sattva* presiding over individual ignorance — he is, like a eunuch, devoid of eternal, real play. The Īśvara worshiped by the *viśiṣṭādvaita-vādīs* is an eternal form of eternity, knowledge and bliss, eternally full of spirit and bliss; by His

eternal particular opulences — internal, homogeneous and heterogeneous — He nourishes two and a half *rasas*: *śānta*, *dāsya* and half of *sakhya*. In the same way, the wholly complete and blissful Śrī Vārṣabhānavī and Vrajendranandana, though self-manifest, eternally nourish *rasa* together with the *sakhīs* — that is the idea.)

*The *sakhīs'* love for Śrī Rādhā —*

সখীর স্বভাব এক অকথ্য-কথন ।
কৃষ্ণ-সহ নিজলীলায় নাহি সখীর মন ॥ ২০৬ ॥

sakhīra svabhāva eka akathya-kathana
of the sakhīs the nature one indescribable
kṛṣṇa-saha nija-līlāya nāhi sakhīra mana
with Kṛṣṇa in their own pastimes there is not of the sakhīs the mind

206 The *sakhīs* have one nature that words cannot describe: they have no wish for pastimes of their own with Kṛṣṇa.

কৃষ্ণ-সহ রাধিকার লীলা যে করায় ।
নিজ-সুখ হৈতে তাতে কোটি সুখ পায় ॥ ২০৭ ॥

kṛṣṇa-saha rādhikāra līlā ye karāya
with Kṛṣṇa Rādhikā's pastimes which they arrange
nija-sukha haite tāte koṭi sukha pāya
than their own happiness in that ten million times happiness they find

207 By arranging Rādhikā's pastimes with Kṛṣṇa they find happiness ten million times greater than their own.

*The bond of love between Rādhā and the *sakhīs* —*

রাধার স্বরূপ — কৃষ্ণপ্রেম-কল্পলতা ।
সখীগণ হয় তার পল্লব-পুষ্প-পাতা ॥ ২০৮ ॥

rādhāra svarūpa — kṛṣṇa-prema-kalpalatā
Rādhā's own nature for Kṛṣṇa of love the wish-fulfilling creeper
sakhī-gaṇa haya tāra pallava-puṣpa-pātā
the sakhīs are its shoots flowers leaves

208 Rādhā's own nature is the wish-fulfilling creeper of love for Kṛṣṇa, and the *sakhīs* are its shoots, flowers and leaves.

কৃষ্ণলীলামৃত যদি লতাকে সিঞ্চয় ।
নিজ-সুখ হৈতে পল্লবাদ্যের কোটি-সুখ হয় ॥ ২০৯ ॥

kṛṣṇa-līlāmṛta yadi latāke siñcaya
of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes the nectar if the creeper waters
nija-sukha haite pallavādyera koṭi-sukha haya
than their own happiness of the shoots and the rest ten-million-fold happiness arises

209 When the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes waters the creeper, the shoots and the rest feel ten million times more happiness than if they themselves were watered.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrī Rādhā is Herself Kṛṣṇa's wish-fulfilling creeper of love, and the *sakhīs* are the shoots, flowers and leaves of that creeper. If one takes shelter at the feet of Rādhikā, who is that creeper, and waters the creeper, the shoots and the rest blossom wonderfully. If one waters the shoots themselves, they do not blossom so. In the same way the gopīs are happier from the meeting of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa than from their own meeting with Kṛṣṇa.

সখ্যঃ শ্রীরাধিকায়া ব্রজকুমুদবিধোর্হ্লাদিনী-নামশক্তেঃ
সারাংশ-প্রেমবল্ল্যাঃ কিসলয়দলপুষ্পাদিতুল্যাঃ স্বতুল্যাঃ ।
সিক্তায়াং কৃষ্ণলীলামৃতরসনিচয়ৈরুল্লসন্ত্যামমুষ্যাং
জাতোল্লাসাঃ স্বসেকাচ্ছতগুণমধিকং সন্তি যত্তন্ন চিত্রম্ ॥ ২১০ ॥

sakhyaḥ śrī-rādhikāyā vraja-kumuda-vidhor hlādinī-nāma-śakteḥ
the sakhīs of Śrī Rādhikā of Vraja of the lilies of the moon hlādinī named of the potency

sārāṁśa-prema-vallyāḥ kisalaya-dala-puṣpādi-tulyāḥ sva-tulyāḥ
of the essence of prema of the creeper shoots leaves flowers and so on like equal to Her

siktāyāṁ kṛṣṇa-līlāmṛta-rasa-nicayair ullasantyām amuṣyāṁ
when watered of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes of the nectar of rasa with floods rejoicing She

jātollāsāḥ sva-sekāc chata-guṇam adhikaṁ santi yat tan na citram
filled with joy than from their own watering a hundredfold more they become that this not a wonder

210 "The *sakhīs* of Śrī Rādhikā are equal to Her. Rādhikā is Hlādinī, the potency of Kṛṣṇa, the moon who delights the lilies of Vraja, and the *sakhīs* are like the shoots, leaves and flowers of Her creeper of prema, the essence of that potency. When She is watered with floods of the nectarean rasa of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes and rejoices, they become a hundred times more joyful than if they themselves were watered — and in this there is nothing to wonder at." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 10.16)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *sakhīs* of Vraja are equal to Śrī Rādhā. Śrī Rādhikā is the potency called *hlādinī* of Kṛṣṇa, the moon for the night-lilies of Vraja, and the *sakhīs* are like the young leaves, shoots, flowers and so on of the creeper of Her *prema*, the essence of that potency. When Rādhikā, full of the highest joy, is watered with the many nectarean *rasas* of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, the *sakhīs* become a hundred times more joyful than from being watered themselves — and there is nothing surprising in this.

Anubhāṣya.

vraja-kumuda-vidhoḥ (of Kṛṣṇacandra, who delights the people of Vraja as the moon delights the night-lilies) **hlādinī-nāma-śakteḥ** (of the potency called *hlādinī*) **rādhikāyāḥ sārāṁśa-prema-vallyāḥ** (the *prema* that is the essence of that potency is itself the creeper; [the shoots] of that creeper) **kiśalaya-dala-puṣpādi-tulyāḥ** (like young leaves, flowers and so on), and therefore **sva-tulyāḥ** (equal to Her) **sakhyaḥ** (Lalitā and the other *priya-narma-sakhīs*) — when

amuṣyāṁ (She, Rādhā) **kṛṣṇa-līlāmṛta-rasa-nicayaiḥ siktāyām** (is watered) and **ullasantyām** (rejoices), those *sakhīs* **sva-sekāt** (than from their own watering) **śata-guṇam adhikaṁ jātollāsāḥ** (filled with joy) **santi** — **yat**, **tat na citram** (that is not astonishing).

*Śrī Rādhikā's love for the *sakhīs* —*

যদ্যপি সখীর কৃষ্ণ-সঙ্গমে নাহি মন ।
তথাপি রাধিকা যত্নে করান সঙ্গম ॥ ২১১ ॥

yadyapi sakhīra kṛṣṇa-saṅgame nāhi mana
although of the sakhīs for meeting with Kṛṣṇa there is not the mind
tathāpi rādhikā yatne karāna saṅgama
still Rādhikā with effort arranges the meeting

211 Although the *sakhīs* have no wish to meet Kṛṣṇa for themselves, Rādhikā takes pains to arrange their meeting with Him.

নানা-ছলে কৃষ্ণে প্রেরি' সঙ্গম করায় ।
আত্মসুখ-সঙ্গ হৈতে কোটি-সুখ পায় ॥ ২১২ ॥

nānā-chale kṛṣṇe preri' saṅgama karāya
by various pretexts to Kṛṣṇa sending meeting She arranges
ātma-sukha-saṅga haite koṭi-sukha pāya
than Her own happy meeting ten-million-fold happiness She finds

212 Under various pretexts She sends them to Kṛṣṇa and arranges their meeting, and from this She finds ten million times more happiness than from Her own meeting with Him.

*Kṛṣṇa's happiness in the mutual love of Śrī Rādhā and the *sakhīs* —*

অন্যোন্যে বিশুদ্ধ প্রেমে করে রস পুষ্ট ।
তাঁ-সবার প্রেম দেখি' কৃষ্ণ হয় তুষ্ট ॥ ২১৩ ॥

anyonye viśuddha preme kare rasa puṣṭa
one another with pure love they make the rasa nourished
tāṁ-sabāra prema dekhi' kṛṣṇa haya tuṣṭa
of them all the love seeing Kṛṣṇa becomes pleased

213 With pure love for one another they nourish the rasa, and Kṛṣṇa is delighted to see their love.

Anubhāṣya.
Anyonye — with one another. Śrī Rādhikā and Her *sakhīs* make no effort at all for their own happiness: each moves the other to serve Kṛṣṇa and so nourishes *prema*. Seeing this, Kṛṣṇa is pleased.

সহজ গোপীর প্রেম, — নহে প্রাকৃত-কাম ।
কামক্রীড়া-সাম্যে তার কহি 'কাম'-নাম ॥ ২১৪ ॥

sahaja gopīra prema, — nahe prākṛta kāma
natural of the gopīs the love is not worldly kāma
kāma-krīḍā-sāmye tāra kahi 'kāma'-nāma
to the play of kāma by its likeness it they call kāma by the name

214 The natural love of the gopīs is not worldly *kāma*. It is called "*kāma*" only because it resembles the play of *kāma*.

প্রেমৈব গোপরামাণাং কাম ইত্যগমৎ প্রথাম্ ।
ইত্যুদ্ধবাদয়োঽপ্যেতং বাঞ্ছন্তি ভগবৎপ্রিয়াঃ ॥ ২১৫ ॥

premaiva gopa-rāmāṇāṁ
love itself of the cowherd women
kāma ity agamat prathām
as kāma so attained fame
ity uddhavādayo 'py etaṁ
therefore Uddhava and others even it
vāñchanti bhagavat-priyāḥ
desire dear to the Lord

215 "It is the prema of the cowherd women that became famed under the name *kāma*; and so even Uddhava and others dear to the Lord long for

it.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.285)[25]

নিজেন্দ্রিয়সুখহেতু কামের তাৎপর্য্য ।
কৃষ্ণসুখ-তাৎপর্য্য গোপীভাব-বর্য্য ॥ ২১৬ ॥

nijendriya-sukha-hetu kāmera tātparya
of one’s own senses of the pleasure for the sake of kāma the aim
kṛṣṇa-sukha-tātparya gopī-bhāva-varya
Kṛṣṇa’s happiness the aim of the gopīs of the mood supreme

216 The aim of *kāma* is the pleasure of one’s own senses, but the aim of the gopīs’ supreme love is Kṛṣṇa’s happiness.

নিজেন্দ্রিয়সুখবাঞ্ছা নাহি গোপীকার ।
কৃষ্ণে সুখ দিতে করে সঙ্গম-বিহার ॥ ২১৭ ॥

nijendriya-sukha-vāñchā nāhi gopīkāra
of their own senses for the pleasure desire there is not of the gopīs
kṛṣṇe sukha dite kare saṅgama-vihāra
to Kṛṣṇa happiness to give they do of union the play

217 The gopīs have no desire for the pleasure of their own senses. They join Kṛṣṇa in the play of union only to give Him happiness.

Anubhāṣya.

Kāma is not a disposition devoted to the service of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the embodiment of *saṁvit*: its aim is the happiness of something other than Śrī Kṛṣṇa. *Prema* aims solely at Śrī Kṛṣṇa's happiness and consists entirely of service to Kṛṣṇa. The *kāma* of the gopīs is really *prema*, for the gopīs do not seek the pleasure of their own senses. Only for Kṛṣṇa's happiness do they move *sakhīs* of their own circle to serve Him, and they themselves, moved by such *sakhīs*, serve Kṛṣṇa — they merely accept *kāma* directed to Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-kāma*). See Ādi 4.162–166.

যত্তে সুজাতচরণাম্বুরুহং স্তনেষু
ভীতাঃ শনৈঃ প্রিয় দধীমহি কর্কশেষু ।
তেনাটবীমটসি তদ্ব্যথতে ন কিংস্বিৎ
কূর্পাদিভির্ভ্রমতি ধীর্ভবদায়ুষাং নঃ ॥ ২১৮ ॥

yat te sujāta-caraṇāmburuhaṁ staneṣu
which Your tender lotus feet on the breasts
bhītāḥ śanaiḥ priya dadhīmahi karkaśeṣu
fearful gently O dear we place hard
tenāṭavīm aṭasi tad vyathate na kiṁ svit
with them the forest You wander they are pained not whether
kūrpādibhir bhramati dhīr bhavad-āyuṣāṁ naḥ
by fine stones and such whirls the mind of whom You are the life our

218 "O dear one, Your tender lotus feet we place gently on our hard breasts, afraid to hurt them — and with those feet You wander through the forest! Are they not hurt by the sharp pebbles? You are our very life, and our minds are reeling." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.19)[26]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 4.173.

*What *rāgānugā-bhakti* is, and how the Śrutis attained Kṛṣṇa —*

সেই গোপীভাবামৃতে যাঁর লোভ হয় ।
বেদধর্ম্ম ত্যজি' সে কৃষ্ণকে ভজয় ॥ ২১৯ ॥

sei gopī-bhāvāmṛte yāṁra lobha haya
for that of the gopīs nectar of the mood whose greed is
veda-dharma tyaji' se kṛṣṇake bhajaya
Vedic dharma giving up he Kṛṣṇa worships

219 One who longs for the nectar of that mood of the gopīs gives up Vedic *dharma* and worships Kṛṣṇa.

রাগানুগ-মার্গে তাঁরে ভজে যেই জন ।
সেই জন পায় ব্রজে ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ॥ ২২০ ॥

rāgānuga-mārge tāṁre bhaje yei jana
of rāgānugā on the path Him worships who the person
sei jana pāya vraje vrajendra-nandana
that person attains in Vraja the son of the king of Vraja

220 One who worships Him on the path of *rāgānugā* attains in Vraja the son of the king of Vraja.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vaidhī-bhakti consists of the sixty-four limbs of *bhajana*; pure faith (*śraddhā*) in it alone gives one the right to it. Seeing the natural *rāga* of the people of Vraja for Kṛṣṇa, some are filled with greed (*lobha*) to walk that path, and this very greed for the nectar of the gopīs' feeling gives them the right to the path of *rāgānugā*. In *bhajana* on the path of *rāgānugā*, giving up attachment to Vedic *dharma* — *varṇāśrama* and the rest — is naturally necessary.

ব্রজলোকের কোন ভাব লঞা যেই ভজে ।
ভাবযোগ্য দেহ পাঞা কৃষ্ণ পায় ব্রজে ॥ ২২১ ॥

vraja-lokera kona bhāva lañā yei bhaje
of the people of Vraja some mood taking up who worships
bhāva-yogya deha pāñā kṛṣṇa pāya vraje
to the mood suited a body receiving Kṛṣṇa attains in Vraja

221 Whoever worships taking up the mood of one of the people of Vraja receives a body suited to that mood and attains Kṛṣṇa in Vraja.

How the Śrutis attained Kṛṣṇa —

তাহাতে দৃষ্টান্ত — উপনিষদ্ শ্রুতিগণ ।
রাগমার্গে ভজি' পাইল ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ॥ ২২২ ॥

tāhāte dṛṣṭānta — upaniṣad śruti-gaṇa
of this the example of the Upaniṣads the Śrutis
rāga-mārge bhaji' pāila vrajendra-nandana
on the path of rāga worshipping they attained the son of the king of Vraja

222 The example of this is the Śrutis of the Upaniṣads: worshipping on the path of *rāga*, they attained the son of the king of Vraja.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In Vraja, Kṛṣṇa's servants — Raktaka, Patraka and others; Kṛṣṇa's friends — Śrīdāmā, Subala and others; Kṛṣṇa's parents — Nanda, Yaśodā and others — serve Kṛṣṇa, each in his own *bhāva*, his own *rasa*. When a person turns to worship in the *rasas* of Vraja and greed awakens in him for one particular *rasa* among them, he attains a spiritual nature (*cit-svarūpa*) fit for that *bhāva*, and at the time of perfection (*siddhi*) he attains Kṛṣṇa. The Upaniṣads, that is, the Śrutis, are an example of this. The Śrutis saw that without following the gopīs one cannot obtain the right to serve Kṛṣṇa in Vraja. Then they accepted the gopīs' guidance and, on the path of *rāga*, in the bodies of gopīs, worshiped Vrajendranandana.

Anubhāṣya.

Rāgānugā-mārga. See Ādi 4.167–169, 175 and Madhya 22.145–162.

*By following the gopīs the Śrutis attain service to Kṛṣṇa in *madhura-rasa* —*

নিভৃতমরুন্মনোঽক্ষদৃঢ়যোগযুজো হৃদি য-
ন্মুনয় উপাসতে তদরয়োঽপি যযুঃ স্মরণাৎ ।
স্ত্রিয় উরগেন্দ্রভোগভুজদণ্ডবিষক্ত ধিয়ো
বয়মপি তে সমাঃ সমদৃশোঽঙ্ঘ্রিসরোজসুধাঃ ॥ ২২৩ ॥

nibhṛta-marun-mano-'kṣa-dṛḍha-yoga-yujo hṛdi yan-
who have restrained breath mind senses in firm yoga engaged in the heart which
munaya upāsate tad arayo 'pi yayuḥ smaraṇāt
the sages worship that the enemies even attained by remembering
striya uragendra-bhoga-bhuja-daṇḍa-viṣakta dhiyo
the women of the king of serpents like the coils to the arms attached in mind
vayam api te samāḥ sama-dṛśo 'ṅghri-saroja-sudhāḥ
we also Your like them sharing their mood of the lotus feet the nectar

223 “That which the sages worship in the heart, having restrained breath, mind and senses in firm yoga, Your enemies attained simply by remembering You. The women whose minds were fixed on Your arms, like the coils of the king of serpents, attained the nectar of Your lotus feet; and we too, having become like them and following their mood, taste that nectar.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.87.23)[2728]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The sages, restraining the breath by *prāṇāyāma* and firmly joining mind and senses in *yoga*, worshiped Brahman in the heart, and the enemies of Bhagavān, by the power of constant thought of Him, also entered that Brahman. The women of Vraja, their minds overcome by the strong poison — the beauty of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's arms, like the body of a serpent — attained the nectar of His lotus feet. We too, having obtained those bodies of gopīs, drank the nectar of His lotus feet in the mood of the gopīs.

Anubhāṣya.

In Janaloka, at the *brahma-satra* sacrifice, Sanandana recounts to the assembled listening sages the Śrutis' prayer to Bhagavān:

nibhṛta-marun-mano-'kṣa-dṛḍha-yoga-yujaḥ (*marut* — the vital airs — the mind and the *akṣas* — the senses — are *nibhṛta*, restrained, by them; that is, they have restrained breath, heart and senses; they unite themselves in firm *yoga* — *dṛḍha-yoga-yujaḥ*; such are they — unwavering, devoted to the Supreme) **munayaḥ yat** (that truth) **hṛdi upāsate** (experience in the heart), **tat arayaḥ** (those who hate Kṛṣṇa) **api** (of You) **smaraṇāt** (by thinking with enmity) **yayuḥ** (attained — reached the impersonal state); **urag-endra-bhoga-bhuja-daṇḍa-viṣakta-dhiyaḥ** (*bhoga* — the body — of the king of serpents, *uragendra*; those whose minds clung to arms like that) **striyaḥ**, **vayam api samāḥ** (as *kāya-vyūhas* of the gopīs, like them in form), **sama-dṛśaḥ** (full of a feeling that follows their feeling), **te** (Your) **aṅghri-saroja-sudhāḥ** (holding fast the lotus feet) — **tat** (that truth, Your form; “we attained” is to be supplied).

The meaning of the words of the verse —

‘সমদৃশঃ’-শব্দে কহে ‘সেই ভাবে অনুগতি’ ।
‘সমাঃ’-শব্দে কহে শ্রুতির গোপীদেহ-প্রাপ্তি ॥ ২২৪ ॥

'sama-dṛśaḥ'-śabde kahe 'sei bhāve anugati'
by the word sama-dṛśaḥ is meant that mood following
'samāḥ'-śabde kahe śrutira gopī-deha-prāpti
by the word samāḥ is meant of the Śrutis of gopīs the bodies the attainment

224 The word *sama-dṛśaḥ* means "following that mood," and the word *samāḥ* means that the Śrutis attained the bodies of gopīs.

'অঙ্ঘ্রিপদ্মসুধা'য় কহে 'কৃষ্ণসঙ্গানন্দ' ।
বিধিমার্গে না পাইয়ে ব্রজে কৃষ্ণচন্দ্র ॥ ২২৫ ॥

'aṅghri-padma-sudhā'ya kahe 'kṛṣṇa-saṅgānanda'
by aṅghri-padma-sudhā is meant with Kṛṣṇa of association the bliss
vidhi-mārge nā pāiye vraje kṛṣṇa-candra
on the path of rules not is attained in Vraja Kṛṣṇacandra

225 The phrase *aṅghri-padma-sudhā* means the bliss of Kṛṣṇa's company. On the path of rules (*vidhi-mārga*) one does not attain Kṛṣṇacandra in Vraja.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the fourth line of the verse, the word *sama-dṛśaḥ* is explained as "following the gopīs' feeling," and the word *samāḥ* as the Śrutis' "attaining the bodies of gopīs." The word *aṅghri-saroja-sudhā* is explained as "the bliss of association with Kṛṣṇa."

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 9.133–134.

*The glory of the *rāgātmikā* devotees —*

নায়ং সুখাপো ভগবান্ দেহিনাং গোপিকাসুতঃ ।
জ্ঞানিনাঞ্চাত্মভূতানাং যথা ভক্তিমতামিহ ॥ ২২৬ ॥

nāyaṁ sukhāpo bhagavān
not this easily attained Bhagavān
dehināṁ gopikā-sutaḥ
for the embodied of the gopī the son
jñāninām cātma-bhūtānāṁ
for the jñānīs and for those who realized the self
yathā bhakti-matām iha
as for those who have devotion here

226 "This Bhagavān, the son of the gopī, is not so easily attained by the embodied, nor by the jñānīs, nor by those who have realized the self, as He is by those who have devotion." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.9.21)[29]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Yaśodā's son, Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇa, is easily attained by embodied beings who possess *bhakti*, but not so by *jñānīs* who have become one with the self (*ātma-bhūta*).[35]

Anubhāṣya.
Seeing Yaśodā's power to bring Kṛṣṇa under her control, Śrī Śukadeva describes to Parīkṣit the glory of the transcendental, natural (*sahaja*) *rāgātmikā-bhakti* of the girls of Vraja:

ayam (the son of the gopī, Yaśodā's son) **bhagavān iha yathā bhakti-matām** (for those who worship on the path of *rāga*) **sukhāpaḥ** (attained without difficulty), **dehinām** (for those who identify with the body), **ātma-bhūtānām** (the *ātmārāmas*, detached from matter and devoted to austerities and vows) **jñāninām ca tathā na** ("attained without difficulty" is to be supplied).

*How a devotee freed from *anarthas* performs *rāgānugā-bhajana* —*

অতএব গোপীভাব করি অঙ্গীকার ।
রাত্রি-দিন চিন্তে রাধাকৃষ্ণের বিহার ॥ ২২৭ ॥

ataeva gopī-bhāva kari aṅgīkāra
therefore of the gopīs the mood making acceptance
rātri-dina cinte rādhā-kṛṣṇera vihāra
night and day one thinks of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa of the pastimes

227 Therefore, accepting the mood of the gopīs, one thinks night and day of the pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

সিদ্ধদেহে চিন্তি' করে তাহাঁঞি সেবন ।
সখীভাবে পায় রাধাকৃষ্ণের চরণ ॥ ২২৮ ॥

siddha-dehe cinti' kare tāhāṁñi sevana
in the perfected body meditating one does there service
sakhī-bhāve pāya rādhā-kṛṣṇera caraṇa
in the mood of a sakhī one attains of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa the feet

228 Meditating in one's perfected spiritual body (*siddha-deha*), one serves there, and in the mood of a *sakhī* one attains the feet of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

Siddha-deha — a spiritual body fit for the service of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, other than the present material body and the subtle body of the mind. By the fruits of material *karma* the *jīva* obtains a material body; in time that body changes, and through the desire for gross enjoyment he again obtains a material body. Through the desire for subtle material enjoyment he takes on a subtle mental body (*liṅga-deha*), enjoys material objects with the mind, and again obtains a similarly changed subtle body. In the same way the pure *jīva*-soul — instead of being born, by the force of the desire for enjoyment, in Devī-dhāma, where matter is enjoyed, and accepting two bodies, gross and subtle, agitated by time — eternally obtains two spiritual bodies in the spiritual Goloka or in Vaikuṇṭha. In them, intent on Kṛṣṇa's happiness, he renders transcendental service to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. The material and subtle bodies cannot think of what lies beyond matter, beyond one's own enjoyment. Therefore the devotee who has passed beyond the three *guṇas*, drawn by Kṛṣṇa's transcendental qualities, thinks of the transcendental with the help of the transcendental senses of his own *siddha* body, which is fit for this; rendering transcendental service, he follows the transcendental mood of the *sakhīs* and attains the transcendental feet of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. See Madhya 22.152–156, 160.

Without following the gopīs, attaining Kṛṣṇa is impossible —

গোপী-আনুগত্য বিনা ঐশ্বর্য্যজ্ঞানে ।
ভজিলেহ নাহি পায় ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দনে ॥ ২২৯ ॥

gopī-ānugatya vinā aiśvarya-jñāne
the gopīs following without in awareness of majesty
bhajileha nāhi pāya vrajendra-nandane
even worshipping not one attains the son of the king of Vraja

229 Without following the gopīs, one who worships with awareness of His majesty (*aiśvarya*) does not attain the son of the king of Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.
In the mood of majesty (*aiśvarya*), on the path of rules (*vidhi-mārga*), one cannot serve Vrajendranandana. Kṛṣṇa is attained only when one is drawn by His sweetness (*mādhurya*) and serves Him following the gopīs. See Ādi 4.176 and Madhya 9.130–135, 137.

*Having refused to follow the gopīs, Lakṣmī proved unfit for the *rāsa* pastimes —*

তাহাতে দৃষ্টান্ত — লক্ষ্মী করিল ভজন ।
তথাপি না পাইল ব্রজে ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ॥ ২৩০ ॥

tāhāte dṛṣṭānta — lakṣmī karila bhajana
of this the example Lakṣmī performed worship
tathāpi nā pāila vraje vrajendra-nandana
still not she attained in Vraja the son of the king of Vraja

230 The example of this is Lakṣmī: she performed worship, yet she did not attain the son of the king of Vraja in Vraja.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 9.111–155 and 14.122–123.

নায়ং শ্রিয়োঽঙ্গ উ নিতান্তরতেঃ প্রসাদঃ
স্বর্যোষিতাং নলিনগন্ধরুচাং কুতোঽন্যাঃ ।
রাসোৎসবেঽস্য ভুজদণ্ডগৃহীতকণ্ঠ-
লব্ধাশিষাং য উদগাদ্ব্রজসুন্দরীণাম্ ॥ ২৩১ ॥

nāyaṁ śriyo 'ṅga u nitānta-rateḥ prasādaḥ
not this of Śrī on the chest indeed wholly attached favour
svar-yoṣitāṁ nalina-gandha-rucāṁ kuto 'nyāḥ
of the celestial women of lotuses the fragrance having the lustre how then others
rāsotsave 'sya bhuja-daṇḍa-gṛhīta-kaṇṭha-
at the festival of rāsa His by the arms embraced around the neck
labdhāśiṣāṁ ya udagād vraja-sundarīṇām
who obtained their desire which arose of Vraja the beautiful women

231 "At the festival of the rāsa dance He embraced the beautiful women of Vraja around their necks with His arms, and they attained their heart's desire. Such favour was not granted even to Śrī, who is wholly devoted to Him, nor to the celestial women, fragrant and radiant like lotuses — what then of others?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.47.60)[30]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 8.80.

The Lord and Rāya weep with love —

এত শুনি' প্রভু তাঁরে কৈল আলিঙ্গন ।
দুইজনে গলাগলি করেন ক্রন্দন ॥ ২৩২ ॥

eta śuni' prabhu tāṁre kaila āliṅgana
this hearing the Lord him made embrace
duijane galāgali karena krandana
the two with arms round each other's necks do weeping

232 Hearing this, the Lord embraced him, and the two of them wept, their arms around each other's necks.

At night the two stay together, and in the morning they go about their duties —

এইমত প্রেমাবেশে রাত্রি গোঙাইলা ।
প্রাতঃকালে নিজ-নিজ-কার্য্যে দুঁহে গেলা ॥ ২৩৩ ॥

ei-mata premāveśe rātri goṅāilā
in this way absorbed in love the night they spent
prātaḥ-kāle nija-nija-kārye duṁhe gelā
in the morning to their own duties both went

233 In this way they spent the night absorbed in love, and in the morning both went about their own duties.

Rāya's humility and his prayer for the Lord's company —

বিদায়-সময়ে প্রভুর চরণে ধরিয়া ।
রামানন্দ রায় কহে বিনতি করিয়া ॥ ২৩৪ ॥

vidāya-samaye prabhura caraṇe dhariyā
at the time of parting the Lord's feet clasping
rāmānanda rāya kahe vinati kariyā
Rāmānanda Rāya says entreaty making

234 At the time of parting, Rāmānanda Rāya clasped the Lord's feet and humbly entreated Him:

মোরে কৃপা করিতে তোমার ইহাঁ আগমন ।
দিন দশ রহি' শোধ মোর দুষ্ট মন ॥ ২৩৫ ॥

more kṛpā karite tomāra ihāṁ āgamana
to me mercy to show Your here coming
dina daśa rahi' śodha mora duṣṭa mana
days ten staying purify my wicked mind

235 "You have come here to show me mercy. Stay ten days and purify my wicked mind.

তোমা বিনা অন্য নাহি জীব উদ্ধারিতে ।
তোমা বিনা অন্য নাহি কৃষ্ণপ্রেম দিতে’ ॥ ২৩৬ ॥

tomā vinā anya nāhi jīva uddhārite
You except another there is not the jīvas to deliver
tomā vinā anya nāhi kṛṣṇa-prema dite’
You except another there is not love for Kṛṣṇa to give

236 There is no one but You to deliver the *jīvas*, no one but You to give love for Kṛṣṇa.”

The Lord praises Rāya and admits that He is won over by him —

প্রভু কহে, — আইলাঙ শুনি’ তোমার গুণ ।
কৃষ্ণকথা শুনি’ শুদ্ধ করাইতে মন ॥ ২৩৭ ॥

prabhu kahe, — āilāṅa śuni’ tomāra guṇa
the Lord said I have come hearing of your virtues
kṛṣṇa-kathā śuni’ śuddha karāite mana
about Kṛṣṇa talks hearing pure to make the mind

237 The Lord said, “I came because I had heard of your virtues — to purify My mind by hearing talks of Kṛṣṇa.

যৈছে শুনিলুঁ, তৈছে দেখিলুঁ তোমার মহিমা ।
রাধাকৃষ্ণ-প্রেমরস-জ্ঞানের তুমি সীমা ॥ ২৩৮ ॥

yaiche śunilum̐, taiche dekhilum̐ tomāra mahimā
as I heard so I have seen your greatness
rādhā-kṛṣṇa-premarasa-jñānera tumi sīmā
of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa of the rasa of love of the knowledge you the limit

238 Your greatness is just as I heard. You are the utmost limit in knowing the rasa of the love of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

You alone have known the true nature of the *rasa* of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa's love. In that knowledge you are perfected and have reached the farther shore; therefore you

are the final limit.

দশ দিনের কা-কথা যাবৎ আমি জীব' ।
তাবৎ তোমার সব ছাড়িতে নারিব ॥ ২৩৯ ॥

daśa dinera kā-kathā yāvat āmi jība'
of ten days what to speak as long as I shall live
tāvat tomāra saba chāḍite nāriba
so long your all to give up I shall not be able

239 What to speak of ten days? As long as I live, I shall never be able to give you up.[31]

The Lord wishes to be with Rāya in Nīlācala —

নীলাচলে তুমি-আমি থাকিব এক-সঙ্গে ।
সুখে গোঙাইব কাল কৃষ্ণকথা-রঙ্গে ॥ ২৪০ ॥

nīlācale tumi-āmi thākiba eka-saṅge
in Nīlācala you and I shall stay together
sukhe goṅāiba kāla kṛṣṇa-kathā-raṅge
happily we shall pass the time in the joy of talks about Kṛṣṇa

240 You and I shall live together in Nīlācala and happily pass our time in the joy of talks about Kṛṣṇa."

Having finished their duties, the two meet in the evening —

এত বলি' দুঁহে নিজ-নিজ-কার্য্যে গেলা ।
সন্ধ্যাকালে রায় পুনঃ আসিয়া মিলিলা ॥ ২৪১ ॥

eta bali' duṁhe nija-nija kārye gelā
so saying both to their own duties went
sandhyā-kāle rāya punaḥ āsiyā mililā
in the evening Rāya again coming met

241 Saying this, both went about their own duties, and in the evening Rāya came again and met the Lord.

*The *iṣṭa-goṣṭhī* of the two —*

অন্যোন্যে মিলি' দুঁহে নিভৃতে বসিয়া ।
প্রশ্নোত্তর-গোষ্ঠী কহে আনন্দিত হঞা ॥ ২৪২ ॥

anyonye mili' dum̐he nibhṛte vasiyā
with one another meeting both in seclusion sitting
praśnottara-goṣṭhī kahe ānandita hañā
of questions and answers a discussion they hold joyful becoming

242 Meeting together, the two sat in seclusion and joyfully held a discussion of questions and answers.

Anubhāṣya.
Goṣṭhī — conversation.

The conversation of the Lord and Rāmānanda: the Lord asks, Rāya answers —

প্রভু পুছে, রামানন্দ করেন উত্তর ।
এইমত সেই রাত্রে কথা পরস্পর ॥ ২৪৩ ॥

prabhu puche, rāmānanda karena uttara
the Lord asks Rāmānanda gives the answer
ei mata sei rātre kathā paraspara
in this way that night conversation with each other

243 The Lord asked and Rāmānanda answered; in this way they talked together all that night.

(1) The highest knowledge is devotion to Kṛṣṇa —

প্রভু কহে, — কোন্ বিদ্যা বিদ্যা-মধ্যে সার ?
রায় কহে, — কৃষ্ণভক্তি বিনা বিদ্যা নাহি আর ॥ ২৪৪ ॥

prabhu kahe, — kon vidyā vidyā-madhye sāra?
the Lord said which knowledge among kinds of knowledge the essence
rāya kahe, — kṛṣṇa-bhakti vinā vidyā nāhi āra
Rāya said devotion to Kṛṣṇa except knowledge there is not other

244 The Lord asked, “Of all kinds of knowledge, which is the best?” Rāya answered, “There is no knowledge other than devotion to Kṛṣṇa.”

Anubhāṣya.

To the question about the best knowledge (*vidyā*), Rāya answers that the best of all knowledge is the knowledge of devotion to Kṛṣṇa (*kṛṣṇa-bhakti-vidyā*). Above the knowledge that begets material enjoyment, and above *brahma-vidyā*, which lies beyond matter, stands the knowledge of devotion to Viṣṇu; and higher still is the knowledge of devotion to Kṛṣṇa. (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 4.29.49): “That is action which pleases Hari; that is knowledge by which the mind is turned to Him.” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.5.23–24): “Hearing and chanting about Viṣṇu, remembering Him, serving His feet, worshiping Him, offering prayers, serving Him, being His friend and offering Him one's self — if a person offers Viṣṇu such devotion with nine features and performs it directly for Bhagavān, I consider that the highest learning.” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.19.40): “Knowledge is the removal of the notion of separateness within the self.”

(2) The best fame, or honor, is to be Kṛṣṇa's servant —

কীর্ত্তিগণ-মধ্যে জীবের কোন্ বড় কীর্ত্তি ?
কৃষ্ণভক্ত বলিয়া যাঁহার হয় খ্যাতি ॥ ২৪৫ ॥

kīrti-gaṇa-madhye jīvera kon baḍa kīrti?
among kinds of fame of the jīva which great fame
kṛṣṇa-bhakta baliyā yāṁhāra haya khyāti
a devotee of Kṛṣṇa as whose is renown

245 “Of all kinds of fame, which is the greatest for a *jīva*?” “The fame of one who is known as a devotee of Kṛṣṇa.”

Anubhāṣya.

Fame as a “devotee of Kṛṣṇa” surpasses every other fame. Greedy for material things, the *jīva* prizes only gross service to matter. But better than passing fame under some title in Devī-dhāma, or fame as a “knower of Brahman” in the realm beyond matter, is fame as a “devotee of Viṣṇu”; and on a still higher level is fame as a “devotee of Kṛṣṇa.” (*Garuḍa Purāṇa*, the words of Indra): “In Kali the name *bhāgavata* is rare and is never obtained; it is higher than the position of Brahmā and Rudra — so my guru told me.” (*Itihāsa-samuccaya*, the conversation of Śrī

Nārada and Puṇḍarīka): “He in whom, after thousands of births, the thought arises, ‘I am the servant of Vāsudeva,’ delivers all the worlds.” (*Ādi Purāṇa*, the conversation of Kṛṣṇa and Arjuna): “The forms of liberation follow the devotees, together with the Śrutis.” (*Bṛhan-nāradīya Purāṇa*): “Even today the best of sages and the gods headed by Brahmā do not know the power of those whose hearts delight in devotion to Viṣṇu.” (*Garuḍa Purāṇa*): “One who performs sacrifices (*satra-yājī*) is better than thousands of *brāhmaṇas*; one who has mastered all Vedānta is better than thousands of *satra-yājīs*; a devotee of Viṣṇu is better than ten million knowers of all Vedānta; and one *ekāntin* is better than thousands of Vaiṣṇavas. The *ekāntins* reach the supreme abode.” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.13.4): “The wise have declared that the highest fruit of long and laborious study of the scriptures is to hear constantly of the qualities of those in whose hearts are Mukunda's lotus feet.” (*Nārāyaṇa-vyūha-stava*): “O Hari, may I not become even Brahmā if I am without devotion to You; but if I am Your devotee, may I be even a worm, birth after birth.” See also *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.25.38, 4.24.29, 4.31.22, 7.9.24, 10.14.30 and so on.

Among them is Prahlāda's fame, as Śrī Rudra says in the *Skanda Purāṇa*: “Only a devotee truly knows Kṛṣṇa — not I. Among all the devotees of Hari, Prahlāda is the very greatest” (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.9.26 and 7.10.21). Higher than he are the Pāṇḍavas (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.10.48–50, 7.15.75–77). Higher than they are the Yadus (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.82.28, 30). Among the Yadus Uddhava is the highest (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.4.31, 11.14.15, 11.16.29). Higher than he are the goddesses of Vraja (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.47.58). In the *Bṛhad-vāmana Purāṇa* Brahmā says to Bhṛgu and the other sages: “Long ago I performed austerities for sixty thousand years to obtain the dust of the feet of the women of the cowherd Nanda's Vraja. Even so I did not obtain the dust of their feet. Neither I, nor Śiva, nor Śeṣa, nor Śrī [Lakṣmī] is ever their equal.”[46] In the *Ādi Purāṇa* Bhagavān says: “Neither Brahmā nor Rudra, O king, nor Lakṣmī, nor even My own Self is as dear to Me as the gopīs.” And among them Śrī Rādhikā is the highest of all.

Those who wholly follow Śrīla Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu — the best of Śrī Rādhā's dearest servants and the most intimate servant of Śrī Gaurāṅga — are known as *rūpānugas*. About their glory the *Śrī Caitanya-candrāmṛta* says: “Let there be ten million renunciations, ten million [virtues such as] *śama*, *dama*, forbearance, friendliness and the rest, ten million meditations on the truth — or even ten million kinds of Vaiṣṇava devotion; all of it is not equal to even a ten-

millionth part of the host of qualities naturally present in those who relish the joy of the effulgence of the toenails on the feet of Śrīmat Caitanyacandra's beloved ones."

(3) The highest wealth is loving devotion to Rādhā and Govinda —

সম্পত্তির মধ্যে জীবের কোন্ সম্পত্তি গণি ?
রাধাকৃষ্ণে প্রেম যাঁর, সেই বড় ধনী' ॥ ২৪৬ ॥

sampattira madhye jīvera kon sampatti gaṇi?
among kinds of wealth of the jīva which wealth do we count
rādhā-kṛṣṇe prema yāṁra, sei baḍa dhanī
for Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa love whose he great rich man

246 "Among all riches, which should we count as a *jīva*'s true wealth?" "One who has love for Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa is the richest of all."

Anubhāṣya.

Given over to material enjoyment, the *jīva* considers the best of all attainments to be wealth that better satisfies his craving for enjoyment. But if one weighs the different kinds of wealth with subtle, transcendental intelligence, there is no wealth equal to love for Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.39.2): "What is unattainable when Bhagavān, the abode of Śrī, is pleased? Yet, O king, those devoted to Him desire nothing."

(4) The most bitter sorrow is separation from a devotee of Kṛṣṇa —

দুঃখ-মধ্যে কোন দুঃখ হয় গুরুতর ?
কৃষ্ণভক্ত-বিরহ বিনা দুঃখ নাহি দেখি পর ॥ ২৪৭ ॥

duḥkha-madhye kona duḥkha haya gurutara?
among sorrows which sorrow is the heaviest
kṛṣṇa-bhakta-viraha vinā duḥkha nāhi dekhi para
from a devotee of Kṛṣṇa separation except sorrow not I see other

247 "Of all sorrows, which is the heaviest?" "I see no sorrow but separation from a devotee of Kṛṣṇa."

Anubhāṣya.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.30.6): “A mortal who has not worshiped Me, tormented by suffering, his mind attached to family, deprived of the company of saints, fallen from the service of his elders….” (*Bṛhad-bhāgavatāmṛta* 5.44): “More than our own life we long for the company of Śrī Viṣṇu's people; separated from them even for a moment, we find here not a particle of happiness.”

(5) Highest among the liberated is one who loves Kṛṣṇa —

মুক্ত-মধ্যে কোন্ জীব মুক্ত করি’ মানি ?
কৃষ্ণপ্রেম যাঁর, সেই মুক্ত শিরোমণি ॥ ২৪৮ ॥

mukta-madhye kon jīva mukta kari’ māni?
among the liberated which jīva as liberated regarding do we accept
kṛṣṇa-prema yāṁra, sei mukta-śiromaṇi
love for Kṛṣṇa whose he of the liberated the crown jewel

248 “Among the liberated, which *jīva* should we regard as truly liberated?” “One who has love for Kṛṣṇa is the crown jewel of the liberated.”

Anubhāṣya.
(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 6.14.4): “O great sage, even among millions of the liberated and perfected, a peaceful devotee wholly devoted to Nārāyaṇa is very hard to find.”

*(6) Singing of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes is the natural *dharma* of the pure soul —*

গান-মধ্যে কোন গান — জীবের নিজ ধর্ম্ম ?
রাধাকৃষ্ণের প্রেমকেলি’ — যেই গীতের মর্ম্ম ॥ ২৪৯ ॥

gāna-madhye kona gāna — jīvera nija dharma?
among songs which song of the jīva own dharma
rādhā-kṛṣṇera prema-keli’ — yei gītera marma
of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa the play of love which of the song the heart

249 “Among songs, which song is the *jīva*’s own *dharma*?” “The song whose heart is the loving play of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.”

Anubhāṣya.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.33.36): “To show mercy to His devotees He accepts a human body and performs such pastimes that one who hears of them becomes wholly devoted to Him.”

*(7) The company of Kṛṣṇa's devotees is the *jīva*'s only highest good (*niḥśreyasa*) —*

শ্রেয়ো-মধ্যে কোন্ শ্রেয়ঃ জীবের হয় সার ?
কৃষ্ণভক্ত-সঙ্গ বিনা শ্রেয়ঃ নাহি আর ॥ ২৫০ ॥

śreyo-madhye kon śreyaḥ jīvera haya sāra?
among goods which good of the jīva is the essence
kṛṣṇa-bhakta-saṅga vinā śreyaḥ nāhi āra
of the devotees of Kṛṣṇa the company except good there is not other

250 “Among all that is good, what is the highest good for a *jīva*?” “There is no good other than the company of Kṛṣṇa’s devotees.”

Anubhāṣya.
(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.2.28): “Therefore, O sinless ones, we ask you about the highest good. In this cycle of birth and death, association with saints even for half a moment is a treasure for human beings.”

(8) Kṛṣṇa is the only one to be remembered always —

কাঁহার স্মরণ জীব করিবে অনুক্ষণ ?
কৃষ্ণ-নাম-গুণ-লীলা — প্রধান স্মরণ ॥ ২৫১ ॥

kāṁhāra smaraṇa jīva karibe anukṣaṇa?
of whom remembrance the jīva should do at every moment
kṛṣṇa-nāma-guṇa-līlā — pradhāna smaraṇa
of Kṛṣṇa’s name qualities pastimes the chief remembrance

251 “Whom should a *jīva* remember at every moment?” “Remembering Kṛṣṇa’s name, qualities and pastimes is the chief remembrance.”

Anubhāṣya.
(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.2.36): “Therefore, O king, with all one's being, everywhere and always, people should hear about Bhagavān Hari, glorify Him and

remember Him."

(9) The lotus feet of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are the only object of meditation —

ধ্যেয়-মধ্যে জীবের কর্ত্তব্য কোন্ ধ্যান ?
রাধাকৃষ্ণপদাম্বুজ-ধ্যান — প্রধান ॥ ২৫২ ॥

dhyeya-madhye jīvera kartavya kon dhyāna?
among objects of meditation of the jīva the duty which meditation
rādhā-kṛṣṇa-padāmbuja-dhyāna — pradhāna
of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa on the lotus feet meditation the chief

252 "Among all objects of meditation, on what should a *jīva* meditate?" "Meditation on the lotus feet of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa is the chief."

Anubhāṣya.
(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.2.14): "Therefore, with one-pointed mind, one should constantly hear about Bhagavān, the Lord of the Sātvatas, glorify Him, meditate on Him and worship Him."

(10) Vraja is the only place to live —

সর্ব্ব ত্যজি' জীবের কর্ত্তব্য কাঁহা বাস ?
শ্রীবৃন্দাবনভূমি — যাঁহা নিত্য-লীলারাস ॥ ২৫৩ ॥

sarva tyaji' jīvera kartavya kāṁhā vāsa?
everything giving up of the jīva the duty where to live
śrī vṛndāvana-bhūmi — yāṁhā nitya-līlā-rāsa
Śrī Vṛndāvana the land where eternal pastime rāsa

253 "Giving up everything, where should a *jīva* live?" "In the land of Śrī Vṛndāvana, where the *rāsa* pastime goes on eternally."

Anubhāṣya.
(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.47.61): "Oh, may I be born in Vṛndāvana as some bush, creeper or herb that receives the dust of these gopīs' feet! For they gave up their own people, so hard to give up, and the path of the respectable, and took the path of Mukunda, which the Śrutis seek."

(11) Kṛṣṇa is the only one to be heard about —

শ্রবণমধ্যে জীবের কোন্ শ্রেষ্ঠ শ্রবণ ?
রাধাকৃষ্ণ-প্রেমলীলা কর্ণ-রসায়ন ॥ ২৫৪ ॥

śravaṇa-madhye jīvera kon śreṣṭha śravaṇa?
among things heard of the jīva which best hearing
rādhā-kṛṣṇa-prema-līlā karṇa-rasāyana
of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa the pastimes of love for the ears an elixir

254 "Of all things to hear, what is best for a *jīva* to hear?" "The pastimes of the love of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, an elixir for the ears."

Anubhāṣya.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.30.39):[47] "One who with faith hears of this play of Viṣṇu with the girls of Vraja and then describes it attains supreme devotion to Bhagavān, becomes steady, and quickly drives out lust, the disease of the heart."

(12) Only the names "Hare Kṛṣṇa" are to be chanted —

উপাস্যের মধ্যে কোন্ উপাস্য প্রধান ?
শ্রেষ্ঠ উপাস্য — যুগল 'রাধা-কৃষ্ণ' নাম ॥ ২৫৫ ॥

upāsyera madhye kon upāsya pradhāna?
among the objects of worship which object of worship the chief
śreṣṭha upāsya — yugala 'rādhā-kṛṣṇa' nāma
the best object of worship the couple Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa the name

255 "Of all objects of worship, which is the chief?" "The best object of worship is the name of the Divine Couple, 'Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa.'"

Anubhāṣya.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 6.3.22): "Only this is considered the highest *dharma* for people in this world: *bhakti-yoga*, devotional service to Bhagavān, beginning with chanting His name."

(13) The destination of those who seek liberation and of those who seek

enjoyment —

মুক্তি ভুক্তি, বাঞ্ছে যেই, কাঁহা দুঁহার গতি ?
স্থাবরদেহ, দেবদেহ, যৈছে অবস্থিতি ॥ ২৫৬ ॥

mukti bhukti, vāñche yei, kāṁhā duṁhāra gati?
liberation enjoyment desires who where of the two the destination
sthāvara-deha, deva-deha, yaiche avasthiti
an immobile body a body of a god so the condition

256 "Those who desire liberation and those who desire enjoyment — where do the two of them go?" "The one attains an immobile body, the other the body of a god.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

From the verse beginning "*prabhu kahe, — 'kon vidyā…*'" up to the verse "*sthāvara deha, deva-deha yaiche avasthiti*," in each verse the first line is the Lord's question and the second line is Rāya's answer. This conversation is found in the *Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka* (Act 7).

Anubhāṣya.

In the answers to the questions of verses 244–256, the material and the transcendental are compared in worth. It is shown that the material outlook is contemptible, and that what belongs to transcendental Goloka — free from material self-interest and aimed at Kṛṣṇa alone — surpasses everything.

Anubhāṣya.

The *mukti-vādīs*, who have rejected material enjoyment, in the end obtain a stationary (*sthāvara*) body devoid of spiritual activity, that is, with consciousness asleep. And the *bhukti-vādīs*, bound to material enjoyment, obtain in the next world the bodies of gods, fit for enjoyment.

"The great sage who, for the sake of liberation — that is, becoming stone — set forth a *śāstra*: know that he is Gautama, and he is just as you know him to be."[48] This is the fruit of the philosophy of the adherents of Buddhist doctrine.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.10.22): "Having worshiped the gods with sacrifices, the performer of sacrifice goes to Svarga, and there, like a god, he enjoys the celestial pleasures he has earned." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 4.29.29): "One becomes a god, a

human or an animal according to one's *karma* and *guṇas*.” See also *Bhagavad-gītā* 9.20.

*The difference between the practice of a *jñānī* and of a devotee —*

অরসজ্ঞ কাক চুষে জ্ঞান-নিম্বফলে ।
রসজ্ঞ কোকিল খায় প্রেমাম্র-মুকুলে ॥ ২৫৭ ॥

arasa-jña kāka cuṣe jñāna-nimba-phale
ignorant of taste the crow sucks of knowledge of the nimba the fruit
rasa-jña kokila khāya premāmra-mukule
knowing taste the cuckoo eats of love of the mango the buds

257 The crow, knowing nothing of rasa, sucks the bitter nimba fruit of knowledge (*jñāna*), while the cuckoo, who knows rasa, feasts on the mango buds of prema.

Anubhāṣya.
Jñāna is like the *nimba* fruit: it cannot be relished, and it is food for *jīvas* who, like crows, cling to harsh logic. But the taste of the mango buds of *prema* is pleasing and very sweet: it is relished only by Kṛṣṇa's devotees, who are like cuckoos that know how to relish *rasa*.

অভাগিয়া জ্ঞানী আস্বাদয়ে শুষ্ক জ্ঞান ।
কৃষ্ণ-প্রেমামৃত পান করে ভাগ্যবান্ ॥ ২৫৮ ॥

abhāgiyā jñānī āsvādaye śuṣka jñāna
unfortunate the jñānī tastes dry knowledge
kṛṣṇa-premāmṛta pāna kare bhāgyavān
of love for Kṛṣṇa the nectar drinking does the fortunate

258 The unfortunate *jñānī* tastes dry knowledge, while the fortunate one drinks the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa.”

Anubhāṣya.
Dry knowledge is what falls to the lot of the unfortunate *jñānī* to taste; but the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa, full of *rasa*, is the drink of the fortunate devotee.

The night spent in talks about Kṛṣṇa —

এইমত দুই জন কৃষ্ণকথা-রসে ।
নৃত্য-গীত-রোদনে হৈল রাত্রি-শেষে ॥ ২৫৯ ॥

ei-mata dui-jana kṛṣṇa-kathā-rase
in this way the two of talks about Kṛṣṇa in the rasa
nṛtya-gīta-rodane haila rātri-śeṣe
in dancing singing weeping came of the night the end

259 In this way the two of them, immersed in the rasa of talks about Kṛṣṇa, danced, sang and wept until the night came to an end.

দোঁহে নিজ-নিজ-কার্য্যে চলিলা বিহানে ।
সন্ধ্যাকালে রায় আসি' মিলিলা আর দিনে ॥ ২৬০ ॥

doṁhe nija-nija-kārye calilā vihāne
both to their own duties went in the morning
sandhyā-kāle rāya āsi' mililā āra dine
in the evening Rāya coming met on the next day

260 In the morning both went about their duties, and the next day, in the evening, Rāya came and met the Lord again.

Anubhāṣya.

Bihāne ("in the morning") — in East Bengal and in the west (in Hindi) this word is still used in everyday speech instead of the word *prātaḥ-kāle* ("in the morning").

The next day Rāya appeals at the Lord's feet —

ইষ্ট-গোষ্ঠী কৃষ্ণকথা কহি' কতক্ষণ ।
প্রভুপদ ধরি' রায় করে নিবেদন ॥ ২৬১ ॥

iṣṭa-goṣṭhī kṛṣṇa-kathā kahi' kata-kṣaṇa
intimate discussion talks of Kṛṣṇa speaking for some time
prabhu-pada dhari' rāya kare nivedana
the Lord's feet clasping Rāya makes an appeal

261 After they had talked intimately of Kṛṣṇa for some time, Rāya clasped the Lord's feet and made an appeal:

'কৃষ্ণতত্ত্ব', 'রাধাতত্ত্ব', 'প্রেমতত্ত্বসার' ।
'রসতত্ত্ব', 'লীলাতত্ত্ব' বিবিধ প্রকার ॥ ২৬২ ॥

'kṛṣṇa-tattva', 'rādhā-tattva', 'prema-tattva-sāra'
of Kṛṣṇa the truth of Rādhā the truth of prema of the truth the essence
'rasa-tattva', 'līlā-tattva' vividha prakāra
of rasa the truth of līlā the truth various kinds

262 "The truth of Kṛṣṇa, the truth of Rādhā, the essence of the truth of prema, the truth of rasa, the truth of *līlā* in all its variety —

The Lord reveals Himself, for He rises in a pure heart —

এত তত্ত্ব মোর চিত্তে কৈলে প্রকাশন ।
ব্রহ্মাকে বেদ যেন পড়াইল নারায়ণ ॥ ২৬৩ ॥

eta tattva mora citte kaile prakāśana
so many truths in my heart You have made manifest
brahmāke veda yena paḍāila nārāyaṇa
to Brahmā the Veda as taught Nārāyaṇa

263 all these truths You have revealed in my heart, just as Nārāyaṇa taught the Veda to Brahmā.

Anubhāṣya.
Bhagavān reveals the Vedas in Brahmā's heart. (*Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad* 6.18): "He who in the beginning created Brahmā and who delivered the Vedas to him — to that God, who illumines the intelligence of the self, I, seeking liberation, go for refuge." See also *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.9.30–35, 11.14.3, 12.4.40, 12.13.19 and so on.

অন্তর্য্যামী ঈশ্বরের এই রীতি হয়ে ।
বাহিরে না কহে, বস্তু প্রকাশে হৃদয়ে ॥ ২৬৪ ॥

antaryāmī īśvarera ei rīti haye
the indwelling of the Lord this the way is
bāhire nā kahe, vastu prakāśe hṛdaye
outwardly not He speaks the reality reveals in the heart

264 Such is the way of the Lord who dwells within: He does not speak outwardly, but reveals the truth in the heart.

Anubhāṣya.
This tells us that Śrī Gaurasundara is Himself the *Bhargo-deva* proclaimed by the Gāyatrī, He who sets the intelligence in motion. Thus (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.4.22): "May He, the best of sages, be pleased with me — He who in the beginning, unfolding true remembrance in the heart of the unborn [Brahmā], inspired Sarasvatī, who then appeared with her characteristics from his mouth."

The definition of the Supreme Lord, full of spiritual play, and meditation on Him —

জন্মাদ্যস্য যতোঽন্বয়াদিতরতশ্চার্থেষ্বভিজ্ঞঃ স্বরাট্
তেনে ব্রহ্ম হৃদা য আদিকবয়ে মুহ্যন্তি যৎ সূরয়ঃ ।
তেজোবারিমৃদাং যথা বিনিময়ো যত্র ত্রিসর্গোঽমৃষা
ধাম্না স্বেন সদা নিরস্তকুহকং সত্যং পরং ধীমহি ॥ ২৬৫ ॥

janmādy asya yato 'nvayād itarataś cārtheṣv abhijñaḥ sva-rāṭ
birth and so on of this from whom directly indirectly and in all purposes fully aware self-luminous
tene brahma hṛdā ya ādi-kavaye muhyanti yat sūrayaḥ
revealed the Veda through the heart who to the first poet are bewildered about whom the wise
tejo-vāri-mṛdāṁ yathā vinimayo yatra tri-sargo 'mṛṣā
of fire water earth as the interchange in whom the threefold creation real
dhāmnā svena sadā nirasta-kuhakaṁ satyaṁ paraṁ dhīmahi
by power His own always free of all deception the truth supreme let us meditate on

265 "Let us meditate on the Supreme Truth, from whom, directly and indirectly, this universe arises, endures and dissolves; who is fully aware of all purposes and shines by Himself (*svarāṭ*); who revealed the Veda

through the heart to the first poet, Brahmā; about whom even the wise are bewildered; in whom, as fire, water and earth pass into one another, the threefold creation is real; and who by His own power is ever free of all deception." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

We meditate on Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the supreme Truth, who by His own potency is eternally free of all deception. It is known for certain that from this Truth come the birth, maintenance and dissolution of the universe. When one reasons by *anvaya-vyatireka*, He is found in all things, or affairs, to be the one supreme *jña-tattva*, the knowing Truth, that is, the *svarūpa-tattva*. In the visible world He alone is *svarāṭ*, that is, the independent King. As the indwelling Lord He taught the truth of Brahman to Brahmā, the first poet. In Him intelligent scholars are bewildered again and again. In Him is the interchange, that is, the separate existence, of the many elements — fire, water, earth and the rest. In Him the three kinds of creation exist as real: creation as the rising of spirit, creation as the manifestation of the *jīvas*, and creation as the universes of *māyā*.

Anubhāṣya.

yataḥ (from whom, the possessor of potencies) **asya** (of this universe) **janmādi** (birth, maintenance and destruction) — according to the Śruti *yato vā imāni bhūtāni jāyante* and so on, and the *sūtra* *janmādy asya yataḥ* (*Brahma-sūtra* 1.1.2); **anvayāt itarataḥ ca** (this comes about by *anvaya* and *vyatireka*); **yaḥ anvayāt artheṣu** (in spiritual affairs, which befit spiritual form, taste, smell, sound and touch) **abhijñaḥ** (attached), and **vyatirekāt artheṣu** (in material objects of form, taste, smell, sound and touch) **abhijñaḥ** (untouched by them), and being such — **sva-rāṭ** (He who shines by Himself, self-luminous); **yat** (in which supreme Truth) **sūrayaḥ** (Brahmā and others — according to the account in the Tenth Canto of Brahmā's bewilderment; the gods — according to the Talavakāra Śruti; the *brāhmaṇas* and others, and the sages — Dattātreya, Durvāsā, Vasiṣṭha, Śaṅkara, Vidyāraṇya and others — according to the words *daivāhatārtha-racanā*, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.9.10) **api muhyanti** (are bewildered, that is, cannot ascertain the supreme Truth); **tat brahma** (that truth — according to the words *vadanti tat tattva-vidaḥ* and so on) **ādi-kavaye** (to Brahmā) **hṛdā** (through the mind — according to the *Brahma-saṁhitā*'s words *trayyā prabuddhaḥ*) **yaḥ tene** (revealed); **yathā tejo-vāri-mṛdāṁ vinimayaḥ** (as in fire, water and earth there is an interchange, one appearing as another, so) **tri-**

sargaḥ (the perishable creation of the three — *rajas*, *tamas* and *sattva*; in the other sense, the eternal manifestation of the three potencies — internal, external and marginal) **yatra** (in the supreme Truth, in Bhagavān's *svarūpa*, the form of eternity, knowledge and bliss, nondual Knowledge) **amṛṣā** (true); **svena dhāmnā** (by His power — His transcendental internal opulence, *sandhinī* and the rest, proper to His nature) **sadā nirasta-kuhakam** (in whom deception, *kuhaka*, the mark of *māyā*, is rejected and cast away) **satyam** (the true essence, the eternal) **param** (Him who is above all, the Supreme Lord) **dhīmahi** (we meditate). For more, see the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*.

Rāya's doubt —

এক সংশয় মোর আছয়ে হৃদয়ে ।
কৃপা করি' কহ মোরে তাহার নিশ্চয়ে ॥ ২৬৬ ॥

eka saṁśaya mora āchaye hṛdaye
one doubt my there is in the heart
kṛpā kari' kaha more tāhāra niścaye
mercy showing tell me of it the resolution

266 Yet one doubt remains in my heart. Be merciful and resolve it for me.

*The Lord's *svarūpa* appeared before Rāya —*

পহিলে দেখিলুঁ তোমার সন্ন্যাসী-স্বরূপ ।
এবে তোমা দেখি মুঞি শ্যাম-গোপরূপ ॥ ২৬৭ ॥

pahile dekhiluṁ tomāra sannyāsī-svarūpa
at first I saw Your sannyāsī form
ebe tomā dekhi muñi śyāma-gopa-rūpa
now You see I dark cowherd in the form

267 At first I saw You in the form of a *sannyāsī*, but now I see You as a dark cowherd boy.

Anubhāṣya.

That is, "Rasarāja and Mahābhāva — two in one form" (verse 242[49]). ***Sannyāsī-svarūpa*** — the form of an eternal renunciant, or ascetic, full of *adhirūḍha-

mahābhāva* born of eternal separation from Kṛṣṇa.

*Rāya sees Gaurasundara adorned with Rādhā's *bhāva* and radiance —*

তোমার সম্মুখে দেখি কাঞ্চন-পঞ্চালিকা ।
তাঁর গৌরকান্ত্যে তোমার সর্ব্ব অঙ্গ ঢাকা ॥ ২৬৮ ॥

tomāra sammukhe dekhi kāñcana-pañcālikā
of You in front I see a golden doll
tāṁra gaura-kāntye tomāra sarva aṅga ḍhākā
her by the golden lustre Your whole body covered

268 Before You I see a golden doll, and her golden lustre covers Your whole body.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.86–89.

তাহাতে প্রকট দেখি স-বংশী বদন ।
নানা-ভাবে চঞ্চল তাহে কমল-নয়ন ॥ ২৬৯ ॥

tāhāte prakaṭa dekhi sa-vaṁśī vadana
in that clearly I see with the flute the face
nānā-bhāve cañcala tāhe kamala-nayana
with various moods restless and there the lotus eyes

269 Within it I clearly see Your face with the flute, and Your lotus eyes restless with many moods.

Rāya asks the Lord Himself the reason for His golden form —

এইমত তোমা দেখি' হয় চমৎকার ।
অকপটে কহ, প্রভু, কারণ ইহার ॥ ২৭০ ॥

ei-mata tomā dekhi' haya camatkāra
in this way You seeing there is wonder
akapaṭe kaha, prabhu, kāraṇa ihāra
without deceit tell Prabhu the cause of this

270 Seeing You like this fills me with wonder. Tell me frankly, Prabhu, what is the cause of it?”

*The Lord tries to hide Himself by praising Rāya as a *mahā-bhāgavata* —*

প্রভু কহে, — কৃষ্ণে তোমার গাঢ়প্রেম হয়।
প্রেমার স্বভাব এই জানিহ নিশ্চয় ॥ ২৭১ ॥

prabhu kahe, — kṛṣṇe tomāra gāḍha-prema haya
the Lord said for Kṛṣṇa your deep love is
premāra svabhāva ei jāniha niścaya
of love the nature this know for certain

271 The Lord said, “You have deep love for Kṛṣṇa, and know for certain that this is the nature of love.

*How a *mahā-bhāgavata*, or Vaiṣṇava, or *paramahaṁsa* sees —*

মহাভাগবত দেখে স্থাবর-জঙ্গম।
তাঁহা তাঁহা হয় তাঁর শ্রীকৃষ্ণ-স্ফুরণ ॥ ২৭২ ॥

mahā-bhāgavata dekhe sthāvara-jaṅgama
the great devotee sees the unmoving and the moving
tāṁhā tāṁhā haya tāṁra śrī kṛṣṇa-sphuraṇa
there and there is to him Śrī of Kṛṣṇa the appearance

272 The *mahā-bhāgavata* sees moving and unmoving things, and wherever he looks, Śrī Kṛṣṇa appears to him.

স্থাবর-জঙ্গম দেখে, না দেখে তার মূর্ত্তি।
সর্ব্বত্র হয় তাঁর ইষ্টদেব-স্ফূর্ত্তি ॥ ২৭৩ ॥

sthāvara-jaṅgama dekhe, nā dekhe tāra mūrti
the unmoving and the moving he sees not he sees their forms
sarvatra haya tāṁra iṣṭa-deva-sphūrti
everywhere is to him of his worshipful Lord the appearance

273 He sees moving and unmoving things, yet he does not see their forms: everywhere his worshipful Lord (*iṣṭa-deva*) appears to him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Lord, at first I saw You as a *sannyāsī*, and now I see You as a dark cowherd boy. And before You I also see a golden doll. That doll has covered Your whole body with its golden radiance, and yet Your own color seems to show plainly; and Your lovely eyes tremble with many feelings. Lord, tell me frankly the cause of this wonderful state of Yours." The Lord said, "Those who have deep love for Kṛṣṇa are the best of *bhāgavatas* (*bhāgavatottama*). The nature of their love is this: whatever they see, moving or nonmoving, they do not see its form, but everywhere see only the presence of Śrī Kṛṣṇa — the manifestation of their worshipable Lord (*iṣṭadeva*)."

*Seeing everywhere Kṛṣṇa and what belongs to Kṛṣṇa (*kārṣṇa*) —*

सर्व्वभूतेषु यः पश्येद्भगवद्भावमात्मनः ।
भूतानि भगवत्यात्मन्येष भागवतोत्तमः ॥ २७४ ॥

sarva-bhūteṣu yaḥ paśyed
in all beings who sees
bhagavad-bhāvam ātmanaḥ
of the Lord the presence of the Self
bhūtāni bhagavaty ātmany
the beings in the Lord in the Self
eṣa bhāgavatottamaḥ
he the best of devotees

274 "One who sees the Lord, the Soul of all, present in all beings, and sees all beings in the Lord, is the best of devotees (*bhāgavatottama*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.45)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *bhāgavatottama* sees in all beings Bhagavān Śrī Kṛṣṇacandra, the Self of the self, and sees all beings in Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Self of the self.

Anubhāṣya.

Nimi, the king of Videha, wished to know the marks, the vision, the conduct and the words of the three kinds of devotees, or *bhāgavatas*. In answer to his question Havi, one of the nine Yogendras, said:

yaḥ sarva-bhūteṣu (in all beings, conscious and unconscious) **ātmanaḥ** (of the self — transcendental, beyond the matter that is enjoyed) **bhagavad-bhāvam** (in beings, the *siddha-svarūpa* and the rest, fit for the service of Bhagavān) **paśyet**, **ātmani bhagavati bhūtāni** (engaged in eternal transcendental service in their own *siddha* forms) **paśyet**, (he) **eṣaḥ bhāgavatottamaḥ**. (By the strength of their transcendental feeling the *mahā-bhāgavatas* everywhere see Kṛṣṇa and what belongs to Kṛṣṇa (*kārṣṇa*), standing in the relation of the One who is served and His servants — for they have no external vision.)

The heart full of service to Kṛṣṇa sees everywhere consciousness, or the inclination to serve Kṛṣṇa —

বনলতাস্তরব আত্মনি বিষ্ণুং
ব্যঞ্জয়ন্ত্য ইব পুষ্পফলাঢ্যাঃ ৷
প্রণতভারবিটপা মধুধারাঃ
প্রেমহৃষ্টতনবো ববৃষুঃ স্ম ॥ ২৭৫ ॥

vana-latās tarava ātmani viṣṇum
the forest creepers the trees within themselves Viṣṇu
vyañjayantya iva puṣpa-phalāḍhyāḥ
revealing as if with flowers with fruits rich
praṇata-bhāra-viṭapā madhu-dhārāḥ
bowed with the weight their branches of honey streams
prema-hṛṣṭa-tanavo vavṛṣuḥ sma
with love thrilled bodies showered indeed

275 "The forest creepers and trees, rich with flowers and fruits, their branches bowed with the weight and their bodies thrilled with love, poured down streams of honey, as if revealing Viṣṇu within themselves." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.35.9)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The forest creepers rich with flowers and fruits, and the trees bowed down by *bhāva* — the great trees of the forest, their bodies thrilling with love — revealed Kṛṣṇa within themselves and poured down streams of honey.

Anubhāṣya.

When Kṛṣṇa went to the forest by day, the gopīs, burning in separation, sang this song to one another: (hearing the sound of Kṛṣṇa's flute) **praṇata-bhāra-viṭapāḥ** (the forest trees, bowed down under their burden) **puṣpa-phalāḍhyāḥ** (full of fruits and flowers) **prema-hṛṣṭa-tanavaḥ** (their bodies blossoming with love for Kṛṣṇa) **vana-latāḥ taravaḥ ca ātmani** (in their own forms) **viṣṇum** (the all-pervading Caitanya, consciousness) **vyañjayantyaḥ** (indicating that He was manifest) **iva madhu-dhārāḥ vavṛṣuḥ sma**.

The highest, final vision of a Vaiṣṇava —

রাধাকৃষ্ণে তোমার মহাপ্রেম হয়।
যাঁহা তাঁহা রাধাকৃষ্ণ তোমারে স্ফুরয় ॥ ২৭৬ ॥

rādhā-kṛṣṇe tomāra mahā-prema haya
for Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa your great love is
yāṁhā tāṁhā rādhā-kṛṣṇa tomāre sphuraya
wherever there Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa to you appear

276 You have great love for Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, and so Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa appear to you wherever you look.”

Rāya openly glorifies the purpose of the Lord's descent —

রায় কহে, — প্রভু তুমি ছাড় ভারিভূরি।
মোর আগে নিজরূপ না করিহ চুরি ॥ ২৭৭ ॥

rāya kahe, — prabhu tumi chāḍa bhāri-bhūri
Rāya said Prabhu You give up this grand pretence
mora āge nija-rūpa nā kariha curi
before me Your own form not do theft

277 Rāya said, “Prabhu, give up this grand pretence. Do not hide Your own form from me.

রাধিকার ভাবকান্তি করি' অঙ্গীকার ।
নিজরস আস্বাদিতে করিয়াছ অবতার ॥ ২৭৮ ॥

rādhikāra bhāva-kānti kari' aṅgīkāra
Rādhikā's mood lustre making acceptance
nija-rasa āsvādite kariyācha avatāra
Your own rasa to taste You have made descent

278 Accepting the mood and lustre of Rādhikā, You have descended to taste Your own rasa.

নিজ-গূঢ়কার্য্য তোমার — প্রেম আস্বাদন ।
আনুষঙ্গে প্রেমময় কৈলে ত্রিভুবন ॥ ২৭৯ ॥

nija-gūḍha-kārya tomāra — prema āsvādana
own secret purpose Your of prema the tasting
ānuṣaṅge prema-maya kaile tribhuvana
incidentally full of prema You made the three worlds

279 Your own secret purpose is to taste prema, and in passing You have filled the three worlds with prema.

Anubhāṣya.
On how a devotee knows Bhagavān's pastimes, see Ādi 3.86–89; on the meaning of the fifth verse of Ādi 1, see Ādi, Chapter 4.

Rāya reproaches the Lord for hiding Himself, or for His trickery —

আপনে আইলে মোরে করিতে উদ্ধার ।
এবে কপট কর, — তোমার কোন্ ব্যবহার ॥ ২৮০ ॥

āpane āile more karite uddhāra
Yourself You came me to make deliverance
ebe kapaṭa kara, — tomāra kon vyavahāra
now deceit You practice Your what conduct

280 You Yourself came to deliver me, and now You are deceiving me. What kind of behaviour is this?"

The Lord shows Rāya His dark and His golden form —

তবে হাসি' তাঁরে প্রভু দেখাইল স্বরূপ ।
'রসরাজ', 'মহাভাব' — দুই এক রূপ ॥ ২৮১ ॥

tabe hāsi' tāṁre prabhu dekhāila svarūpa
then smiling to him the Lord showed His own form
'rasa-rāja', 'mahābhāva' — dui eka rūpa
Rasarāja Mahābhāva the two one form

281 Then, smiling, the Lord showed him His own form: Rasarāja and Mahābhāva, the two in one form.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa in the form of Rasarāja and Śrīmatī Rādhikā in the form of Mahābhāva, united, are one *tattva*. It was this *svarūpa* that He showed, that is, He showed "the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa adorned with Rādhā's *bhāva* and radiance." In this way He showed a wondrous *svarūpa* in which one *tattva* is two, and two *tattvas* are one. Only those who are able to understand the truth of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya and the truth of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are granted, by the mercy of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī, to serve that eternal *svarūpa*.

Rāya faints in bliss —

দেখি' রামানন্দ হৈলা আনন্দে মূর্চ্ছিতে ।
ধরিতে না পারে দেহ, পড়িলা ভূমিতে ॥ ২৮২ ॥

dekhi' rāmānanda hailā ānande mūrcchite
seeing Rāmānanda became in bliss unconscious
dharite nā pāre deha, paḍilā bhūmite
to hold up not he can the body he fell to the ground

282 Seeing this, Rāmānanda fainted in bliss. Unable to hold himself up, he fell to the ground.

*Coming to himself, Rāya is amazed to see the Lord in the dress of a *sannyāsī**

—

প্রভু তাঁরে হস্ত স্পর্শি, করাইলা চেতন ।
সন্ন্যাসীর বেষ দেখি’ বিস্মিত হৈল মন ॥ ২৮৩ ॥

prabhu tāṁre hasta sparśi’ karāilā cetana
the Lord him with His hand touching brought to consciousness
sannyāsīra veṣa dekhi’ vismita haila mana
of a sannyāsī the dress seeing astonished became his mind

283 The Lord touched him with His hand and brought him back to consciousness, and seeing Him in the dress of a *sannyāsī*, Rāya was astonished.

*The Lord comforts Rāya and frankly reveals all the confidential reasons — that He is Kṛṣṇa Himself and that He is full of Rādhā's *bhāva* and radiance — their purpose and so on —*

আলিঙ্গন করি’ প্রভু কৈল আশ্বাসন ।
তোমা বিনা এইরূপ না দেখে অন্যজন ॥ ২৮৪ ॥

āliṅgana kari’ prabhu kaila āśvāsana
embrace making the Lord gave comfort
tomā vinā ei-rūpa nā dekhe anya-jana
you except this form not sees any other person

284 Embracing him, the Lord comforted him: “No one but you sees this form.

মোর তত্ত্বলীলা-রস তোমার গোচরে ।
অতএব এইরূপ দেখাইলুঁ তোমারে ॥ ২৮৫ ॥

mora tattva-līlā-rasa tomāra gocare
My truth pastimes rasa to you within reach of perception
ataeva ei-rūpa dekhāiluṁ tomāre
therefore this form I have shown to you

285 You know the truth of Me, of My pastimes and My rasa; therefore I have shown you this form.

গৌর অঙ্গ নহে, মোর — রাধাঙ্গস্পর্শন ।
গোপেন্দ্র সুত বিনা তেঁহো না স্পর্শে অন্যজন ॥ ২৮৬ ॥

gaura aṅga nahe, mora — rādhāṅga-sparśana
fair body is not Mine of Rādhā's body the touch
gopendra-suta vinā teṁho nā sparśe anya-jana
of the king of cowherds the son except She not touches any other person

286 This golden complexion is not Mine: it comes from the touch of Rādhā's body. And She touches no one but the son of the king of the cowherds.

Anubhāṣya.

The *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, relying on the words *gaura aṅga nahe*, take Gaura and Kṛṣṇa to be different. In fact both are the form of the *svayaṁ-rūpa*. Gaura Himself, in His "*svarūpa* as Kṛṣṇa," is in the *rasa* of *sambhoga* the *nāgara*, the *viṣaya-vigraha*; and Kṛṣṇa Himself, in His "*svarūpa* as Gaura," is in the *rasa* of *vipralambha* Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, full of the *bhāva* and radiance of Śrī Rādhā, the *āśraya-vigraha*. No form of Viṣṇu other than Śrī Nandanandana, the *svayaṁ-rūpa* — the embodiment of transcendental *śṛṅgāra*, the king of *rasas*, the *dhīra-lalita* hero — can enjoy Śrī Rādhikā, Kṛṣṇa's complete *cit-śakti*, or *svarūpa-śakti*, *mahābhāva* itself. For in all forms of Viṣṇu other than Kṛṣṇa there is no *śṛṅgāra-rasa* and no nature of a *dhīra-lalita* hero, and the mood of majesty (*aiśvarya*) predominates. That is why Śrīmatī's names are: "Rādhā is the delight of Govinda and the enchantress of Govinda; She is Govinda's all-in-all and the crest-jewel of all His beloveds." (*Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Ādi 4.82)

তাঁর ভাবে ভাবিত করি' আত্ম-মন ।
তবে নিজ-মাধুর্য্য করি আস্বাদন ॥ ২৮৭ ॥

tāṁra bhāve bhāvita kari' ātma-mana
Her with the bhāva imbued making My own mind
tabe nija-mādhurya kari āsvādana
then My own sweetness I do tasting

287 Steeping My own mind in Her *bhāva*, I then taste My own sweetness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Rāmānanda, you see in Me a separate 'golden person' (*gaura-puruṣa*) — but I am not that. I am that very Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the son of the king of the cowherds, and this golden hue of Mine — the touch of Rādhā's body — is eternal. Rādhikā touches no one but Kṛṣṇa. Steeping My *svarūpa* and mind in Śrī Rādhikā's feeling, I relish the *rasa* of My own sweetness, the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa."

তোমার ঠাঞি আমার কিছু গুপ্ত নাহি কর্ম্ম ।
লুকাইলে প্রেম-বলে জান সব মর্ম্ম ॥ ২৮৮ ॥

tomāra ṭhāñi āmāra kichu gupta nāhi karma
from you of Mine any hidden there are not doings
lukāile prema-bale jāna saba marma
if I hide by the power of love you know all the secrets

288 Nothing I do is hidden from you. Even if I hide it, by the power of love you know every secret.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.86–89.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi, Chapter 4.

*Confidential talks of *bhajana* are to be revealed to no one —*

গুপ্তে রাখিহ, কাঁহা না করিহ প্রকাশ ।
আমার বাতুল-চেষ্টা লোকে উপহাস ॥ ২৮৯ ॥

gupte rākhiha, kāṁhā nā kariha prakāśa
in secret keep it anywhere not make disclosure
āmāra bātula-ceṣṭā loke upahāsa
My mad behaviour people will ridicule

289 Keep it secret and reveal it to no one. People would laugh at My mad behaviour.

*The Lord and Rāya are both intoxicated with the feeling of the *āśraya* —*

আমি — এক বাতুল, তুমি — দ্বিতীয় বাতুল ।
অতএব তোমায়-আমায় হই সম-তুল ॥ ২৯০ ॥

āmi — eka bātula, tumi — dvitīya bātula
I one madman you a second madman
ataeva tomāya-āmāya hai sama-tula
therefore you and I are equal

290 I am one madman, and you are a second; therefore you and I are equals.”

Anubhāṣya.
In a world devoted to logic all this will become merely an object of laughter, because people are attached only to matter; therefore do not reveal it to the unworthy. When a person is intoxicated with love for Kṛṣṇa, his worldly material endeavors, devoted to logic, slacken, and the loving impulses of *rāgānugā-bhāva* look to the ordinary pleasure-seeking eye like mere “madness.” By material standards I am mad and you are mad; we are equal, and both of us are intoxicated with talks of love for Kṛṣṇa — and others, who cherish material *rasas* foreign to Kṛṣṇa, laugh at us.

The Lord spends ten days with Rāya —

এইরূপ দশরাত্রি রামানন্দ-সঙ্গে ।
সুখে গোঙাইলা প্রভু কৃষ্ণকথা-রঙ্গে ॥ ২৯১ ॥

ei-rūpa daśa-rātri rāmānanda-saṅge
in this way ten nights with Rāmānanda
sukhe goṅāilā prabhu kṛṣṇa-kathā-raṅge
happily spent the Lord in the joy of talks about Kṛṣṇa

291 In this way the Lord spent ten nights happily with Rāmānanda in the joy of talks about Kṛṣṇa.

The conversation of the Lord and Rāmānanda is a vast mine in which many metals are distinguished by their worth —

নিগূঢ় ব্রজের রস-লীলার বিচার ।
অনেক কহিল, তার না পাইল পার ॥ ২৯২ ॥

nigūḍha vrajera rasa-līlāra vicāra
deeply hidden of Vraja of the pastimes of rasa discussion
aneka kahila, tāra nā pāila pāra
much they spoke of it not reached the end

292 They spoke at length on the deeply hidden pastimes of rasa in Vraja, yet never reached their end.

*A comparison for the five transcendental *rasas* —*

তামা, কাঁসা, রূপা, সোনা, রত্নচিন্তামণি ।
কেহ যদি কাঁহা পোতা পায় এক-খানি ॥ ২৯৩ ॥

tāmā, kāṁsā, rūpā, sonā, ratna-cintāmaṇi
copper bell-metal silver gold the jewel cintāmaṇi
keha yadi kāṁhā potā pāya eka-khāni
someone if somewhere buried finds all together

293 Suppose someone finds copper, bell-metal, silver, gold and the *cintāmaṇi* jewel buried together in one place.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
To Śrī Mahāprabhu's questions Śrī Rāmānanda Rāya first gave five answers (in this chapter, from verse 57 to 67). The first of them is like copper, an ordinary metal; the second is like bronze, a metal better than that; the third is like silver, a metal

better still; the fourth is gold, the best of metals. But the fifth is *bhakti* free from *jñāna*; it is the jewel *cintāmaṇi*, that is, the goal (*sādhya*) itself, and by its power the other four acquire the worth of metals. And if the sixth answer (verses 68–81) is taken as the "first," then the five answers about *prema* that follow it must be understood by the same comparison.

Anubhāṣya.

In Vraja the embodiments of *śānta-rasa* — the waters of the Yamunā, the sand of its banks, the *kadamba* trees and so on, the cows, the staff, the flute and the rest; the embodiments of *dāsya-rasa* — Citraka, Patraka, Raktaka and others; the embodiments of *sakhya-rasa* — Śrīdāmā, Sudāmā and others; the embodiments of *vātsalya-rasa* — Nanda, Yaśodā and others; and the cowherd women — Śrīmatī Rādhikā, Lalitā and others — are each rich in their own *rasa*. *Śānta*, *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura* — these five are, in order, like mines of copper, bronze, silver, gold and the jewel *cintāmaṇi*. ***Potā*** — buried in the earth.

ক্রমে উঠাইতে, সেহ উত্তম বস্তু পায় ।
ঐছে প্রশ্নোত্তর কৈল প্রভু-রামরায় ॥ ২৯৪ ॥

krame uṭhāite, seha uttama vastu pāya
step by step digging up he the finest thing finds
aiche praśnottara kaila prabhu-rāmarāya
in that way questions and answers made the Lord and Rāmarāya

294 Digging it up step by step, he comes upon ever finer treasure. In just this way the Lord and Rāma Rāya went from question to answer.

The Lord takes leave of Rāya and gives him an instruction —

আর দিন রায়-পাশে বিদায় মাগিলা ।
বিদায়ের কালে তাঁরে এই আজ্ঞা দিলা ॥ ২৯৫ ॥

āra dina rāya-pāśe vidāya māgilā
the next day from Rāya leave He asked
vidāyera kāle tāṁre ei ājñā dilā
of parting at the time to him this instruction He gave

295 The next day the Lord asked Rāya's leave to go, and at the time of parting He gave him this instruction:

The Lord tells Rāya to go to Nīlācala: there, when they meet again, there will be the chance to talk about Kṛṣṇa —

বিষয় ছাড়িয়া তুমি যাহ নীলাচলে ।
আমি তীর্থ করি' তাঁহা আসিব অল্পকালে ॥ ২৯৬ ॥

viṣaya chāḍiyā tumi yāha nīlācale
worldly affairs giving up you go to Nīlācala
āmi tīrtha kari' tāṁhā āsiba alpa-kāle
I pilgrimage making there shall come in a short time

296 "Give up worldly affairs and go to Nīlācala. I shall visit the holy places and come there before long.

দুইজনে নীলাচলে রহিব একসঙ্গে ।
সুখে গোঙাইব কাল কৃষ্ণকথা-রঙ্গে ॥ ২৯৭ ॥

dui-jane nīlācale rahiba eka-saṅge
the two of us in Nīlācala shall stay together
sukhe goṅāiba kāla kṛṣṇa-kathā-raṅge
happily we shall pass the time in the joy of talks about Kṛṣṇa

297 The two of us shall live together in Nīlācala and happily pass our time in the joy of talks about Kṛṣṇa."

Rāya goes home —

এত বলি' রামানন্দে করি' আলিঙ্গন ।
তাঁরে ঘরে পাঠাইয়া করিল শয়ন ॥ ২৯৮ ॥

eta bali' rāmānande kari' āliṅgana
so saying Rāmānanda making embrace
tāṁre ghare pāṭhāiyā karila śayana
him home sending He made lying down to rest

298 Saying this, He embraced Rāmānanda, sent him home and lay down to rest.

*After the *darśana* of Vajrāṅga-jī, the Lord sets out for the south —*

প্রাতঃকালে উঠি' প্রভু দেখি' হনুমান্ ।
তাঁরে নমস্করি' প্রভু দক্ষিণে করিলা প্রয়াণ ॥ ২৯৯ ॥

prātaḥ-kāle uṭhi' prabhu dekhi' hanumān
in the morning rising the Lord seeing Hanumān
tāṁre namaskari' prabhu dakṣiṇe karilā prayāṇa
to him offering obeisances the Lord to the south made departure

299 Rising in the morning, the Lord had *darśana* of Hanumān, offered him obeisances and set out for the south.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Hanumān. In Vidyānagara the form (*mūrti*) of Hanumān is worshiped. Bowing to that village deity, the Lord went south.

On seeing the Lord, all the people of Vidyānagara become Vaiṣṇavas —

'বিদ্যাপুরে' নানা-মত লোক বৈসে যত ।
প্রভু-দর্শনে 'বৈষ্ণব' হৈল, ছাড়ি' নিজমত ॥ ৩০০ ॥

'vidyāpure' nānā-mata loka vaise yata
in Vidyāpura of various doctrines people live as many as
prabhu-darśane 'vaiṣṇava' haila, chāḍi' nija-mata
on seeing the Lord Vaiṣṇavas became giving up their own doctrines

300 All the people of Vidyāpura, whatever their doctrines, became Vaiṣṇavas on seeing the Lord and gave up their own views.

Anubhāṣya.
Vidyāpure — in Vidyānagara.

Rāya's state in separation from the Lord —

রামানন্দ হৈলা প্রভুর বিরহে বিহ্বল ।
প্রভুর ধ্যানে রহে বিষয় ছাড়িয়া সকল ॥ ৩০১ ॥

rāmānanda hailā prabhura virahe vihvala
Rāmānanda became in separation from the Lord overwhelmed
prabhura dhyāne rahe viṣaya chāḍiyā sakala
on the Lord in meditation he remains worldly affairs giving up all

301 Rāmānanda was overwhelmed by separation from the Lord. Giving up all worldly affairs, he remained absorbed in meditation on Him.

In this book the conversation of the Lord and Rāmānanda is described only briefly —

সংক্ষেপে কহিলুঁ রামানন্দের মিলন ।
বিস্তারি' বর্ণিতে নারে সহস্র-বদন ॥ ৩০২ ॥

saṅkṣepe kahiluṁ rāmānandera milana
briefly I have told Rāmānanda's meeting
vistāri' varṇite nāre sahasra-vadana
in detail to describe is not able the thousand-mouthed one

302 I have told briefly of the Lord's meeting with Rāmānanda. Even the thousand-mouthed Ananta could not describe it in full.

The connection between Caitanya's pastimes, Rāya's life and the pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa —

সহজে চৈতন্যচরিত্র — ঘনদুগ্ধপূর ।
রামানন্দ-চরিত্র তাহে খণ্ড প্রচুর ॥ ৩০৩ ॥

sahaje caitanya-caritra — ghana-dugdha-pūra
by nature Caitanya's life of thickened milk a flood
rāmānanda-caritra tāhe khaṇḍa pracura
Rāmānanda's life in it sugar candy abundant

303 Caitanya's life is by nature a flood of thickened milk, and Rāmānanda's life is the abundant sugar candy in it.

Only the most fortunate have the right and the chance to enter these pastimes —

রাধাকৃষ্ণলীলা — তাতে কর্পূর মিলন ।
ভাগ্যবান্ যেই, সেই করে আস্বাদন ॥ ৩০৪ ॥

rādhā-kṛṣṇa-līlā — tāte karpūra-milana
the pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa to that of camphor the mixing
bhāgyavān yei, sei kare āsvādana
fortunate who he does tasting

304 The pastimes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa are the camphor mixed into it. Whoever is fortunate tastes it.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Śrī Caitanya's life is like thickly boiled-down milk; Rāmānanda's life is *khaṇḍa*, or *khāṛ*, that is, a special kind of sugar in it; and the pastimes of Śrī Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa among them are camphor in that sweetened milk.

Thus ends the eighth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

যে ইহা একবার পিয়ে কর্ণদ্বারে ।
তাঁর কর্ণ লোভে ইহা ছাড়িতে না পারে ॥ ৩০৫ ॥

ye ihā eka-bāra piye karṇa-dvāre
who this once drinks through the ears
tāṁra karṇa lobhe ihā chāḍite nā pāre
his ears out of longing this to give up not can

305 Whoever drinks it even once through the ears — his ears, out of longing, can never give it up.

The fruit of hearing the conversation of the Lord and Rāmānanda —

‘রসতত্ত্ব-জ্ঞান’ হয় ইহার শ্রবণে ।
‘প্রেমভক্তি’ হয় রাধাকৃষ্ণের চরণে ॥ ৩০৬ ॥

‘rasa-tattva-jñāna’ haya ihāra śravaṇe
of rasa of the truth knowledge comes of this by hearing
‘prema-bhakti’ haya rādhā-kṛṣṇera caraṇe
loving devotion comes of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa for the feet

306 By hearing it one gains knowledge of the truth of rasa, and loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*) awakens for the feet of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

চৈতন্যের গূঢ়তত্ত্ব জানি ইহা হৈতে ।
বিশ্বাস করি’ শুন, তর্ক না করিহ চিত্তে ॥ ৩০৭ ॥

caitanyera gūḍha-tattva jāni ihā haite
of Caitanya the hidden truth one knows this from
viśvāsa kari’ śuna, tarka nā kariha citte
faith having hear argument not make in the mind

307 From this one comes to know the hidden truth of Caitanya. Hear it with faith, and do not argue in your mind.

Bhagavān's inconceivable nature is beyond logic —

অলৌকিক লীলা এই পরম নিগূঢ় ।
বিশ্বাসে পাইয়ে, তর্কে হয় বহুদূর ॥ ৩০৮ ॥

alaukika līlā ei parama nigūḍha
beyond this world pastime this supremely hidden
viśvāse pāiye, tarke haya bahu-dūra
by faith it is attained by argument it becomes far away

308 This pastime is beyond the world and supremely hidden. It is attained by faith; by argument it remains far away.

Love for Kṛṣṇa is attained only by one wholly devoted to Nitāi, Gaura and Advaita —

শ্রীচৈতন্য-নিত্যানন্দ-অদ্বৈত-চরণ।
যাঁহার সর্ব্বস্ব, তাঁরে মিলে এই ধন ॥ ৩০৯ ॥

śrī caitanya-nityānanda-advaita-caraṇa
Śrī Caitanya's Nityānanda's Advaita's feet
yāṁhāra sarvasva, tāṁre mile ei dhana
whose all in all to him comes this treasure

309 This treasure comes to one whose all in all is the feet of Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda and Advaita.

Anubhāṣya.

"Kṛṣṇa is attained by faith; by logic one goes far away." That is, only through faith (*viśvāsa*), that is, *śraddhā*, following the path step by step, does one come to experience this supramundane, supremely secret, true Reality — the pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa. It is not the fiction or "whim" of a *jīva* who does not follow the path of *śruti*, doubts the real truth and has turned away from service — a product of the mind with its accepting and rejecting, which can be shaped however one likes. One who relies on material logic has so great a desire for material enjoyment that the spiritual pastimes stay far away. Thus (*Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 1.2.9): "This understanding cannot be reached by logic; O dearest, only when taught by another does it lead to true knowledge." (*Muṇḍaka Upaniṣad* 3.2.3): "This Self is not attained by discourse, nor by intellect, nor by much hearing. Whom He chooses, by him He is attained; to him this Self reveals His own form." (*Brahma-sūtra* 2.1.11): "For logic has no firm ground." A person who tries to grasp the supramundane truth with knowledge full of material, mundane judgments goes far from the Reality, because the subject under consideration here (the *rasa* of love for Kṛṣṇa) is supramundane. When materialistic *sahajiyās* or men of letters reason about it with the mind, that is, the intellect, what they think they have reasoned about is mundane; and so all such efforts of theirs are futile. Only one who has given up such reasoning and has faith in Viṣṇu-*tattva* alone has knowledge of *sambandha* that is pure and attained without difficulty.

The author glorifies Rāya —

রামানন্দ রায়ে মোর কোটী নমস্কার ।
যাঁর মুখে কৈল প্রভু রসের বিস্তার ॥ ৩১০ ॥

rāmānanda rāye mora koṭī namaskāra
to Rāmānanda Rāya my ten million obeisances
yāṁra mukhe kaila prabhu rasera vistāra
through whose mouth made the Lord of rasa the unfolding

310 To Rāmānanda Rāya I offer ten million obeisances. Through his mouth the Lord unfolded the truth of rasa.

দামোদর-স্বরূপের কড়চা-অনুসারে ।
রামানন্দ-মিলন-লীলা করিল প্রচারে ॥ ৩১১ ॥

dāmodara-svarūpera kaḍacā-anusāre
of Svarūpa Dāmodara the notes following
rāmānanda-milana-līlā karila pracāre
of Rāmānanda of the meeting the pastime I have made known

311 Following the notes (*kaḍacā*) of Svarūpa Dāmodara, I have made known the pastime of the Lord's meeting with Rāmānanda.

Anubhāṣya.

At the end of almost every chapter the author in this way, by the path of *śruti*, shows his unwavering fidelity to the guru. What he means to establish is this: the event "the meeting of the Lord and Rāmānanda" was written and described exactly according to the diary (*kaḍacā*) of Śrīla Dāmodara Svarūpa; it is not something invented out of one's own head, not the proud effort of a worldly man who has given up hearing from the mouth of the guru.

Thus ends the eighth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ৩১২ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

312 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 4.2; translation as there. ↩
2. The same verse as Madhya 9.264. ↩
3. The same verse as Madhya 9.265. ↩
4. The same verse as Madhya 1.206; translation as there. ↩
5. The same verse as Madhya 9.121; translation as there. ↩
6. The same verse as Ādi 5.214; translation as there. ↩
7. The same verse as Ādi 4.23; translation as there. Kṛṣṇa's words to the gopīs at Kurukṣetra. ↩
8. Compare Ādi 4.177 (the second line is the same). ↩
9. The same verse as Ādi 4.180; translation as there. ↩
10. The same verse as Ādi 4.215; translation as there. The edition gives the source as *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (2.45), the words of the *Padma Purāṇa*. ↩
11. The same verse as Ādi 4.88; translation as there. ↩
12. The same verse as Ādi 4.219; translation as there. ↩
13. Variant reading: the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *sevya-sādhana-nirṇaya* ("the ascertainment of the One to be served and of the means"); another reading, noted by the *Anubhāṣya*, is *sādhya-sādhana-nirṇaya* ("of the goal and the means"). ↩
14. The same verse as Ādi 2.107; translation as there. ↩
15. The same verse as Ādi 5.214 (= 81); translation as there. ↩
16. The same verse as Ādi 4.224; translation as there. ↩
17. The same verse as Madhya 9.114. ↩
18. The same verse as Ādi 4.146; translation as there. ↩
19. The same verse as Ādi 7.119 and Madhya 6.154; translation as there. ↩
20. The same verse as Ādi 4.62; translation as there. ↩
21. The same verse as Madhya 6.157 (Ādi 4.63 with the reading *sarva-saṁśraye*, "the shelter of all"; Ādi 4.63 reads *sarva-saṁsthitau*, "the basis of all"; the

sense is the same); translation as there. ↩

22. The same verse as Ādi 4.70; translation as there. The reference follows the edition's heading here (*Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*, chapter 4, verse 3). ↩
23. The same verse as Ādi 4.72; translation as there. ↩
24. The same verse as Ādi 4.117; translation as there. ↩
25. The same verse as Ādi 4.163; translation as there. In the edition, the words of the *Gautamīya-tantra*. ↩
26. The same verse as Ādi 4.173; translation as there. ↩
27. The same verse as Madhya 9.123; translation as there. ↩
28. The author himself explains in the next verse: *samāḥ* — the Śrutis attained bodies like those of the gopīs; *sama-dṛśaḥ* — they follow the gopīs' mood. So too the *Anubhāṣya*: "like the gopīs in form, as their *kāya-vyūhas*, filled with a mood that follows theirs." ↩
29. The same verse as Madhya 9.132; translation as there. ↩
30. The same verse as Madhya 9.121 (= 80); translation as there. ↩
31. The edition reads *tomāra saba* ("all of you"; other editions, *tomāra saṅga*, "your company"); the sense is the same. ↩
32. The edition reads *kānta-bhāgavata prema*, apparently a transposition of syllables for *kānta-bhāva-gata*, "in the mood of the beloved." ↩
33. So in the edition: সর্পে রজ্জু-ভ্রমের ন্যায় (literally "like the rope-delusion in a snake"); the usual example is the reverse: a rope is mistaken for a snake. ↩
34. The edition reads কবিরাজ ("king of poets"); from the sense of the verse (*kuñjara-pati*, "king of elephants") this is apparently a misprint for করিরাজ (king of elephants). ↩
35. The verse translation reads differently: He "cannot be attained by those who identify with the body…"; Bhaktivinoda connects the word *dehinām* ("embodied") with the devotees. ↩
36. The edition gives no source; it is *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.2.45. ↩
37. The edition does not give the verse number; it is *Manaḥ-śikṣā* 2. ↩
38. The edition gives no source; it is *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu* 1.2.101, where the verse is quoted as the words of the *Brahma-yāmala* (the last word there is *kalpate*; the edition has *kevalam*). ↩
39. In a number of editions of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, 7.11.35. ↩
40. So in the edition: গুহ্য-সূত্র ("*guhya-sūtra*"), apparently for গৃহ্য-সূত্র ("*gṛhya-sūtra*"). ↩
41. The verse is printed in a corrupted form in the edition (ইত্যঙ্গোক্তিমস্থান্তে পরসম্বন্ধগাস্তথা); its sense ("qualities in the body, in speech, in the mind, and those

connected with others”) is clear from the *Anubhāṣya*'s explanation that follows. The source is the *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*. ↩

42. The edition gives no source; it is *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*, Eastern Division, fifth wave (in the accepted numbering, 2.5.132). ↩
43. *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, Madhya 8.193 (a line of Rāmānanda Rāya's song). ↩
44. In the verse of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* (Madhya 8.290) the word is *bātula* (“madman”); in the *Anubhāṣya* it is *bāula* (“*bāul*”). ↩
45. *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi* (the definition of *pūrva-rāga*). ↩
46. The edition prints নাহং নিশবশ্চ শেষশ্চ…; the word নিশবশ্চ is apparently a corruption of শিবশ্চ (“and Śiva”), and is translated so. ↩
47. So in the edition; this verse is *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.33.39. ↩
48. A pun: “Gautama” can also be read as “the greatest of bulls” (*go-tama*). ↩
49. So in the edition (২৪২); the verse is 281. ↩